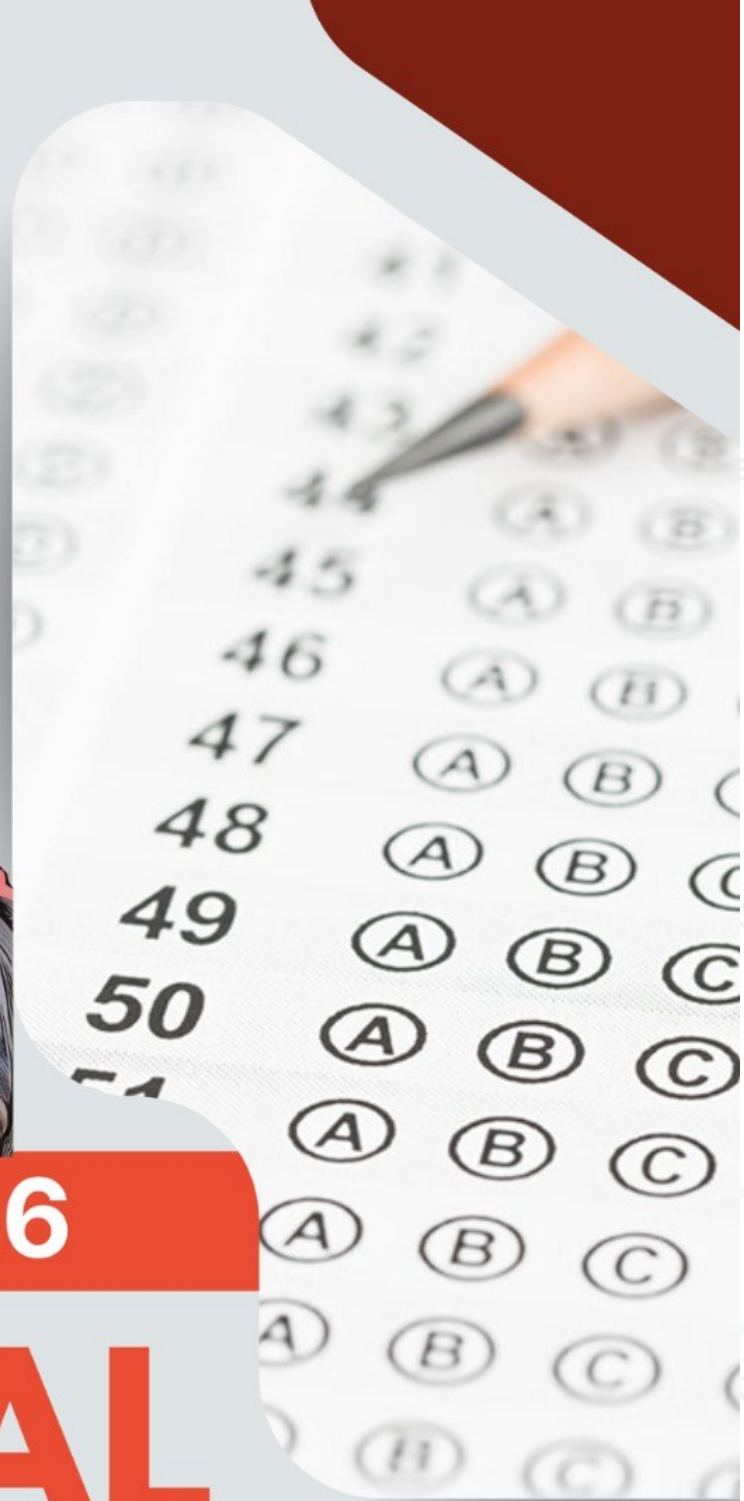
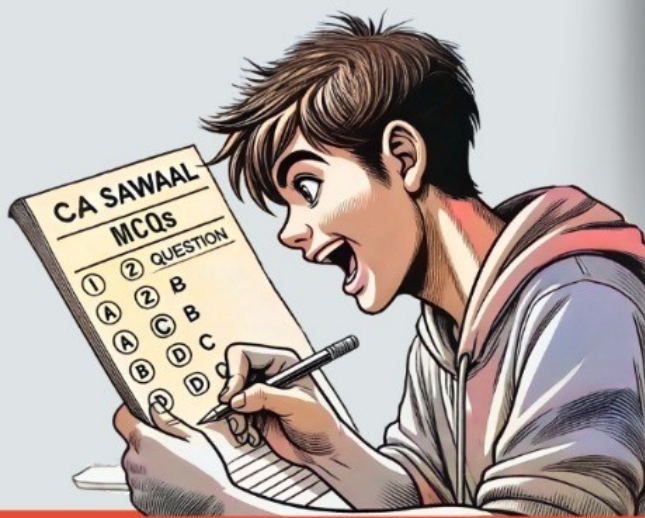




**JANUARY 2026**

# SAWAAL

**The CA OBJECTIVE  
Monthly e-Book**

**400**<sup>\*</sup> MCQs  
Detailed  
Explanation

## Contents

|                                     |     |
|-------------------------------------|-----|
| Important Days & themes .....       | 3   |
| Appointments .....                  | 10  |
| Books .....                         | 14  |
| Obituaries.....                     | 17  |
| Awards National .....               | 20  |
| State.....                          | 28  |
| Defence .....                       | 49  |
| Science &tech .....                 | 57  |
| Environment.....                    | 64  |
| National .....                      | 72  |
| Eminent Personalities in News ..... | 84  |
| Banking .....                       | 86  |
| International.....                  | 88  |
| Sports.....                         | 94  |
| Index .....                         | 100 |

## Important Days & themes

### 1. The Mahayana New Year is observed on:

- A. The first lunar day following the winter solstice
- B. The first full moon day of the lunar month of January
- C. The full moon day of the spring equinox month
- D. The new moon day marking the beginning of the Buddhist calendar year

**Answer: B**

- **3 January- Mahayana New Year**
- **Mahayana New Year starts on the first full moon day in January.** Celebrated in Mahayana countries like China, Korea, Japan, Taiwan and Vietnam.

### 2. The Braille script was first introduced in India in:

- A) 1854
- B) 1887
- C) 1951
- D) 2019

**Answer: B**

- **4th January World Braille Day**
- World Braille Day, celebrated since 2019, is observed to raise awareness of the importance of Braille as a means of communication in the full realization of the human rights for blind and partially sighted people. The Braille script was introduced in India in 1887.

### 3. National Bird Day is celebrated annually on:

- A) 2 January
- B) 4 January
- C) 5 January
- D) 10 January

**Answer: C**

- National Bird Day, which has American origins, is celebrated annually on 5th of January, to raise awareness about the value of birds in the ecosystem.
- **THEME :** "Every Bird Counts – Your Observations Matter!"

### 4. The theme of the 9th Siddha Day celebrations is:

- A) Integrative Medicine for Wellness
- B) Traditional Medicine for Sustainable Health
- C) Siddha for Global Health
- D) Indigenous Systems of Healing

**Answer: C**

- Siddha Day annually observed on 6 January.
- **The celebrations, themed "Siddha for Global Health,"** commemorate the birth anniversary of Sage Agathiyar, revered as the father of Siddha medicine.

### 5. Earth Rotation Day commemorates the scientific demonstration of Earth's rotation conducted in 1851 by:

- A) Galileo Galilei
- B) Isaac Newton
- C) Léon Foucault
- D) Johannes Kepler

**Answer: C**

- January 8 is recognized as Earth Rotation Day every year.
- **Today marks the anniversary of French physicist Leon Foucault's 1851 proof** that the Earth revolves on its axis.



6. The year 2026 has been designated by the United Nations as the:

संयुक्त राष्ट्र ने वर्ष 2026 को इस रूप में नामित किया है:

- A) Year of Forest Conservation
- B) International Year for Rangelands and Pastoralists
- C) Year of Climate Action
- D) International Year of Sustainable Agriculture

**Answer: B**

- The United Nations has declared 2026 as the International Year for Rangelands and Pastoralists, renewing global attention on grasslands.
- Recent climate negotiations continue to prioritise forests, prompting debate on why grasslands must be integrated into national climate plans and NDCs.

7. January 9 was chosen as Pravasi Bharatiya Divas because on this day in 1915:

- A. The Indian Constitution was drafted
- B. The first overseas Indian association was formed
- C. **Mahatma Gandhi returned to India from South Africa**
- D. The first Pravasi Bharatiya Conference was held

**Answer: C**

- 9 January – NRI (Non-Resident Indian) Day or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- January 9 was chosen as the day to celebrate PBD as it was on this day, in 1915, that Mahatma Gandhi had returned to India from South Africa.

8. World Hindi Day commemorates which historic event?

विश्व हिंदी दिवस किस ऐतिहासिक घटना की याद में मनाया जाता है?

- A. First use of Hindi at the United Nations General Assembly
- B. First World Hindi Conference
- C. Adoption of Hindi as India's official language
- D. Formation of the Hindi Sahitya Akademi

**Answer: A**

- Vishwa Hindi Diwas is an annual event observed on January 10.
- **World Hindi Day was created to mark the occasion when Hindi was first spoken at the UNGA in 1949.**

9. Since which year has the Government of India been observing January 12 as National Youth Day?

- A. 1975
- B. 1980
- C. 1985
- D. 1990

**Answer: C**

- Rashtriya Yuva Divas also known as Vivekanand Jayanti.
- Every year **since 1985**, the Government of India observes January 12 as National Youth Day and the **week commencing from that day, as National Youth Week.**

10. Consider the following statements regarding Army Day in India:

1. Army Day is observed every year on 15 January.
2. It marks the day when the first Indian Commander-in-Chief took charge of the Indian Army.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- Every year, 15 January is commemorated as 'Army Day' to remember the occasion **when General (later Field Marshal) KM Cariappa took over the command of the Indian Army from General Sir FRR Bucher, the last British Commander-in-Chief in 1949** and became the first Indian Commander-in-Chief of Independent India.

**11. Defence Forces Veterans' Day** is observed in India every year on:

- A. 13 January
- B. **14 January**
- C. 15 January
- D. 26 January

**Answer: B**

- The nation observed the 10th Defence Forces Veterans' Day on January 14, 2026, paying tribute to the valour, sacrifices and dedicated service of the veterans who have served the nation with distinction.
- The **Defence Forces Veterans' Day is commemorated on 14th January every year to honour the legacy and yeoman service of Field Marshal KM Cariappa**, the first Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Army, who retired on this day in 1953.

**12. With reference to the Startup India Initiative**, consider the following statements:

1. It provides **tax exemption for three consecutive financial years**.
2. It includes a **₹10,000 crore Fund of Funds for Startups (FFS)**.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- National Startup Day on 16 January 2026 marks a landmark decade of the Startup India Initiative.
- **Startup India was launched on 16 January 2016** by the Prime Minister as a transformative national programme to nurture innovation, promote entrepreneurship and enable investment-driven growth, with the objective of making India a nation of job creators rather than job seekers.
- **Funding Support:** ₹10,000 crore Fund of Funds for Startups (FFS) supports early-stage funding.
- eligible DPIIT-recognized startups can claim a 100% income tax exemption for any **three consecutive financial years out of the first ten years** since their incorporation

**13. Tirukkural consists of:**

- (a) 1,200 verses written in epic metre
- (b) 1,330 short couplets dealing with ethics, polity and love
- (c) 1,000 hymns devoted to moral theology
- (d) 1,500 aphorisms on metaphysics

**Answer: (b)**

**15<sup>TH</sup> January Thiruvalluvar Day.**

- **Thiruvalluvar was a celebrated Tamil poet-philosopher, traditionally linked to the Sangam/post-Sangam intellectual milieu, revered as a moral teacher across South India.**

**Tirukkural:**

- The Tirukkural is a classical Tamil text of 1,330 short couplets (kurals) offering teachings on ethics, polity/economics, and love.
- **Author:** Traditionally attributed to Thiruvalluvar.

**14. National Defence Academy (NDA) Raising Day is observed on which date?**

- A. January 1
- B. January 9
- C. January 16
- D. January 26

**Answer: C**

- **16<sup>TH</sup> January National Defence Academy's Raising Day**
- The National Defence Academy (NDA), India's **premier tri-services military training academy at Khadakwasla, Pune, commemorates 77 years since its raising.**

**15. Kokborok was officially recognized as a state language of Tripura in which year?**

- (a) 1972
- (b) 1979
- (c) 1985
- (d) 1999

**Answer: b**

- 19 January- Kokborok Day - Officially recognized as a state language of Tripura on January 19, 1979. Declared an official language of the Tripura Tribal Areas Autonomous District Council (TTAADC) on April 20, 1999.

**16. With reference to Lokpal of India, consider the following statements: It is a constitutional body established under Article 280 of the Constitution. The Lokpal institution came into legal force on 16 January 2014. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- Lokpal of India observed its Foundation Day on 16 January 2026, marking the day the institution legally came into force in 2014. Lokpal is a statutory, independent anti-corruption ombudsman at the Union level.

**17. Consider the following statements: Penguin Awareness Day is observed annually on 20 January. Emperor Penguin is the largest species of penguin in the world. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C.**

- Every year on January 20, Penguin Awareness Day is observed. Emperor Penguin is the largest of all the different kinds of penguin species.

**18. The National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) was raised on:**

- (a) 26 January 2005
- (b) 19 January 2006
- (c) 29 October 2005
- (d) 15 August 2006

**Answer: (b)**

- National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) was raised on 19th January 2006 after the enactment of Disaster Management Act, 2005. Since its raising, it has grown from initial 8 Battalions to 16 Battalions today.

**19. In which year did the Government of India announce that 23rd January would be celebrated as Parakram Diwas?**

- A. 2019
- B. 2020
- C. 2021
- D. 2022

**Answer: C**



- Subhas Chandra Bose Jayanti, also known as Parakram Diwas or the Day of Valour, is observed annually in India to honour one of India's esteemed freedom fighters, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose. In 2021, the government announced that 23rd January will be celebrated as 'Parakram Diwas.' Subhas Chandra Bose, born on January 23, 1897, in Cuttack, Orissa

**20. What is the theme of the International Day of Education for the year 2026?**

- A. Inclusive education for all
- B. Education for sustainable development
- C. Transforming education through technology
- D. The power of youth in co-creating education

**Answer: D**

- 24 January - International Day of Education Since 2018, the day has been authored by 59 member states. The theme 2026 : The power of youth in co-creating education

**21. National Girl Child Day was introduced in India for the first time in which of the following years?**

- A. 2006
- B. 2008
- C. 2010
- D. 2015

**Answer: B.**

- National Girl Child Day is observed on 24 January every year, with an aim to spread awareness about the challenges faced by girls in Indian Society. National Girl Child Day was implemented for the first time by the Ministry of Women and Child Development in 2008

**22. Consider the following statements regarding 26 January: The Congress Party declared 26 January 1930 as Independence Day. The Constitution of India was adopted on 26 January 1930. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- This year marks 77 years since our Constitution came into effect on January 26, 1950 (adopted on November 26, 1949). The Indian National Congress, on 19 December 1929, passed the historic 'Purna Swaraj' – (total independence) resolution – at its Lahore session. A public declaration was made on 26 January 1930 – a day which the Congress Party urged Indians to celebrate as 'Independence Day'.

**23. The theme for National Voters' Day 2026 is:**

- A. Empowering Democracy
- B. Vote for Nation
- C. My India, My Vote
- D. One Nation One Vote

**Answer: C**

- Since 2011, National Voters' Day has been observed annually on January 25 to commemorate the foundation day of the Election Commission of India, established on January 25, 1950. The theme for National Voters' Day 2026 is "My India, My Vote" with a tagline of Citizen at the Heart of Indian Democracy.

**24. The theme of International Customs Day 2026 is:**

- A. Customs for Economic Growth

- B. Customs Protecting Society through Vigilance and Commitment
- C. Securing Borders, Securing Nations
- D. Customs in the Digital Era

**Answer: B**

- 26 January - International Customs Day Dedicated to the united efforts of Customs to support people and businesses Theme: "Customs Protecting Society through Vigilance and Commitment."

**25. The United Nations designated 27 January as International Holocaust Remembrance Day to commemorate:**

- A. The signing of the Nuremberg Laws
- B. The beginning of World War II
- C. The liberation of Auschwitz-Birkenau
- D. The end of the Holocaust

**Answer: C**

- 27 January - International Day of Commemoration in Memory of the Victims of the Holocaust, Designated by the United Nations to mark the anniversary of the January 27, 1945, liberation of Auschwitz-Birkenau, the largest Nazi concentration and death camp.

**26. International Data Privacy Day is observed annually on:**

- A. 26 January
- B. 27 January
- C. 28 January
- D. 30 January

**Answer: C**

- January 28 International Data Privacy Day, In 2006 Council of Europe initiated International Data Privacy Day, also known as Data Protection Day. Theme - "Privacy by Design: Building Digital Trust,"

**27. The theme of the International Day of Peaceful Coexistence 2026 is:**

- A. Peace through Sustainable Development
- B. Unity in Diversity
- C. Commitment to Peaceful Coexistence and a Safe, Inclusive World
- D. Global Harmony for the Future

**Answer: C**

- On 4 March 2025, the United Nations General Assembly adopted proclaiming 28 January as the International Day of Peaceful Coexistence. THEME: Commitment to Peaceful Coexistence and a Safe, Inclusive World

**28. India's first printed newspaper, Hicky's Bengal Gazette, was first published in:**

- A. 1757
- B. 1765
- C. 1780
- D. 1857

**Answer: C**

- **29 January - Indian Newspaper Day**
- Commemorate the birth of the country's first-ever printed newspaper.
- On January 29, 1780, Ireland-born James Augustus Hicky published the first edition of 'Hicky's Bengal Gazette', India's first newspaper.

**29. India observes Martyrs' Day on 30 January primarily to commemorate:**

- A. The adoption of the Indian Constitution
- B. The execution of Bhagat Singh
- C. The assassination of Mahatma Gandhi
- D. The formation of Indian National Congress

**Answer: C**

- 30 January - Martyrs Day or Shaheed Diwas
- On this day in 1948 Mahatma Gandhi was assassinated in the Birla House in New Delhi by Nathuram Godse



30. India's first printed newspaper, *Hicky's Bengal Gazette*, was first published in:

- A. 1757
- B. 1765
- C. 1780
- D. 1857

Answer: C

- **29 January - Indian Newspaper Day**
- Commemorate the birth of the country's first-ever printed newspaper.
- On January 29, 1780, Ireland-born James Augustus Hicky published the first edition of 'Hicky's Bengal Gazette', India's first newspaper.

31. India observes **Martyrs' Day** on 30 January primarily to commemorate:

- A. The adoption of the Indian Constitution
- B. The execution of Bhagat Singh
- C. The assassination of Mahatma Gandhi
- D. The formation of Indian National Congress

Answer: C

- **30 January - Martyrs Day or Shaheed Diwas**
- On this day in 1948 Mahatma Gandhi was assassinated in the Birla House in New Delhi by Nathuram Godse.

# SSC+RAILWAY MEGA COMBO

## BATCH 2026-27 (LIFETIME)

UNLIMITED LIVE + RECORDED BATCH | LIFETIME VALIDITY

FREE TEST SERIES

ALL SUBJECTS INCLUDED



## Appointments

**1. Who has been recently appointed as the Chairman of the Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC)?**

- A. Sanjay Jain
- B. Rahul Mehta
- C. A. Sakthivel
- D. Rakesh Mehra

**Answer: C**

- A Sakthivel has been recently appointed as the chairman of the Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC), marking his fifth term at the helm of the organization.

**2. Who has been appointed as the new Director of the Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR)?**

- A) C.G. Karhadkar
- B) Sreekumar G. Pillai
- C) R. Chidambaram
- D) Anil Kakodkar

**Answer: B**

- Sreekumar G. Pillai, Deputy Chief Executive, Nuclear Recycle Board, Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC), Mumbai, has been appointed the **new Director of Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR), Kalpakkam, from January 1, 2026.**

**3. Who has been appointed as the new Chief Justice of the Kerala High Court?**

- A) Nithin Jamdar
- B) Soumen Sen
- C) Sanjib Banerjee
- D) Ashok Bhushan

**Answer: B**

- **Soumen Sen, Chief Justice of the High Court of Meghalaya, will be the new Chief Justice of the Kerala High Court.** Nithin Jamdar, the present Chief Justice of Kerala, will retire on January 9.

**4. Who has assumed charge as the Vice Chief of the Air Staff of the Indian Air Force?**

- A) Air Marshal Narmadeshwar Tiwari
- B) Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor
- C) Air Chief Marshal V. R. Chaudhari
- D) Air Marshal Rakesh Kumar Singh Bhadauria

**Answer: B**

- Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor assumed charge as the Vice Chief of the Air Staff, succeeding Air Marshal Narmadeshwar Tiwari, who superannuated after 40 years of distinguished service to the nation.

**5. Who was sworn in as the Chief Justice of the Patna High Court?**

- A) Arif Mohammad Khan
- B) Sangam Kumar Sahoo
- C) Dhananjaya Y Chandrachud
- D) Sanjiv Khanna

**Answer: b**

- Sangam Kumar Sahoo was sworn in as the Chief Justice of the Patna High Court, He was elevated as a Judge of the Orissa High Court on July 2, 2014.

**6. Who was sworn in as the 18th Chief Justice of the Jharkhand High Court?**

झारखंड हाई कोर्ट के 18वें चीफ जस्टिस के तौर पर किसने शपथ ली?

- A. Tarlok Singh Chauhan
- B. Sanjiv Khanna

C. Mahesh Sharadchandra Sonak

D. D. Y. Chandrachud

**Answer: C**

- Justice Mahesh Sharadchandra Sonak sworn in as the 18th Chief Justice of Jharkhand High Court (HC). **Justice Sonak assumed charge after incumbent Chief Justice Tarlok Singh Chauhan demitted office on January 8,** upon attaining the age of 62 years.

**7. Who has been appointed as the Chief Justice of the Uttarakhand High Court?**

A. Guhanathan Narendar

B. Sanjiv Khanna

C. Manoj Kumar Gupta

D. Rajiv Sharma

**Answer: C.**

- Justice Manoj Kumar Gupta was appointed as the Chief Justice of the Uttarakhand High Court. **He will assume charge after the incumbent, Justice Guhanathan Narendar, demits office upon attaining the age of 62.**

**8. The headquarters of the Advisory Board on Disarmament Matters is located at:**

निरस्त्रीकरण मामलों पर सलाहकार बोर्ड का मुख्यालय यहाँ स्थित है:

A. Geneva

B. Vienna

C. The Hague

D. New York

**Answer: D**

- Senior Indian diplomat DB Venkatesh Varma** has been nominated by the UN Secretary General to **chair the Advisory Board on Disarmament Matters for the 2026–27 term, marking the first time an Indian will hold the position.**
- It was established in **1978**.
- Headquarter: New York.

**9. Who has been sworn in as the first woman Chief Justice of the Meghalaya High Court?**

मेघालय हाई कोर्ट की पहली महिला चीफ जस्टिस के तौर पर किसने शपथ ली है?

A. Indira Banerjee

B. Gita Mittal

C. Revati Mohite Dere

D. Hima Kohli

**Answer: C**

- Justice Revati Mohite Dere was sworn in as the first woman Chief Justice of the Meghalaya High Court. Justice Dere succeeds Soumen Sen, who has been transferred to the Kerala High Court.

**10. Who has been appointed as the Director General of the National Investigation Agency (NIA) with tenure up to 31 August 2028?**

किसे 31 अगस्त 2028 तक के कार्यकाल के लिए नेशनल इन्वेस्टिगेशन एजेंसी (NIA) का डायरेक्टर जनरल नियुक्त किया गया है?

A. Shatrujeet Singh Kapoor

B. Praveen Kumar

C. Rakesh Aggarwal

D. Sanjay Arora

**Answer: C**

- Senior IPS officer Rakesh Aggarwal was appointed as the Director General of the National Investigation Agency (NIA),** tenure up to August 31, 2028
- Former Haryana DGP Shatrujeet Singh Kapoor was named as the Director General of Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)** up to October 31, 2026, succeeding incumbent Praveen Kumar



**11. Who was sworn in as the Chief Justice of the Calcutta High Court?**

- A. T.S. Sivagnanam
- B. C.V. Ananda Bose
- C. Sujoy Paul
- D. Sanjiv Khanna

**Answer: C**

- Sujoy Paul was sworn in as the chief justice of Calcutta High Court . **West Bengal Governor C.V. Ananda Bose administered the oath of office to Justice Paul.**

**12. Who has been appointed as the goodwill ambassador for the Pune Grand Tour 2026?**

- A. Sachin Tendulkar
- B. Mahendra Singh Dhoni
- C. Virat Kohli
- D. Anil Kumble

**Answer: B**

- Bajaj Pune Grand Tour 2026: MS Dhoni named goodwill ambassador for India's first international cycling road race

**13. Who has been elected as the new National President of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)?**

- (a) J. P. Nadda
- (b) Nitin Nabin
- (c) Samrat Choudhary
- (d) Devendra Fadnavis

**Answer: (b)**

- Bharatiya Janata Party(BJP) working president Nitin Nabin has been elected as the new national president of the party.

**14. Who has been appointed as Vigilance Commissioner in the Central Vigilance Commission in January 2026?**

- (a) Shri Sanjay Arora
- (b) Shri Alok Kumar
- (c) Shri Praveen Vashista
- (d) Shri Rakesh Asthana

**Answer: c**

- Shri Praveen Vashista, IPS (Bihar cadre, 1991 batch), has been appointed as Vigilance Commissioner in the Central Vigilance Commission and took oath on 16 January 2026.

**15. Who has been recently appointed as a member of the Asian Boxing Council?**

- (a) MC Mary Kom
- (b) Vijender Singh
- (c) Amit Panghal
- (d) Shiva Thapa

**Answer: (b)**

- India's Vijender Singh, who won a bronze medal at the Beijing 2008 Olympics, was appointed as a member of the Asian Boxing Council, the Boxing Federation of India (BFI) announced .

**16. Consider the following statements regarding astronaut Sunita Williams:**

**1. Sunita Williams' first launch was aboard Space Shuttle Discovery (STS-116).**

**2. She has never performed a spacewalk.**

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- After 27 years of service, NASA astronaut Sunita “Suni” Williams retired on December 27, 2025.
- She completed three missions aboard the International Space Station, setting multiple human spaceflight records.
- First launched aboard Space Shuttle Discovery (STS-116) in December 2006; returned on Atlantis (STS-117).
- Performed three spacewalks to repair a radiator leak and replace a solar power-linked component.
- The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has formally approved the appointment of Ravi Shankar Chhabhi, a 2007-batch Indian Police Service (IPS) officer from the Uttar Pradesh cadre, as Deputy Inspector General (DIG) in the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF).

**17. Who has been appointed as the Vice Chairman and Director on the board of Eternal Ltd.?**

- A. Albinder Singh Dhindsa
- B. Deepinder Goyal
- C. Ritesh Agarwal
- D. Nandan Reddy

**Answer: B**

- Deepinder Goyal has been appointed as the vice chairman & director on the board of Eternal Ltd. (Formerly Zomato Ltd.) He had resigned as the director, MD and CEO of the company.

**18. Who has been appointed as the Commissioner of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD)?**

- A. Ashwani Kumar
- B. Sanjeev Khirwar
- C. Krishna Tirath
- D. Anil Baijal

**Answer: B**

- The Union Home Ministry appointed Sanjeev Khirwar as the Commissioner of Municipal Corporation of Delhi.
- He takes over from Ashwani Kumar.

**19. The Reserve Bank of India has approved the appointment of \_\_\_\_\_ as a Whole-time Director on the Board of HDFC Bank.**

- A. Kaizad Bharucha
- B. Sashidhar Jagdishan
- C. Deepak Parekh
- D. Ashima Goyal

**Answer: A**

- The RBI has approved the appointment of Kaizad Bharucha as a whole-time director on the bank's board.

## Books

1. The book *Premnu Vishva, Vishvano Prem*, released recently, is written by:

- a) Acharya Mahapragya
- (b) Hemachandra
- (c) **Shrimad Vijayaratna Sunder Surishwarji Maharaj**
- (d) Dalai Lama

Answer: (c)

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi lauded the contributions of Jain scholar Shrimad Vijayaratna Sunder Surishwarji Maharaj as he addressed the release of the saint's 500th book .
- **The latest book, "Premnu Vishva, Vishvano Prem," .**

2. The book *Early North India and Its Coinage* has been published by:

- A. Archaeological Survey of India
- B. Indian Council of Historical Research
- C. National Museum Authority
- D. Hinduja Foundation

Answer: D

- Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath released a book 'Early North India and Its Coinage' published by the Hinduja Foundation.
- **Author: Devendra Handa**

3. *History That India Ignored* has been authored by:

- A. Ramachandra Guha
- B. Sanjeev Sanyal
- C. Prem Prakash
- D. Vikram Sampath

Answer: C

- Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant formally launched the new (second) edition of the book *History That India Ignored*, written by veteran journalist and Asian News International (ANI) Chairman Prem Prakash

4. The book *Sing, Dance and Lead: Leadership Lessons from the Life of Srila Prabhupada* has been authored by:

सिंग, डांस एंड लीड: श्रील प्रभुपाद के जीवन से लीडरशिप के सबक नाम की किताब के लेखक हैं:

- A. Hindol Sengupta
- B. Sanjeev Sanyal
- C. Vikram Sampath
- D. Ramachandra Guha

Answer: A

- Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan **launched the book "Sing, Dance and Lead: Leadership Lessons from the Life of Srila Prabhupada" by author Hindol Sengupta .**

5. The English translation of 'Parthibo', titled 'Darling Earth', has been done by:

'पार्थिबो' का इंग्लिश अनुवाद, जिसका टाइटल 'डार्लिंग अर्थ' है, इन लोगों ने किया है:

- A) Prasenjit Saha
- B) Arundhati Roy
- C) Amitav Ghosh
- D) Jayanta Mahapatra

Answer: A

- **'Darling Earth' — the English translation of 'Parthibo' — launched**
- **Parthibo' ,written by Shirshendu Mukhopadhyay, has been translated by Prasenjit Saha**



**6. The book *From Volga to Ganga* (Volvavilurundhu Gangai Varai) was written by:**

- A) Munshi Premchand
- B) M. N. Roy
- C) Rahul Sankrityayan
- D) R. S. Sharma

**Answer: C**

- **BOOK:** From Volga to Ganga (Volvavilurundhu Gangai Varai) by Rahul Sankrityayan (1893-1963) – an eminent scholar, travel writer, and a founding member of the Communist Party of India (CPI) in Bihar.
- **The latest translation has been undertaken by A. Mangai.**

**7. At present, how many languages in India have been accorded official classical language status?**

वर्तमान में भारत में कितनी भाषाओं को आधिकारिक शास्त्रीय भाषा का दर्जा दिया गया है?

- A) 6
- B) 8
- C) 11
- D) 22

**Answer: C**

- **Union Minister Dharmendra Pradhan releases 55 literary works developed by classical language centres**
- **In 2024, the Modi government officially conferred classical language status on five additional languages,** such as Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese and Bengali. In India, there are eleven official classical Indian languages.
- **Six Indian languages —Tamil, Sanskrit, Kannada, Telugu, Malayalam, and Odia—were earlier accorded the status of classical languages between 2004 to 2024.**

**8. Nalanda: How It Changed the World is authored by:**

- A. Ramachandra Guha
- B. Sanjeev Sanyal
- C. Abhay K
- D. William Dalrymple

**Answer: C**

- **BOOK:** Nalanda: How It Changed the World
- **BY:** Abhay K

**9. The book “Chalice of Ambrosia: Ram Janmabhoomi – Challenge and Response” has been authored by:**

- A. Surendra Kumar Pachauri
- B. Ram Madhav
- C. Bimal N. Patel
- D. Meenakshi Jain

**Answer: A**

- The Vice President of India, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, released the book “Chalice of Ambrosia: Ram Janmabhoomi – Challenge and Response”, authored by former Secretary to the Government of India Shri Surendra Kumar Pachauri, at the Vice President’s Enclave in New Delhi.
- 

**10. *Palanivelu GUTS* is the autobiography of which eminent personality?**

- (a) Dr. C. Palanivelu
- (b) Dr. Arvinder Singh
- (c) Dr. Raghuram
- (d) Dr. Naresh Trehan

**Answer: (a)**

- The Vice-President of India, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, released the Hindi edition of ‘Palanivelu GUTS’, the autobiography of eminent surgeon Dr. C. Palanivelu,

11. Who is the author of the book *The Sari Eternal*?

- (a) Shobhaa De
- (b) Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni
- (c) Lakshmi Puri
- (d) Arundhati Roy

**Answer: (c)**

- 'The Sari Eternal', the book by Lakshmi Puri .
- A personalised memoir of her own love affair with the sari.

12. The novel *The Courtesan, Her Lover and I* has been written by:

- A. Jhumpa Lahiri
- B. Anita Desai
- C. Tarana Husain Khan
- D. Arundhati Roy

**Answer: C**

- new novel, *The Courtesan, Her Lover and I*
- BY - writer and historian Tarana Husain Khan

# CURRENT AFFAIRS MONTHLY E-MAGAZINE SUBSCRIPTION 2026

**JAN'26 TO DEC'26**

**Current Affairs + Static Coverage**

- Monthly CA E-Magazines
- Monthly Revision MCQ PDFs
- Weekly Revision PDFs
- Banking CA PDFs
- Daily CA PDFs
- The Hindu Analysis PDFs



## Obituaries

1. Daniel Walker Howe, who recently passed away, was best known as a:

- A. Political scientist
- B. Economist
- C. **Historian**
- D. Sociologist

**Answer: C**

- Daniel Walker Howe, a Pulitzer Prize-winning historian whose “What Hath God Wrought” became a widely acclaimed chronicle of the vast technological and social changes in the US in the first half of the 19th century, has died at age 88.

2. Davinder Singh Garcha, who recently passed away, was associated with which sport?

हाल ही में जिनका निधन हुआ, दविंदर सिंह गरचा किस खेल से जुड़े थे?

- A. Cricket
- B. Football
- C. **Hockey**
- D. Athletics

**Answer: C**

- Former Indian Hockey player, Olympian and **Gold Medallist, Davinder Singh Garcha passed away.**
- He was 74.

3. Ueli Kestenholz, who recently died, was associated with which sport?

- A. Snowboarding
- B. **Alpine skiing**
- C. Freestyle skiing
- D. Biathlon

**Answer: A**

- **Ueli Kestenholz, the Swiss snowboarder who won an Olympic bronze medal during snowboarding’s debut at the Winter Games,** has died after being caught in an avalanche in the Swiss Alps.
- An **avalanche is a rapid downslope flow of snow**, often triggered by terrain, weather, and human activity.

4. G. Rajkumar, recently in news for his contribution to environmental conservation, was closely associated with which campaign?

- A. Save Silent Valley Movement
- B. **Save Kurinji Campaign**
- C. Save Western Ghats Initiative
- D. Neelgiri Biosphere Protection Drive

**Answer: B**

- G. Rajkumar, a bank employee-turned-environmentalist and the driving force behind the Save Kurinji Campaign, passed away in Thiruvananthapuram. He was 70.
- **Fondly known as “Kurinji Rajkumar”.**

5. Madhav Gadgil’s memoir is titled:

- A. Ecology and Equity in India
- B. People, Forests and the State
- C. A Walk with Nature
- D. **A Walk Up The Hill: Living with People and Nature**

**Answer: D**

- Veteran ecologist Madhav Gadgil, known for championing community rights and sustainable development, passed away.



- In 2010, the Union government appointed Gadgil as the head of the Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (WGEEP), later known as the Gadgil Commission.
- His memoir, *A Walk Up The Hill: Living with People and Nature*.

**6. Suresh Kalmadi, who recently passed away, was associated with which political party?**

- A) Bharatiya Janata Party
- B) Indian National Congress
- C) Nationalist Congress Party
- D) Communist Party of India

**Answer: B**

- Senior Congress leader and former Union Minister Suresh Kalmadi passed away in Pune , He was 81.
- He had served as Union Minister of State for Railways and was a former president of the Indian Olympic Association (IOA).

**7. Manoj Kothari, who recently passed away, was conferred the Dhyan Chand Award for Lifetime Achievement in which year?**

- A) 2000
- B) 2003
- C) 2005
- D) 2007

**Answer: C**

- Former World billiards champion and Indian cue sports chief coach Manoj Kothari passed away. He won the World billiards title in 1990 and the World doubles billiards championships in 1997 before being conferred the prestigious Dhyan Chand Award for lifetime achievement in 2005.

**8. Inderjit Singh Bindra, who recently passed away, was associated with which organisation?**

- A. Hockey India
- B. Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- C. All India Football Federation
- D. Indian Olympic Association

**Answer: B**

- Inderjit Singh Bindra, former president of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) died in New Delhi. Bindra served as BCCI president from 1993 to 1996,

**9. Valentino Garavani, who recently passed away, was internationally renowned as a:**

- (a) Architect
- (b) Film director
- (c) Fashion designer
- (d) Perfumer

**Answer: (c)**

- Valentino Garavani, the jet-set Italian designer often in his trademark shade of “Valentino red” has died

**10. S. Siri Jagan, who recently passed away, was a former judge of which High Court?**

- A. Madras High Court
- B. Andhra Pradesh High Court
- C. Karnataka High Court
- D. Kerala High Court

**Answer: D**

- S. Siri Jagan, former judge of the Kerala High Court, passed away. Mr. Siri Jagan was serving as chairperson of the Sabarimala high-power committee appointed by the Kerala High Court .

**11. Father Kunnunkal, recently in the news, was awarded the Padma Shri in 1974 for his contribution to:**

- A. Education
- B. Literature
- C. Social work
- D. Journalism

**Answer: A**

- Father Kunnunkal, a Jesuit priest, a Padma Shri awardee and one of the most influential figures in India's post
- Independence education system, died .
- Best known for reshaping the Central Board of Secondary Education into a national benchmark.
- Father Kunnunkal served as the CBSE chairman from 1980 to 1987.

**12. Michael Nobbs, recently passed away, was associated with which sport?**

- A. Cricket
- B. Football
- C. Hockey
- D. Badminton

**Answer: C**

- Former India Hockey team coach and ex-Australia international Michael Nobbs passed away
- He was pivotal in the Indian team's return to the Olympics

**13. Ajit Pawar, who passed away, was the Deputy Chief Minister of which state?**

- A. Gujarat
- B. Maharashtra
- C. Madhya Pradesh
- D. Rajasthan

**Answer: B**

- Maharashtra's Deputy Chief Minister Ajit Pawar has died in a plane crash at Maharashtra's Baramati .
- In November 2019, he rebelled against his uncle of Nationalist Congress Party Sharad Pawar and took oath as Deputy Chief Minister with the BJP's Devendra Fadnavis

## Awards National

**1. Who was honoured with the Puttanna Kanagal Award for the year 2020 at the Karnataka State Film Awards?**

- K. Shivarudraiah
- Sa. Ra. Govindu
- M. S. Sathyu
- M. K. Sundar Raj

**Answer: C.**

- **Karnataka State Film Awards 2020 and 2021: M.S. Sathyu honoured with Puttanna Kanagal Award**  
The Lifetime Achievement Awards as part of the Karnataka State Film Awards 2020 and 2021 were announced.
- **Renowned filmmaker and theatre giant M.S. Sathyu was honoured with the Puttanna Kanagal Award for the year 2020.**

**2. The International Living Legend Award 2026 at the Kalinga Literary Festival (KLF) is being conferred on:**

- A. Achyutananda Pati
- B. Daisy Rockwell
- C. Ranjana Niraula
- D. Dr. Binod Chaudhury

**Answer: D**

- The Kalinga Literary Festival (KLF) 2026 (January 8-11) has announced a slew of awards, **recognising outstanding contributions to literature, translation, cultural dialogue across India, South Asia, and the world.**
- The **Kalinga Literary Award (International)** will be conferred on writer and translator Daisy Rockwell.
- **The International Living Legend Award 2026 is being conferred on Dr. Binod Chaudhury, at Kalinga Literary Festival .**

**3. The Badalta Bharat Mera Anubhav campaign is associated with which Union Ministry?**

- A. Ministry of Culture
- B. Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- C. Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- D. Ministry of Education

**Answer: C**

- The Information and Broadcasting Ministry has announced the winners of four creative challenges under the Badalta Bharat Mera Anubhav campaign.
- **Indrajeet Subodh Mashankar has won first prize in the Category of Badalta Bharat Mera Anubhav – Instagram Reel Contest, Manthan Rohit received the first prize in Badalta Bharat Mera Anubhav – YouTube Shorts Challenge category.**

**4. The International Living Legend Award 2026 at the Kalinga Literary Festival (KLF) is being conferred on:**

- A. Achyutananda Pati
- B. Daisy Rockwell
- C. Ranjana Niraula
- D. Dr. Binod Chaudhury

**Answer: D**

- The Kalinga Literary Festival (KLF) 2026 (January 8-11) has announced a slew of awards, **recognising outstanding contributions to literature, translation, cultural dialogue across India, South Asia, and the world.**
- The **Kalinga Literary Award (International)** will be conferred on writer and translator Daisy Rockwell.
- **The International Living Legend Award 2026 is being conferred on Dr. Binod Chaudhury, at Kalinga Literary Festival .**



**5. The Badalta Bharat Mera Anubhav campaign is associated with which Union Ministry?**

- A. Ministry of Culture
- B. Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- C. Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- D. Ministry of Education

**Answer: C**

- The Information and Broadcasting Ministry has announced the winners of four creative challenges under the Badalta Bharat Mera Anubhav campaign.
- **Indrajeet Subodh Mashankar has won first prize in the Category of Badalta Bharat Mera Anubhav – Instagram Reel Contest, Manthan Rohit received the first prize in Badalta Bharat Mera Anubhav – YouTube Shorts Challenge category.**

**6. Uttar Pradesh Police won the SKOCH Award–2025 (Gold Category) for which initiative?**

- (a) Emergency Response System–112
- (b) Cyber Crime Reporting Portal
- (c) **Meta Suicidal Alert initiative**
- (d) Smart Traffic Management System

**Answer: (c)**

- Uttar Pradesh Police was awarded SKOCH Award-2025 (Gold Category) at the 105th SKOCH Summit held in New Delhi for the innovative Meta Suicidal Alert initiative of the Integrated Command and Control Center (ICCC) established during Mahakumbh 2025 and the UP Police Social Media Centre.
- **The theme of this year's summit was "Governing Viksit Bharat."**

**7. The 'Sishu Mitra Champion Awards', which recognise outstanding contributions to child protection and child-friendly policing, are instituted by the police of which state?**

- A. West Bengal
- B. Odisha
- C. Tripura
- D. Assam

**Answer: D**

- This was the third edition of the Assam Police Sishu Mitra Champion Awards, a part of the Assam Police Sishu Mitra Programme.
- The Assam Police awarded 21 police officers from across the state for "outstanding contributions to child protection and child-friendly policing".

**8. Which school stood first at the National Level in the 26th National Youth Parliament Competition (2024–25) for Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas?**

- (a) **PM Shri School Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya, Kerala**
- (b) Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya, Gujarat
- (c) **PM Shri School Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya, Rajasthan**
- (d) Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya, Uttar Pradesh

**Answer: (c)**

- The Prize Distribution Function of the **26th National Youth Parliament Competition, 2024-25 for Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas** was held, the 15th of January, 2026 at Mavalankar Auditorium, Constitution Club of India, Rafi Marg, New Delhi.
- **PM Shri School Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya, Suratgarh, Sriganganagar-II, Rajasthan** (Jaipur Region), which stood first at the National Level in the 26th National Youth Parliament Competition, 2024–25 for Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas,

**9. Which of the following indigenous systems have been awarded the SKOCH Award (Gold Category)?**

1. **D4 Counter-Drone System**

**2. Dharashakti Integrated Electronic Warfare (EW) System****3. Akash Surface-to-Air Missile System**

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

- Two critical indigenous systems — the D4 Counter-Drone System and the Dharashakti Integrated Electronic Warfare (EW) System — **have been awarded the prestigious SKOCH Award (Gold Category), underscoring India's growing strength in electronic warfare, air defence, and counter-UAS technologies.**
- The award recognises the role of India's defence research ecosystem in developing strategically significant, operationally deployed, and indigenously designed systems to counter emerging aerial and electronic threats.

**11. Consider the following statements regarding the Tyler Prize for Environmental Achievement:**

1. It carries a monetary award of \$250,000.
2. It is administered by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP).
3. In 2025, the Tyler Prize was awarded to Toby Kiers.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: a

**12. American evolutionary biologist "Toby Kiers" has been awarded the Tyler Prize for Environmental Achievement 2026, often referred to as the Nobel for the environment. which is accompanied by a reward of \$250,000 (€215,000).**

The award recognises her pioneering work in revealing the ecological and climatic importance of mycorrhizal fungi.

**Match List-I (Category) with List-II (Winners) at the 83rd Golden Globe Awards (2026):**

| List-I                                        | List-II                     |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| A. Best Motion Picture – Drama                | 1. One Battle After Another |
| B. Best Motion Picture – Musical/Comedy       | 2. Hamnet                   |
| C. Best Motion Picture – Animated             | 3. KPop Demon Hunters       |
| D. Best Motion Picture – Non-English Language | 4. The Secret Agent         |

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
- B. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
- C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Answer: A

- The 83rd edition Golden Globes returned in 2026
- **Best Motion Picture – Drama:** Hamnet
- **Best Motion Picture – Musical/Comedy:** One Battle After Another
- **Best Motion Picture – Animated:** Kpop Demon Hunters
- **Best Motion Picture – Non English language:** The Secret Agent, Brazil

**13. Which film won the Best Picture award at the 31st Critics Choice Awards 2026?**

- A) Marty Supreme
- B) Hamnet
- C) Sinners
- D) One Battle After Another

**Answer: D**

- The 31st Annual Critics Choice Awards 2026 took place in California on January 4, 2026
- **Film**
- **Best Picture:** One Battle After Another (Warner Bros.) (WINNER)
- **Best Director:** Paul Thomas Anderson - One Battle After Another (WINNER)
- **Best Actor:** Timothee Chalamet - Marty Supreme (WINNER)
- **Best Actress:** Jessie Buckley - Hamnet (WINNER)

**14. Italy has conferred the 'Cavaliere dell'Ordine della Stella d'Italia' on which Indian personality?**

- A. Ratan Tata
- B. Shrinivas Dempo
- C. Nandan Nilekani
- D. Baba Kalyani

**Answer: B**

- Italy has conferred one of its most respected civilian honours, the **Cavaliere dell'Ordine della Stella d'Italia (Knight of the Order of the Star of Italy)**, on Goa-based industrialist **Shrinivas Dempo** in recognition of his services to Italian citizens and bilateral interests in India.
- **Shrinivas Dempo serves as the honorary vice consul of Italy in Goa.**

**15. Who has been honoured as the 2025 New South Wales (NSW) Scientist of the Year?**

- A. Veena Sahajwalla
- B. Nalini Joshi
- C. Manjul Bhargava
- D. Gagandeep Kang

**Answer: B**

- Renowned Indian-origin mathematician Professor Nalini Joshi has been honoured as the 2025 New South Wales (NSW) Scientist of the Year, becoming the first mathematician to receive the state's premier science accolade.
- The recognition was announced at the NSW Premier's Prizes for Science & Engineering ceremony held at Government House in Sydney.

**16. Which Indian Army officer won the UN Secretary-General's Award 2025 for the project "Equal Partners, Lasting Peace"?**

- A. Major Neha Sharma
- B. Major Swathi Shantha Kumar
- C. Colonel Anjali Singh
- D. Captain Ritu Mehra

**Answer: B**

- An Indian army officer from Bengaluru, Major Swathi Shantha Kumar, has won the UN Secretary General's Award 2025 for her project Equal Partners, Lasting Peace.
- **Major Swathi is currently serving on an United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS).**

**17. For what achievement did SVIMS students Sheikh Ghouse Basha and Jangam Shruti enter the Guinness Book of Records?**

- A. Longest solo Kuchipudi performance
- B. Maximum number of dance forms performed in a day



C. Largest Kuchipudi costume display

D. Largest Kuchipudi lesson titles' demonstration

Answer: D

- Tirupati Sri Venkateswara Institute of Medical Sciences (SVIMS) students **Sheikh Ghouse Basha and Jangam Shruti secured a place in the Guinness Book of Records for being part of the Kuchipudi Kalavaibhavam-2** event conducted recently by Bharat Arts Academy in Hyderabad.
- Their names were recorded in the Guinness Book of Records due to their participation in the largest Kuchipudi lesson titles' demonstration, which saw 4,608 participants sharing the stage.

**18. The Ahmedabad International Flower Show recently gained international attention for setting Guinness World Records in which category/categories?**

अहमदाबाद इंटरनेशनल फ्लावर शो को हाल ही में किस कैटेगरी/कैटेगरीज़ में गिनीज वर्ल्ड रिकॉर्ड बनाने के लिए अंतरराष्ट्रीय पहचान मिली?

- A) World's largest flower mandala and flower portrait
- B) World's largest flower bouquet only
- C) World's longest flower structure only
- D) World's largest indoor floral exhibition

Answer: A

- **14th edition of the Ahmedabad International Flower Show – Gujarat**, The event gained international attention after setting two Guinness **World Records for the world's largest flower mandala and the world's largest flower portrait**, the latter depicting national leader Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.

**19. What Guinness World Record was recently achieved by the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)?**

नेशनल हाईवे अथॉरिटी ऑफ इंडिया (NHAI) ने हाल ही में कौन सा गिनीज वर्ल्ड रिकॉर्ड बनाया है?

- A) Construction of the longest six-lane highway in a single year
- B) Fastest completion of an economic corridor
- C) Longest distance and highest quantity of Bituminous Concrete laid continuously within 24 hours
- D) Maximum number of bridges built under a single project

Answer: C

- **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has achieved two Guinness World Records for laying Bituminous Concrete** on the Vanavolu-Vankarakunta section of the six-lane Bengaluru-Kadapa-Vijayawada Economic Corridor.
- The records include around 29 lane kilometre, the longest distance of **Bituminous Concrete laid continuously within 24 hours, and over ten thousand metric tonnes**, the highest quantity of Bituminous Concrete laid continuously within 24 hours.

**20. Which of the following pairs of Jeevan Raksha Padak Award and prize money is/are correctly matched?**

1. Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak – ₹2 lakh
2. Uttam Jeevan Raksha Padak – ₹1.5 lakh
3. Jeevan Raksha Padak – ₹1 lakh

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

- **The President of India has approved the conferment of Jeevan Raksha Padak Series of Awards – 2025 on 30 persons which includes**
- Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak to 06,
- Uttam Jeevan Raksha Padak to 06 and Jeevan Raksha Padak to 18 persons.

- Six awardees are posthumous.
- **Award:** The decoration of the award consists of a Medal, Certificate, along with a one-time monetary allowance: Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak (₹2 lakh), Uttam Jeevan Raksha Padam (₹1.5 lakh) and Jeevan Raksha (₹1 lakh).

### 21. Each Super-100 winner of Veer Gatha 5.0 receives:

वीर गाथा 5.0 के हर सुपर-100 विजेता को ये मिलता है:

- A. ₹5,000, certificate and trophy
- B. ₹10,000, medal and certificate
- C. ₹25,000, medal and plaque
- D. ₹50,000, certificate only

**Answer: B**

- Raksha Rajya Mantri Shri Sanjay Seth and the Minister of State for Education and Skill Development & Entrepreneurship (I/C), Shri Jayant Chaudhary, felicitated the Super-100 winners of Veer Gatha 5.0 in New Delhi .
- **Each winner was presented with a cash prize of Rs. 10,000, a medal and a certificate.**

### 22. The Franz Edelman Award is widely regarded as the:

- A. Oscar of Data Science
- B. Nobel Prize of Operations Research and Analytics
- C. Booker Prize of Technology
- D. Turing Award of Management Science

**Answer: B**

- The Department of Food and Public Distribution (DFPD) is among the six finalists for the prestigious 2026 Franz Edelman Award for its initiative, “Anna Chakra” .
- **Developed in partnership with the United Nations World Food Programme (WFP) in India and the Indian Institute of Technology Delhi.**
- **Widely regarded as the “Nobel Prize of Operations Research and Analytics”,** the Franz Edelman Award recognizes the world’s most impactful, high-value applications of advanced analytics.

### 23. Who is the first and only Indian so far to have won the Wiley Research Heroes Prize 2025?

- A. Randeep Guleria
- B. Chandrakant Lahariya
- C. Soumya Swaminathan
- D. Balram Bhargava

**Answer: B**

- Chandrakant Lahariya, former staff member of World Health Organisation (WHO), has won the Wiley Research Heroes Prize 2025.
- **He is credited to be the first and only Indian so far to have won this International Wiley Prize**

### 24. Who among the following is eligible for the Sukhatme National Award in Statistics?

- (a) Any Indian statistician below 40 years of age
- (b) Indian statisticians aged 45 years and above for lifetime contributions
- (c) Only government-employed statisticians
- (d) Foreign nationals working in Indian institutions

**Answer: (b)**

- **Sukhatme National Award in Statistics has been instituted by Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation** to recognize the exceptional/ outstanding contribution made by the individuals in terms of high-quality research work, to improve the system of official statistics.

- **This prestigious award is given in alternate years since the year 2000** to eminent Indian Statisticians of the age 45 years and above for their Lifetime Contributions and Achievements in the field of Statistics.

**25. The Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT) has been conferred the \_\_\_\_\_ Award-2025 for its Cell Broadcast Solution (CBS).**

- (a) National Telecom
- (b) SKOCH
- (c) Digital India
- (d) Atmanirbhar Bharat

**Answer: (b)**

- Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT), the premier Telecom R&D centre of the Government of India, has been conferred the “SKOCH Award-2025” for its Cell Broadcast Solution (CBS). **The award ceremony was held as part of the 104th SKOCH Summit on the theme “Resourcing Viksit Bharat”.**

**26. Which State has launched the annual literary award “Semmozhi Illakiya Virudhu (Classical Language Literary Award)” for non-Hindi language writers?**

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Andhra Pradesh
- (d) Tamil Nadu

**Answer: (d)**

- A new annual **Tamil Nadu** state-sponsored literary award aimed at recognising outstanding works in major Indian languages other than Hindi.
- **The award is named “Semmozhi Illakiya Virudhu (Classical Language Literary Award)”** and is intended to honour high-quality literary works in non-Hindi languages with a national-level character.

**27. The Padmapani Award of the 11th Ajanta–Ellora International Film Festival has been announced for:**

- (a) A. R. Rahman
- (b) Ilaiyaraaja
- (c) M. M. Keeravani
- (d) Vishal Bhardwaj

**Answer: (b)**

- The prestigious ‘Padmapani Award’ of the 11th Ajanta-Ellora International Film Festival has been announced for this year’s veteran music composer Ilaiyaraaja, in recognition of his unparalleled contribution to Indian cinema.
- **The award comprises a Padmapani memento, a citation certificate, and a cash prize of 2 lakh rupees.**

**28. Who has been selected for the Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development for 2025?**

- A. Ellen Johnson Sirleaf
- B. Leymah Gbowee
- C. Graca Machel
- D. Amina J. Mohammed

**Answer: C**

- Recently, Mozambican rights activist and humanitarian Graca Machel has been selected for the Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development for 2025.
- **Indira Gandhi Peace Prize was instituted in the memory of the former Prime Minister Indira Gandhi by a trust in her name in 1986.**

**29. The Asian Productivity Organization is headquartered in:**

- A. Seoul
- B. Beijing



C. Singapore

D. Tokyo

**Answer: D**

- Bakul Limbasiya, founder of Bhathwari Technologies, has been conferred the APO National Award, recognising his outstanding contribution to productivity, innovation, and leadership in India.
- Asian Productivity Organization is a Tokyo-based intergovernmental body.

**30. Consider the following pairs:**

1. Ashoka Chakra – Captain Shubhanshu Shukla
2. Kirti Chakra – Major Arshdeep Singh
3. Shaurya Chakra – Major Shivkant Yadav

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2 and 3 only

C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: D**

- President Smt Droupadi Murmu has approved Gallantry awards to 70 Armed Forces personnel, including six posthumous, on the eve of 77th Republic Day.
- **2This year, the President has approved conferment of 131 Padma Awards** — 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri Awards.

**31. With reference to the Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar, consider the following statements:**

1. Sikkim State Disaster Management Authority (SSDMA) and Lt Col Seeta Ashok Shelke have been selected for the award 2026.
2. The award carries a cash prize of Rs. 51 lakh for institutions and Rs. 5 lakh for individuals, along with a certificate.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- Sikkim State Disaster Management Authority (SSDMA) and Lieutenant Colonel Seeta Ashok Shelke, **who led disaster relief operations during the 2024 Wayanad landslide** have been selected for the Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar.
- The award carries a cash prize of Rs. 51 lakh and a certificate in case of an institution and Rs. 5 lakh and a certificate in case of an individual.

## State

### 1. Spituk Gustor festival is celebrated in which Union Territory/State of India?

स्पितुक गुस्तोर त्योहार भारत के किस केंद्र शासित प्रदेश/राज्य में मनाया जाता है?

- A. Jammu & Kashmir
- B. Himachal Pradesh
- C. Sikkim
- D. Ladakh

Answer: D

- In Ladakh, the two-day-long annual monastic festival of Spituk Monastery – Spituk Gustor – begins.
- This festival is observed after a week-long period of prayers and rituals in honour of God and Goddess for world peace, prosperity and triumph over evil.
- **Spituk Gustor is the first festival of Monasteries among the 16 monastic festivals observed with different sacred masked dances,** rituals and prayers during different seasons of the year.

### 2. The Zaskar River is a tributary of which major river system?

ज़ांस्कर नदी किस प्रमुख नदी प्रणाली की सहायक नदी है?

- A. Ganga
- B. Brahmaputra
- C. Sutlej
- D. Indus River

Answer: D

#### About Zaskar River

- It is a major left-bank tributary of the Indus River, flowing entirely within the union territory of Ladakh in northern India.
- It drains the remote Zaskar Valley in the northwestern Himalayas.

### 3. The recently excavated Zehanpora Buddhist site is located in:

- A. Kupwara district, Jammu & Kashmir
- B. Anantnag district, Jammu & Kashmir
- C. **Baramulla district, Jammu & Kashmir**
- D. Budgam district, Jammu & Kashmir

Answer: C

- The 2,000-year-old Buddhist stupas and monastic complex at Zehanpora in Baramulla, Kashmir, dating to the Kushan period, have been scientifically excavated.
- **The Zehanpora site is a large Kushan-era Buddhist complex comprising multiple stupas, apsidal chaityas (prayer halls), viharas (monk residences),** urban-type settlements, and artefacts.
- Located along the ancient Silk Route corridor linking Kashmir with Gandhara (Afghanistan–Pakistan region)

### 4. Which Indian institution has been included in the BRICS Network University under the thematic area of

**Sustainable Agriculture and Food Security?** सतत कृषि और खाद्य सुरक्षा के विषय क्षेत्र के तहत किस भारतीय संस्थान को

ब्रिक्स नेटवर्क यूनिवर्सिटी में शामिल किया गया है?

- A. Indian Agricultural Research Institute, Delhi
- B. Tamil Nadu Agricultural University
- C. Punjab Agricultural University, Ludhiana
- D. Banaras Hindu University

Answer: C

- The Punjab Agricultural University, Ludhiana, has been formally **included in the BRICS Network University under the thematic area of Sustainable Agriculture and Food Security.**

- **The expansion of the BRICS Network University was approved by the BRICS International Governing Board in May 2025**, leading to the creation of new thematic clusters, including Sustainable Agriculture and Food Security.
- Notably, PAU is the only state agricultural university from the country to be selected in the network.

**5. The theme of the New Delhi World Book Fair 2026 is:**

- A. India @ 75: Literature and Legacy
- B. Indian Knowledge Systems
- C. Indian Military History: Valour and Wisdom @ 75
- D. Books as Instruments of Peace

**Answer: C**

- The **53rd edition of the New Delhi World Book Fair 2026** will be held from 10th to 18 January at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.
- The **nine-day book fair will attract participation from over one thousand publishers** representing more than 35 countries.
- **Theme** – Indian Military History: Valour and Wisdom @ 75.

**6. Which State/UT Chief Minister recently announced an event titled 'Lunch Pe Charcha' to be held with youth on January 11?**

- A) Chief Minister of Delhi
- B) Chief Minister of Maharashtra
- C) Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh
- D) Chief Minister of West Bengal

**Answer: A**

- Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta is set to hold an interaction titled 'Lunch Pe Charcha', with youth on January 11, a day before the National Youth Day.
- The **event will also feature an open discussion on problems and complaints** faced by young people in the past 11 years.

**7. Consider the following statements regarding the Piprahwa relics:**

The relics were excavated from a Buddhist stupa located in present-day Uttar Pradesh.

They include pearls, rubies, sapphires, and gold sheets.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A) 1 only
- B) 2 only
- C) Both 1 and 2
- D) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- The Prime Minister of India inaugurated "The Light and The Lotus: Relics of the Awakened One", an international exposition of the sacred Piprahwa relics associated with Lord Buddha in New Delhi.
- The **event coincided with the recent repatriation of priceless Buddhist relics that had been taken out of India** during the colonial period and were nearly auctioned abroad.
- **Piprahwa relics were excavated in 1898 by William Claxton Peppé from a stupa at Piprahwa**; they include 349 gemstones, reliquaries, caskets, and bone/ash believed to be of Buddha.

**8. The Delhi government is set to declare which disease as a notifiable disease under the Epidemic Diseases Act?**

दिल्ली सरकार किस बीमारी को एपिडेमिक डिजीज एक्ट के तहत नोटिफाइबल बीमारी घोषित करने वाली है?

- A) Human Rabies
- B) Dengue
- C) Tuberculosis
- D) Japanese Encephalitis

**Answer: A**

- In a significant move to strengthen disease surveillance and ensure timely reporting and treatment, **the Delhi government is set to declare human rabies a notifiable disease under the Epidemic Diseases Act.**



- So far, 20 states have declared human rabies a notifiable disease, as per the official website of the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare's National Rabies Control Program.

**9. The Uttar Pradesh Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 will be held in:**

- A. Noida
- B. Varanasi
- C. Prayagraj
- D. Lucknow

**Answer: D**

- IndiaAI and the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), in collaboration with the Government of Uttar Pradesh, are set to host the Uttar Pradesh Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 in Lucknow on 12–13 January 2026.
- **The Uttar Pradesh Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 marks a precursor to the India AI Impact Summit 2026, scheduled to be held in New Delhi, India from February 16–20, 2026.**

**10. In which State has the Boramdev Corridor Development Project been launched?**

- A) Madhya Pradesh
- B) Odisha
- C) Chhattisgarh
- D) Jharkhand

**Answer: C**

- **In Chhattisgarh, Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai and Union Minister for Tourism and Culture, Gajendra Singh Shekhawat, laid the foundation stone of the Boramdev Corridor Development Project at a programme held at Boramdev Dham in Kabirdham district**
- Under the Central Government's Swadesh Darshan Scheme 2.0, the Boramdev Corridor Development Project will be developed at an estimated cost of around 146 crore rupees, on the lines of the Kashi Vishwanath Corridor in Varanasi.

**11. With reference to the Panchayat (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996 (PESA), consider the following statements:**

1. **The 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992 extended Panchayati Raj Institutions uniformly across India, including the Scheduled Areas.**
2. **The Fifth Schedule (Article 244) provided protection to tribal areas but did not ensure effective local self-governance.**

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: B**

- Jharkhand notified PESA Rules in January 2026, 25 years after becoming a state, extending tribal self-governance to its Fifth Schedule areas.
- **The Panchayat (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996 (PESA) extends Part IX of the Constitution (Panchayati Raj) to Fifth Schedule tribal areas, recognising Gram Sabha as the primary authority over local governance, land, forests and community resources.**

**Key history of the PESA Act:**

- **Colonial legacy:** British laws dispossessed tribes, eroding customary governance.
- **Fifth Schedule (Art. 244):** Protection without local self-rule = weak.
- **73rd Amendment (1992):** PRIs nationwide; Scheduled Areas excluded.
- **Bhuria Committee (1994–95):** Gram Sabhas to control resources & development.
- **PESA (1996):** Legal empowerment via direct democracy.

**12. Bargi Dam is constructed on which river?**

बरगी बांध किस नदी पर बना है?

- A. Tapi
- B. Godavari

- C. Mahanadi  
D. Narmada

Answer: D

- Recently, the National Dam Safety Authority has issued a show-cause notice to the Narmada Valley Development Authority over safety concerns at Bargi Dam.

**About Bargi Dam**

- It is a major multi-purpose dam, serving irrigation, water supply, and power generation.
- It is on the Narmada river.
- **Location:** It is located in the state of Madhya Pradesh.

**13. Which of the following statements regarding E. coli is correct?**

1. It is normally found in the intestines of humans and animals
2. All strains of E. coli cause disease
3. Some strains can cause diarrhoea and urinary tract infections

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- A) 1 only  
B) 1 and 3 only  
C) 2 and 3 only  
D) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B

- More than half of the ground water samples taken from multiple borewells in Indore's Bhagirathpura locality have tested positive for E coli bacteria.

Escherichia coli

- It is commonly known as E. coli, is a type of bacteria that can be found in the intestines of humans and animals.
- A rod-shaped bacterium of the Enterobacteriaceae family.
- Most strains are harmless, but some cause diarrhea, UTIs, respiratory infections, and pneumonia. Spread via contaminated food, water, or fecal contact.
- Disease-causing strains produce Shiga toxin, damaging the intestine → diarrhea.

**14. Consider the following statements about Sagar Island:**

1. It lies where the Ganges River system meets the Bay of Bengal.
2. It is separated from the mainland by an arm of the Hooghly River.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only  
B. 2 only  
C. Both 1 and 2  
D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- Sagar Island, also known as Gangasagar or Sagardwip, is located in the Ganges delta, in West Bengal.
- It is **about 100 km south of Kolkata.**
- **It lies at the mouth of the Hooghly River (a major distributary of the Ganges),** an arm of which separates it from the mainland to the east.
- **Although Sagar Island is a part of Sundarbans,** it does not have any tiger habitation or mangrove forests or small river tributaries as is characteristic of the overall Sundarban delta.
- Situated at a point where the Ganges River system meets the Bay of Bengal, the island is held to be particularly sacred and is a noted Hindu pilgrimage center.

**15. The 'Samridhi Yatra', recently in the news, was launched in which of the following states?**

- A. Uttar Pradesh  
B. Jharkhand  
C. **Bihar**  
D. West Bengal

Answer: C

- **Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar will launch his 'Samridhi Yatra' on January 16, during which he will tour the districts and review the implementation of government schemes.**

**16. The 'Sanskaar Shaala' programme primarily targets children belonging to which age group?**

‘संस्कार शाला’ कार्यक्रम मुख्य रूप से किस आयु वर्ग के बच्चों को टारगेट करता है?

- A) 3–6 years
- B) 6–10 years
- C) 8–18 years
- D) 4–14 years

Answer: D

- Lakshman Prasad Acharya, Governor of Assam, inaugurated Sanskaar Shaala in Guwahati at the Lohia Lions Auditorium.
- The programme is designed for children aged 4 to 14 years and focuses on value-based education alongside formal schooling.

**17. Which State has become the first in India to constitute an 8th State Pay Commission for its employees?**

- A) Tamil Nadu
- B) Maharashtra
- C) Assam
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Answer: C

- Assam became the first State to constitute an 8th State Pay Commission, ahead of the expiry of the 7th Pay Commission on 1 Jan 2026.
- **Headed by former Chief Secretary Subhas Das.**

**18. The financial assistance scheme for celibate monks residing in 'satras' was launched by the Chief Minister of:**

- A) West Bengal
- B) Assam
- C) Odisha
- D) Manipur

Answer: B

- Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma launched a new financial assistance scheme aimed at providing support to celibate monks residing in the state's traditional 'satras' — the Vaishnavite monastic institutions that are key to Assamese cultural and spiritual life.
- **Under the scheme, each eligible monk — referred to as an Udasin Bhakat (celibate Vaishnavite monk) — will receive monthly financial assistance of Rs 1,500 directly into their bank accounts.**

**19. India's first-ever Sunrise Festival, titled "ALO PRABHAT – Dance of the Dawn," was organised in which of the following States?**

भारत का पहला सनराइज़ फेस्टिवल, जिसका नाम "आलो प्रभात – डांस ऑफ़ द डॉन" था, निम्नलिखित में से किस राज्य में आयोजित किया गया था?

- A) Assam
- B) Nagaland
- C) Sikkim
- D) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: D

- **India's first-ever Sunrise Festival in the picturesque easternmost village of Dong in Anjaw district.**
- As the first rays of the sun illuminated India's easternmost horizon, history was made in Dong with the inaugural Sunrise Festival, "ALO PRABHAT – Dance of the Dawn."
- The Meyor and Mishimi communities played a central role in the celebrations.

**20. Which newly formed district is set to become India's first Bio-Happy District?**

- A. Lower Dibang Valley
- B. Longding
- C. Keyi Panyor
- D. Kurung Kumey

Answer: C



**21. Consider the following statements about the Thadou tribe:**

1. The Thadou people share cultural similarities with the Chin-Kuki-Mizo community.
2. Thadou and Chin languages spoken by the tribe belong to the Tibeto-Burman language family.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A) 1 only
- B) 2 only
- C) Both 1 and 2
- D) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- Public broadcaster Prasar Bharati has initiated steps to resume live radio programming in the Thadou language from All India Radio, also known as Akashvani, in Imphal.

**About Thadou Tribe**

- They are an **indigenous people who live in the hill country adjacent to the Imphal Valley in Manipur.**
- The **Thadous are the second largest tribe in Manipur**, preceded only by the Meiteis, or Manipuris.
- Language:** They speak Chin and Thado, which belong to the Tibeto-Burman family of the Sino-Tibetan languages.
- Thadous share a common culture with all the Chin-Kuki-Mizo community**

**22. The theme of Kalinga Literary Festival 2026 is:**

- A) Literature and Civilisation
- B) Literature in the Digital Age
- C) Borders and Narratives
- D) Stories That Shape Humanity: Translating Worlds, Transforming Futures

**Answer: d**

- The **12th edition of the Kalinga Literary Festival (KLF) 2026 to be held from 8-11 January at Mayfair, Bhubaneswar.**
- The **theme, 'Stories That Shape Humanity: Translating Worlds, Transforming Futures',**

**23. India's first bullet train corridor is being developed between which of the following pairs of cities?**

- A) Delhi–Mumbai
- B) Mumbai–Ahmedabad
- C) Chennai–Bengaluru
- D) Ahmedabad–Jaipur

**Answer: B**

- Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw announced that India's first bullet train will be ready by August 15, 2027.
- The **National High-Speed Rail Corporation Limited (NHSRCL) is currently executing the country's first bullet train corridor between Mumbai and Ahmedabad.**
- The first operational section will be the Surat–Bilimora stretch, followed by Vapi–Surat.

**24. The Navi Mumbai International Airport will be named after:**

- A. Balasaheb Thackeray
- B. Gopinath Munde
- C. D. B. Patil
- D. Annasaheb Patil

**Answer: C**

- The **Navi Mumbai International Airport will be named after late D B Patil**, a prominent people's leader associated with farmers' and local rights movements in the region.

**25. The name of Goa's proposed third district, Kushavati, has been derived from which of the following geographical features?**

गोवा के प्रस्तावित तीसरे ज़िले, कुशावती का नाम, निम्नलिखित में से किस भौगोलिक विशेषता से लिया गया है?

- A) An ancient kingdom
- B) A mountain range
- C) A historical fort

D) A river flowing through southern Goa

Answer: D

- **Goa's third district will be named Kushavati, deriving its name from Kushavati river that flows through southern Goa.**
- Goa currently has two districts – South Goa and North Goa.
- **The headquarters for the third district will be located in Quepem.**
- The ancient capital of Goa, Chandrapur or Chandor, is located on the banks of the Kushavati, wherein the Bhojas, South Konkan Shilaharas and Kadamba dynasties ruled from the 4th century to the mid-14th century.

**26. India Energy Week (IEW) 2026 is organised under the patronage of which Union Ministry?**

- A) Ministry of Power
- B) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- C) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas
- D) Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer: C

- **India Energy Week 2026 to be held in Goa from 27–30 January**
- **Organised under the patronage of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and jointly hosted by the Federation of Indian Petroleum Industry (FIPI) and dmg events, IEW 2026 will serve as the first major international energy gathering of the year.**

**27. The Somnath Temple is situated at the Triveni Sangam of which rivers?**

- A) Kapila, Hiran and Saraswati
- B) Narmada, Tapi and Mahi
- C) Sabarmati, Luni and Banas
- D) Godavari, Krishna and Tungabhadra

Answer: A

- Prime Minister of India highlighted the thousand-year survival of the Somnath Temple, marking 1,000 years since the 1026 attack by Mahmud of Ghazni.
- The Somnath Temple is one of the 12 sacred Jyotirlingas of Lord Shiva, revered across Hindu tradition. It is often called the “Eternal Shrine” due to its repeated destruction and reconstruction over centuries.

**Location:**

- Prabhas Patan, near Veraval, in the Saurashtra region of Gujarat
- Situated on the Arabian Sea coast, at the confluence (Triveni Sangam) of the Kapila, Hiran, and Saraswati rivers

**28. Karuna Abhiyan was launched in which Indian state?**

करुणा अभियान किस भारतीय राज्य में शुरू किया गया था?

- A. Gujarat
- B. Rajasthan
- C. Maharashtra
- D. Madhya Pradesh

Answer: A

- **Uttarayan is celebrated in Gujarat during the Makar Sankranti period.**
- Karuna Abhiyan is a Gujarat initiative for animal and bird welfare. Wildlife rescue operations involve veterinarians and trained volunteers.
- Kite strings, especially synthetic ones, pose serious risks to birds.

**29. The mobile cancer screening unit 'Asha Van', inaugurated for early detection and diagnosis of cancer, was launched in which state?**

कैंसर का जल्दी पता लगाने और निदान के लिए शुरू की गई मोबाइल कैंसर स्क्रीनिंग यूनिट 'आशा वन' किस राज्य में लॉन्च की गई?

- A. Maharashtra
- B. Rajasthan

C. Madhya Pradesh

D. Gujarat

Answer: D

- Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel inaugurated a mobile cancer screening unit, 'Asha Van', in Gandhinagar, aimed at early detection and diagnosis of cancer.
- **The Asha Van is equipped with ultra-modern medical technology, including EVA-Pro diagnostics, a mammography unit, and expert teleconsultation facilities.**
- It is capable of screening and diagnosing multiple life-threatening diseases on the spot.

**30.The Bhadrakali inscription is associated with which historical site?**

A. Modhera Sun Temple

B. Rani ki Vav

C. Somnath Temple

D. Dwarkadhish Temple

Answer: C

- The Bhadrakali inscription is a key 12th-century record that confirms the history and development of Somnath Temple and patronage given by the Solanki dynasty.

**About Bhadrakali Inscription**

- **Location:** It is situated in Prabhas Patan, Gujarat specifically on the wall of the Bhadrakali Temple.
- **It was carved in 1169 CE** and currently protected by the State Department of Archaeology,

**31.The Rajasthan Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 will be held in which city?**

राजस्थान रीजनल AI इम्पैक्ट कॉन्फ्रेंस 2026 किस शहर में आयोजित की जाएगी?

A) Udaipur

B) Jodhpur

C) Jaipur

D) Kota

Answer: C

- As part of India's build-up to the India AI Impact Summit 2026, the **Rajasthan Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 will be held on January 6, 2026, in Jaipur.**
- The Conference will serve as a key regional platform to explore **how Artificial Intelligence can drive governance reform, economic growth, innovation, and inclusive development.**
- Held in conjunction with Rajasthan DigiFest × TiE Global Summit 2026.

**32.Recently, the Geographical Indication (GI) tag granted to 'Nagauri Ashwagandha' pertains to which state?**

A. Gujarat

B. Madhya Pradesh

C. Rajasthan

D. Maharashtra

Answer: C

- Recently, the Centre has officially granted a Geographical Indication (GI) tag to 'Nagauri Ashwagandha'.
- It is mainly grown in the Nagaur district of Rajasthan.
- Nagaur's dry climate and sandy soil are ideally suited for Ashwagandha cultivation.
- **It has longer, thicker roots rich in medicinal compounds, particularly alkaloids.**
- Its berries are known for their dark, bright red colour, which is considered a clear indicator of superior quality.
- It has **brittle and starchy roots. The 'Nagori Ashwagandha' is the supreme among all Ashwagandha varieties in arid regions.**

**33.Which village body has become the first in Rajasthan to be certified as fully organic?**

राजस्थान में कौन सी ग्राम पंचायत पूरी तरह से ऑर्गेनिक सर्टिफाइड होने वाली पहली पंचायत बन गई है?

A. Bamanwas Kankar Panchayat

B. Khimsar Gram Panchayat



- C. Bishnoi Panchayat  
D. Mandawa Panchayat

Answer: A

- Bamanwas Kankar panchayat in Rajasthan has become the first village body in the State to be certified as fully organic.
- **Bamanwas Kankar panchayat, comprising seven hamlets in Kotputli–Behror district, has formally committed to 100% organic farming** and eco-friendly animal husbandry, eliminating chemical fertilisers, pesticides, and synthetic inputs from all agricultural and livestock practices.

**34. The primary objective of Operation Smile–XII is to:**

- A) Prevent cybercrime against minors  
B) Track juvenile offenders  
C) Trace missing children and rescue vulnerable minors  
D) Rehabilitate child labourers

Answer: C

- The Cyberabad Police(Telangana) launched Operation Smile–XII, a month-long drive aimed at tracing missing children and rescuing vulnerable minors across the commissionerate.
- **The initiative, launched on January 1, will continue till January 30**
- The police will also use facial recognition technology through the Darpan mobile application to trace missing children and reunite them with their families.

**35. Which State Legislative Assembly passed a Bill removing the two-child norm for contesting local body elections?**

किस राज्य विधानसभा ने स्थानीय निकाय चुनाव लड़ने के लिए दो बच्चों वाले नियम को खत्म करने वाला बिल पास किया?

- A) Telangana  
B) Andhra Pradesh  
C) Karnataka  
D) Tamil Nadu

Answer: A

- The Legislative Assembly passed a Bill to overcome the existing law, enacted in 1994, that disqualifies people with more than two children from contesting local body elections.
- The Bill **supersedes the earlier Ordinance. The new Bill — Telangana Panchayat Raj (Amendment) Bill 2026 — was moved by Minister for Panchayat Raj Danasari Anasuya Seethakka**, who said the time has come to remove the two-child norm given the changes in society and the fall in fertility rate.

**36. The Smart Green Aquaculture Farm and Research Institute with India's first commercial-scale tropical Recirculating Aquaculture System (RAS)–based Rainbow Trout facility is located in which state?**

भारत का पहला कमर्शियल-स्केल ट्रॉपिकल रीसर्कुलेटिंग एक्वाकल्चर सिस्टम (RAS) पर आधारित रेनबो ट्राउट फैसिलिटी वाला स्मार्ट ग्रीन एक्वाकल्चर फार्म और रिसर्च इंस्टीट्यूट किस राज्य में स्थित है?

- A) Andhra Pradesh  
B) Telangana  
C) Tamil Nadu  
D) Karnataka

Answer: b

**India Launches First Tropical RAS-Based Rainbow Trout Farm**

- The Union Minister, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying and Ministry of Panchayati Raj, Shri Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh will inaugurate the Smart Green Aquaculture Farm and Research Institute and state-of-the-art Recirculatory Aquaculture System (RAS) Facility following the General body meeting on 5th January 2026 **in Hyderabad, Telangana.**
- **Situated at Kandukur Mandal in Ranga Reddy District, Telangana .**

**37. The term “Jamma” in Jamma Bane lands refers to:**

जम्मा बने ज़मीनों में “जम्मा” शब्द का मतलब है:

- A. Hereditary land holding  
B. Tax-free land

- C. Temporary land grants
- D. Community-owned land

Answer: A

- Recently, the Karnataka government has amended its land revenue law to modernise an age-old system of land records called Jamma Bane lands.
- The word Jamma means hereditary.
- The **Jamma Bane tenure is a form of land holding prevalent in Kodagu district of Karnataka.**
- **History:** These lands were originally granted by erstwhile kings of Coorg and the British — between 1600 and 1800 to local communities in return for military service.

### 38. Which State is hosting the prestigious national-level SARAS Mela 2026?

कौन सा राज्य प्रतिष्ठित राष्ट्रीय स्तर का सरस मेला 2026 की मेज़बानी कर रहा है?

- A) Telangana
- B) Tamil Nadu
- C) Kerala
- D) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: D

- Guntur, Andhra Pradesh, will host the prestigious national-level SARAS Mela from 6th January to 18th January 2026
- **SARAS Mela are a flagship initiative aimed at the economic empowerment of women SHG members through sustainable livelihoods.**

### 39. Jallikattu is traditionally celebrated during which festival?

- A) Onam
- B) Bihu
- C) Pongal
- D) Makar Sankranti

Answer: C

- The Tamil Nadu government has granted permission for the first Jallikattu event of 2026 to be held on January 3 at Thatchankurichi village in Pudukkottai district, officially marking the beginning of the state's annual bull-taming season.
- The event has been permitted under the provisions of the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960, as amended by the Tamil Nadu Amendment Act, 2017.
- **Thatchankurichi holds a unique place in Tamil Nadu's Jallikattu tradition, as it customarily hosts the first event of every season.** It is celebrated in the month of January, during the Tamil harvest festival, Pongal.

### 40. India's first fully paperless district judiciary has been established in which state?

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Karnataka
- C. Kerala
- D. Andhra Pradesh

Answer: C

- India marked a milestone in judicial reform as Chief Justice of India Surya Kant virtually inaugurated the country's first fully paperless district judiciary in Kalpetta, Wayanad, Kerala.
- **For the first time, an entire district court system has shifted to end-to-end digital functioning,** signalling a transformative change in access to justice.
- All courts in Kalpetta district now operate entirely digitally, with electronic filings, digital scrutiny, and instant access through the District Court Case Management System (DCMS) developed in-house by Kerala High Court.

### 41. The theme of the 9th International Spice Conference (ISC 2026) is:

9वें इंटरनेशनल स्पाइस कॉन्फ्रेंस (ISC 2026) का थीम है:

- A. Sustainable Spices for Global Health
- B. Spice Trade in a Digital World
- C. Spice 360 – Getting Future Ready
- D. One Earth, One Spice

Answer: C

- The All India Spices Exporters Forum (AISEF) will host the 9th edition of the International Spice Conference (ISC 2026) from February 23 to 26, 2026 in Kochi.
- **The 4-day conference theme -- "Spice 360 – Getting Future Ready"-**

**41. Who established the first registration system in India?**

- A) Lord Dalhousie
- B) Warren Hastings
- C) Murdoch Brown
- D) Robert Clive

**Answer: C**

- The **Kerala** State Registration department will observe January 4 as Registration Day every year, with the first State-level celebrations to be held on January 4.
- The **first registration system in the country was established at Anjarakandy in Kannur in 1865** by British official Murdoch Brown in connection with the registration of a cinnamon plantation.
- Records show that the first registration under the system took place on January 4, 1867, prompting the government to choose the date for annual observance.

**42. What is the theme of the International Theatre Festival of Kerala (ITFoK) 2026?**

- A. Theatre and Society
- B. Performing Traditions of India
- C. Silence Speaks
- D. **Voices in Silence**

**Answer: D.**

**43. Himachal Pradesh was officially declared a state on:**

- A. 1 November 1966
- B. 25 January 1971
- C. 15 August 1970
- D. 26 January 1971

**Answer: B**

- Himachal Pradesh was officially declared a state on **25th January 1971, becoming the 18th state of India.**
- **1948:** HP formed as a Chief Commissioner's Province.

**44. Consider the following statements regarding Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojana (MMSY):**

MMSY provides cashless medical treatment of up to ₹10 lakh per family per year.

The scheme is applicable only to Below Poverty Line (BPL) families.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government in Punjab has rolled out the **Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojana (MMSY), a universal healthcare scheme that provides cashless medical treatment** of up to Rs 10 lakh per family per year. With no exclusions, the scheme aims to bring all residents of the state under a single healthcare coverage framework.

**45. The primary objective of Operation Parhar is to:**

- (a) Control drug trafficking across borders
- (b) **Eliminate organised gangster networks in Punjab**



- (c) Counter left-wing extremism
- (d) Strengthen cybercrime investigations

**Answer: (b)**

- Punjab Police launched 'Operation Parhar' to dismantle the gangster network in Punjab to make the state gangster-free. 2,000 teams involving 12,000 police officials have started raids across Punjab .
- **Delhi**

**46. Which of the following is the theme of the 2nd Global Buddhist Summit?**

- A. Buddhism for Peaceful World Order
- B. Dharma and Sustainable Development
- C. Collective Wisdom, United Voice, and Mutual Coexistence
- D. Buddhism in the Digital Age

**Answer: C**

- The International Buddhist Confederation (IBC), in collaboration with the Ministry of Culture, Government of India, will organise the 2nd Global Buddhist Summit (GBS) on 24th and 25th January 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.
- **Theme:** Collective Wisdom, United Voice, and Mutual Coexistence

**47. The theme of PM Vishwakarma Haat 2026 is:**

- (a) Atmanirbhar Bharat through MSMEs
- (b) Skill India for Global Markets
- (c) Vishwakarma Ka Abhiyaan, Viksit Bharat Ka Nirman
- (d) Celebrating Crafts, Empowering Exports

**Answer: (c)**

- The **Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)** will organise PM Vishwakarma Haat 2026 at Dilli Haat, INA, in the national capital from January 18 to 31
- **The theme** "Vishwakarma Ka Abhiyaan, Viksit Bharat Ka Nirman".

**48. Who among the following are recipients of the 'Uttar Pradesh Gaurav Samman' award 2026?**

1. Shubhanshu Shukla
2. Alakh Pandey
3. Rashmi Arya
4. Hariom Panwar
5. Sudhanshu Singh
6. Ritesh Agarwal

**Select the correct answer using the code below:**

- A. 1, 2, 3 and 4 only
- B. 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
- C. 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6 only
- D. 1, 3, 4 and 6 only

**Answer: B**

- The state government will confer the 'Uttar Pradesh Gaurav Samman' award 2026 on six individuals from the fields of music, agriculture and education during the state foundation day .
- **The awardees include :**
  - Five individuals were honoured with Rs 11 lakh, an angavastram, a memento, and a citation.
  - Astronaut and Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla;
  - Alakh Pandey of Physics Wallah for his contributions to education, entrepreneurship and self-reliance;
  - Rashmi Arya for education and innovation;
  - Hariom Panwar for literature;
  - and Sudhanshu Singh for contributions to the agriculture sector.

**49. Which city will host the 86th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC) and the 62nd Conference of Secretaries of Legislative Assemblies and Legislative Councils of India 2026?**

- (a) New Delhi
- (b) Prayagraj
- (c) Lucknow
- (d) Varanasi

**Answer: (c)**

- The state is set to host the 86th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC) and 62nd Conference of Secretaries of Legislative Assemblies and Legislative Councils of India from January 19 to 21, 2026, which is being hosted by the Uttar Pradesh Legislative Assembly at UP Vidhan Bhavan, **Lucknow**.

**51. The 'One District, One Cuisine' (ODOC) initiative was launched in which state?**

- A. Madhya Pradesh
- B. Rajasthan
- C. Uttar Pradesh
- D. Bihar

**Answer: C**

- Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched the 'One District, One Cuisine' (ODOC) initiative in Uttar Pradesh, aimed at giving a distinct identity to the traditional food and beverage specialties of each district, on the lines of the state's flagship 'One District, One Product' (ODOP) programme.

**52. The Sahasralingam, described as the world's largest Shivling, was recently installed in which Indian state?**

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Bihar
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Jharkhand

**Answer: (b)**

- **Bihar's Motihari - world's largest Shivling installed at Virat Ramayan Mandir**  
The installation of the **Sahasralingam**—described as the world's largest Shivling—in Motihari **took place at the under-construction temple complex in Kathwalia village of Kalyanpur block** on Magh Krishna Chaturdashi, an auspicious date in the Hindu calendar.

**53. Which state government has launched the scheme 'Aame Padhiba Aama Bhasare' to promote early childhood education in the mother tongue?**

- (a) Jharkhand
- (b) Chhattisgarh
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

**Answer: (c)**

- **Odisha government launches new scheme 'Aame Padhiba Aama Bhasare' Scheme aimed at providing early childhood education in mother tongue.**

**54. Which country is the focal theme country for the 49th International Kolkata Book Fair?**

- A. Spain
- B. Mexico
- C. Brazil
- D. Argentina

**Answer: D**

- Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee inaugurated the 49th International Kolkata Book Fair.
- **The 49th International Kolkata Book Fair commenced at the Boi – Mela ground at Salt Lake in Kolkata**

- **This year, the focal theme country is Argentina.**
- It is one of the folk dances of the Bodo community, deeply inspired by nature.
- It represents peace, fertility, joy and collective harmony, and is closely associated with festivals such as Bwisagu, the Bodo New Year, and Domasi.
- The dance symbolises blooming flowers and reflects harmony between human life and the natural world.
- It features gentle, flowing movements that imitate butterflies, birds, leaves and flowers.
- **It is traditionally performed only by women of the Bodo community, with the musical instruments being played by their male counterparts.**

**55. Which Indian states observe their Foundation Day on 21 January?**

- A. Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura
- B. Tripura, Manipur, Meghalaya
- C. Meghalaya, Nagaland, Tripura
- D. Manipur, Assam, Meghalaya

**Answer: B**

- **21 January - Tripura, Manipur, and Meghalaya Foundation Day**

**56. Which state government has announced direct procurement of ginger and dry broomsticks from farmers under the Bana Kaih scheme?**

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Nagaland
- (c) Mizoram
- (d) Manipur

**Answer: (c)**

- Mizoram Chief Minister Lalduhoma announced that **the state government will begin procuring ginger and dry broomsticks directly from farmers from February 2 under its flagship handholding initiative, the Bana Kaih scheme.**

**57. Which state is hosting the Namsai–Pangsau PowerDrive 2026?**

- A. Assam
- B. Nagaland
- C. Arunachal Pradesh
- D. Manipur

**Answer: C**

- **Arunachal Pradesh hosts Namsai-Pangsau PowerDrive 2026 to boost adventure tourism**  
The two-day Motorsport 'Namsai-Pangsau PowerDrive 2026'
- **with the theme "Daring to Push Boundaries, Celebrating Culture," began today at Namsai, Arunachal Pradesh.**

**58. Raj-UNNATI is an initiative launched by which state government?**

- A. Gujarat
- B. Rajasthan
- C. Madhya Pradesh
- D. Haryana

**Answer: B**

- The Rajasthan Government's Raj-UNNATI, a new **project-monitoring initiative inspired by the Centre's PRAGATI (Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation)**, an information and communication technology-enabled multimodal platform.
- Raj-UNNATI aims to resolve issues related to important projects, schemes, and public grievances that are stuck for various reasons.



**59. Which state has laid the foundation stone for India's first integrated private satellite plant - the 'Palmnaro' plant?**

- A. Maharashtra
- B. Tamil Nadu
- C. Gujarat
- D. Karnataka

**Answer: C**

- The foundation stone for the country's first integrated private satellite plant was laid at Khoraj in Sanand in Gujarat.
- **This facility, known as the 'Palmnaro' plant, is set to become a premier hub for the indigenous manufacturing of satellites and advanced optical payloads by the private sector.**

**60. Gangapur Dam is located on which river?**

- A. Krishna
- B. Tapi
- C. Godavari
- D. Narmada

**Answer: C**

- **Gangapur Dam**
  - It is an earthfill dam on the River Godavari, near Nashik, Maharashtra.
  - It is the longest earthen reservoir of Asia, with a length of 9.8 kilometers and a height of 36.6 meters.

**61. The MAHIMA agency, recently established to facilitate overseas employment opportunities, was set up by which state?**

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Madhya Pradesh
- (c) Gujarat
- (d) Karnataka

**Answer: (a)**

- **Maharashtra Cabinet Clears ₹4,775 Crore Bembla River Irrigation Project**
- Project is Located in Yavatmal district of Maharashtra.
- **In another key decision, approval was granted for the establishment of the Maharashtra Agency for Holistic International Mobility and Advancements – MAHIMA to provide overseas employment opportunities for the state's youth.**

**62. Fire Dance and Chari Dance are traditional dance forms of which tribe?**

- A. Gond Tribe
- B. Santhal Tribe
- C. Toda Tribe
- D. Lambadi Tribe

**Answer: D**

- **Lambadi Tribe are found in Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka states in South India.**
- They are also known as Sugali or Banjara.
- **Belief System:** The majority of Banjara in India are Hindu; some have combined Hindu practices with their own animistic beliefs.
- Fire dance and Chari are the traditional dance forms of the banjara people.

**63. The Sufi Basant Festival scheduled for January 23 will be held in which city?**

- A. Delhi

- B. Jaipur
- C. Lucknow
- D. Hyderabad

**Answer: D**

- Sufi Basant Festival, organised by the Telangana Arts and Cultural Council, will be held in Hyderabad on January 23.
- Muzaffar began organising the annual celebration in Hyderabad in 2014.

**64. Sammakka and Saralamma are worshipped mainly by which of the following tribal communities?**

- (a) Gond tribe
- (b) Lambada tribe
- (c) Koya Adivasi
- (d) Chenchu tribe

**Answer: (c)**

- Telangana is preparing for the biennial Sammakka–Saralamma Jatara beginning 28 January 2026, **alongside a large-scale redevelopment of the sacred precinct at Medaram.**
- A biennial tribal spiritual festival honouring Sammakka and Saralamma, revered as ancestral goddesses of the Koya Adivasi community.
- **Recognised as Asia’s largest tribal festival and one of the largest human congregations in the world.**

**65. The humanoid robot “ASC ARJUN” has been introduced by:**

- A. Indian Space Research Organisation
- B. Indian Railways
- C. Defence Research and Development Organisation
- D. Bharat Electronics Limited

**Answer: B**

- **Recently, the Indian Railways has introduced a humanoid robot named “ASC ARJUN” at Visakhapatnam Railway Station.**

**66. With reference to Ponduru Khadi, consider the following statements:**

1. It is a handspun and handwoven cotton fabric of Andhra Pradesh.
2. Its qualities were praised by Mahatma Gandhi in *Young India*.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: (c)**

- **Ponduru Khadi of Andhra Pradesh has been granted the Geographical Indication (GI) tag, with the registration awarded in favour of the Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) by the Geographical Indications Registry.**
- Ponduru Khadi, is a famous handspun and handwoven cotton fabric from Andhra Pradesh.
- During the pre – independence era Mahatma Gandhi mentioned its virtues in his *Young India* (the national weekly that Gandhiji edited).

**67. Gruha Lakshmi Digital Marketing is an initiative of which of the following States?**

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Telangana
- (d) Karnataka

Answer: (d)

- Gruha Lakshmi Digital Marketing is a Karnataka government initiative.
- **It promotes women entrepreneurship through a state-backed e-commerce portal.**

**68. Lakkundi, currently proposed for inclusion in UNESCO's World Heritage Site list, is especially associated with which architectural tradition?**

- A. Vesara architecture of Hoysalas
- B. Dravidian architecture of Cholas
- C. Chalukyan temple architecture
- D. Indo-Islamic architecture of Bahmanis

Answer: C

- Recent excavations at Lakkundi in Karnataka have unearthed Neolithic-era artefacts, strengthening the State's push to include Lakkundi in UNESCO's World Heritage Site list.
- **An Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)-supervised excavation at the Kote Veerabhadreshwar (Veerabhadraswamy) Temple**, aimed at uncovering buried structures and cultural layers to support heritage conservation and UNESCO nomination.
- **Flourished under the Kalyana Chalukyas and later the Hoysalas; famous as the "village of a hundred wells and temples".**
- Home to Hindu temples, Jain basadis, stepwells, and later even a Muslim dargah, reflecting religious pluralism.
- Known for the "Lakkundi school" of Chalukyan temple architecture.

**69. IITM Pravartak Technologies Foundation has partnered with which platform to launch AI training for rural school teachers?**

- A. DIKSHA
- B. SWAYAM Plus
- C. e-Pathshala
- D. NPTEL

Answer: B

- IITM Pravartak Technologies Foundation has partnered with SWAYAM Plus to launch Artificial Intelligence Training for Rural School Teachers across India.
- **The 'AI for Educators – K12 Teachers'** (Classes I to XII) Certification Course will start from February 5.

**70. Which of the following best describes the PM SVANidhi Credit Card facility?**

- A. UPI-linked, Fixed-deposit linked loan
- B. Interest-bearing term loan
- C. UPI-linked, interest-free revolving credit facility
- D. Subsidy-only assistance

Answer: C

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi flagged off the newly allotted three new Amrit Bharat Express trains and one passenger train service for Kerala, in Thiruvananthapuram .
- **Mr. Modi has also launched the PM SVANidhi Credit Card, marking the next phase of financial inclusion for street vendors.**
- The UPI-linked, interest-free revolving credit facility will provide instant liquidity, promote digital transactions, and help beneficiaries build formal credit histories.

**71. Which microorganism has been officially declared as the 'State Microbe' of Kerala?**

- A. Escherichia coli
- B. Lactobacillus acidophilus
- C. Bacillus subtilis
- D. Streptomyces griseus

Answer: C



- **Recently, Kerala officially declared *Bacillus subtilis* as ‘State microbe’**  
Bacillus subtilis (B. subtilis) is a type of probiotic (“good” bacteria) found naturally in the human gut.
- **It’s also found in fermented foods.**

**72. The distinctive purple colour of the newly commercialised taro variety “Jamuni” is mainly due to its high content of:**

- A. Carotenoids
- B. Chlorophyll
- C. Anthocyanins
- D. Flavonols

**Answer: C**

- The ICAR-Central Tuber Crops Research Institute (CTCRI) has commercialised a purple taro variety named “Jamuni”; which is characterised by a high anthocyanin content.
- The variety is root vegetable and carries high anthocyanin content, which gives the tubers their purple colour and potentially enhanced antioxidant properties (anthocyanins are plant pigments associated with health benefits).

**73. With reference to the Uttarakhand Uniform Civil Code (UCC), consider the following statements:**

1. **The UCC is applicable to all residents of the State, except the Scheduled Tribes and natives who have migrated out of the State.**
2. **Uttarakhand became the second state in the country and the first in independent India to implement a Uniform Civil Code.**

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- Uttarakhand Implements Uniform Civil Code (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026
- Its objective is to remove ambiguities, align penal provisions with new criminal laws and ensure smoother implementation.
- UCC is for all residents of the State, except the Scheduled Tribes and natives who have migrated out of the State
- Online registration of marriages, divorce and live-in relationships mandatory; govt launches new portal; people can also upload their will.
- Became the second state in the country, and the first to do so in independent India, to implement a Uniform Civil Code (UCC).

**74. The 12th edition of the Smile International Film Festival for Children and Youth (SIFFCY) is being held in:**

- A. Mumbai
- B. New Delhi
- C. Bengaluru
- D. Kolkata

**Answer: b**

- The 12th edition of Smile International Film Festival for Children and Youth- SIFFCY, organised by Smile Foundation, has begun in New Delhi.
- This seven-day event has been organised in collaboration with the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities.

**75. The present structure of the Shri Mahakaleshwar Temple was built in the 18th century by:**

- A. Ahilyabai Holkar
- B. Baji Rao I
- C. Ranoji Shinde
- D. Madhavrao Scindia

**Answer: C**

- The Supreme Court recently did not entertain a petition challenging the practice of 'VIP darshan' at the famed Shri Mahakaleshwar temple in Ujjain, observing that the court is not meant to play the role of a gatekeeper on who enters a temple and when.
- It is a Hindu temple located on the banks of the River Shipra at Ujjain in Madhya Pradesh.
- It is dedicated to Lord Shiva. It is one of the 12 Jyotirlingas in India.
- The current structure of the temple was built in the 18th century by the Maratha ruler Ranoji Shinde.

**76. Which state has declared 2026 as the Year of Agriculture?**

- A. Madhya Pradesh
- B. Chhattisgarh
- C. Rajasthan
- D. Maharashtra

**Answer: A**

- Madhya Pradesh Declares 2026 as Year of Agriculture

**77. The Sunabeda Wildlife Sanctuary, recently declared 'Maoist-free', is located in which state?**

- A. Odisha
- B. Jharkhand
- C. Chhattisgarh
- D. Telangana

**Answer: A**

- The Sunabeda Wildlife Sanctuary in Odisha was officially declared 'Maoist-free' in January 2026
- Established in 1983, it is part of the Deccan Peninsula biogeographic zone and serves as a vital ecological bridge in Central India.

**78. Consider the following statements regarding the Buddhist Diamond Triangle of Odisha:**

1. It comprises Lalitgiri, Udayagiri and Ratnagiri.
2. It has been included in India's Tentative List of UNESCO World Heritage Sites.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- The UNESCO World Heritage Centre has officially added Odisha's famed Buddhist Diamond Triangle—comprising Lalitgiri, Udayagiri, and Ratnagiri—to India's Tentative List for World Heritage Sites.
- The Diamond Triangle is a serial cultural nomination of three interconnected monastic complexes located in the Jajpur and Cuttack districts of Odisha.
- These sites are unique because they document 1,500 years of continuous history, showcasing the transition of Buddhism through three major schools: Theravada (Hinayana) ; Mahayana ;Vajrayana (Esoteric Buddhism)

**79. The Mukhya Mantrir Eti Koli Duti Paat Scheme, recently launched, is associated with which Indian state?**

- A. Assam

- B. West Bengal
- C. Odisha
- D. Jharkhand

**Answer: A**

- Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma launched the Mukhya Mantrir Eti Koli Duti Paat Scheme at Doomdooma in Tinsukia district.
- The scheme aims to recognise the contribution of tea tribes and indigenous communities and provide direct financial support across the state.

**80. Which state has announced the Namolaxmi Scheme for girls' education?**

- A. Gujarat
- B. Madhya Pradesh
- C. Rajasthan
- D. Maharashtra

**Answer: A**

- The Gujarat government announced that under the Namolaxmi Scheme, it will provide financial assistance of Rs 1,250 crore in the 2025-26 academic year to more than 12 lakh girls studying in secondary and higher secondary education.
- The scheme aims to ensure that financial constraints do not prevent girls from completing their education after primary schooling.

**81. Which state has launched India's first dedicated menopause clinics in government hospitals and urban health facilities?**

- A. Maharashtra
- B. Tamil Nadu
- C. Kerala
- D. Gujarat

**Answer: A**

- Maharashtra has launched the country's first dedicated menopause clinics across government hospitals and urban health facilities to address women's physical and mental health needs.

**82. The 'Dhairya Sparsha' initiative, recently seen in the news, was launched in which state?**

- A. Telangana
- B. Andhra Pradesh
- C. Tamil Nadu
- D. Karnataka

**Answer: B**

- Chittoor Police launch 'Dhairya Sparsha' initiative in Chittoor, Andhra Pradesh
- The 'Dhairya Sparsha' initiative, stressing the importance of recognising good touch and bad touch at an early age.

**83. The 4B movement is best described as a:**

- A. Environmental movement
- B. Radical feminist movement
- C. Labour rights movement
- D. Anti-globalisation movement

**Answer: B**

- The 4B movement, a radical feminist current originating in South Korea, has resurfaced in public debate amid renewed discussions on patriarchy, gender violence, and women's autonomy.
- The 4B movement is a feminist resistance framework where women refuse participation in four core institutions associated with patriarchy:



- No marriage
- No childbirth
- No dating
- No sex

**84. The 2026 meeting of the SCO Council of National Coordinators (CNC) is being chaired by:**

- A. China
- B. India
- C. Russia
- D. Kyrgyz Republic

**Answer: D**

- The first meeting of the SCO Council of National Coordinators (CNC) for 2026 opened in Beijing, under the chairmanship of the Kyrgyz Republic, to finalize the agenda for high-level summits later this year.
- The Council of National Coordinators (CNC) is the primary coordination and management mechanism of the SCO.

## Defence

1. Which of the following best describes the Pralay missile?

निम्नलिखित में से कौन प्रलय मिसाइल का सबसे अच्छा वर्णन करता है?

- A) Liquid-propellant, air-to-surface missile
- B) Solid-propellant, surface-to-surface, quasi-ballistic missile
- C) Cruise missile with turbojet engine
- D) Intercontinental ballistic missile

**Answer: B**

- DRDO conducted a salvo launch of two indigenous Pralay missiles from the same launcher.

**Pralay missile:**

- **Type:** Solid-fuel, surface-to-surface, quasi-ballistic
- **Range:** 150–500 km | Payload: 500–1,000 kg
- **Warheads:** Multiple types
- **Developed by:** Research Centre Imarat with other DRDO labs

2. The Close Quarter Battle (CQB) Carbine is best described as:

क्लोज क्वार्टर बैटल (CQB) कार्बाइन को सबसे अच्छे तरीके से इस तरह बताया जा सकता है:

- A) An imported assault rifle for infantry units
- B) A sub-machine gun used exclusively by police forces
- C) A sniper rifle developed for long-range engagements
- D) An indigenously designed and manufactured compact firearm

**Answer: D**

- **The Ministry of Defence recently signed defence procurement contracts worth ₹4,666 crore for the acquisition of Close Quarter Battle (CQB) Carbines for the Indian Army and Navy and Heavyweight Torpedoes for the Indian Navy.**
- **CQB Carbine is an indigenously designed, developed, and manufactured (IDDM) compact firearm. It has been designed by DRDO's Armament Research & Development Establishment (ARDE), Pune, and is being manufactured by Bharat Forge Ltd (a Pune based Indian multinational).**
- **CQB carbines are compact, lightweight weapons designed specifically for urban warfare, close-range engagements and counter-terrorism operations.**

3. The Albert Ekka Brigade observed its 56th Raising Day in which city?

- A) Guwahati
- B) Shillong
- C) Agartala
- D) Aizawl

**Answer: C**

- Albert Ekka Brigade Marks 56th Raising Day in Agartala
- The Albert Ekka Brigade has earned the highest gallantry awards in war and peacetime, including the Param Vir Chakra (1971).
- Recently relocated to Agartala Military Station, from where Operation Cactus Lily was launched.
- 1971 war comprised two major operations — Operation Cactus Lily and Operation Nut Cracker .

4. Samudra Pratap has been designed and constructed by:

समुद्र प्रताप को डिज़ाइन और निर्माण किया गया है:

- A) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- B) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- C) Cochin Shipyard Limited

D) Goa Shipyard Limited

**Answer: D**

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh will commission Indian Coast Guard ship 'Samudra Pratap', the first of two pollution control vessels, at Goa Shipyard Limited, Vasco, in South Goa .
- **The vessel has been designed and constructed by Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) under the two-ship PCV project.**

**5. The indigenously developed Taimoor Air-Launched Cruise Missile, recently in the news, has been successfully tested by which country?**

- A) China
- B) Turkey
- C) Pakistan
- D) Iran

**Answer: C**

- **Pak Air Force successfully conducts flight test of indigenously developed Taimoor missile**
- "Taimoor Air-Launched Cruise Missile is capable of engaging enemy land and sea targets with high precision at a range of 600 kilometers, carrying a conventional warhead,"

**6. What is the maximum strike range of the Suryastra rocket system?**

- A) 120 km
- B) 150 km
- C) 200 km
- D) 300 km

**Answer: D**

- The Indian Army has signed a ₹293-crore emergency procurement contract with NIBE Ltd., in collaboration with Elbit Systems, to induct the Suryastra rocket system, a long-range universal launcher with strike ranges up to 300 km.
- **Suryastra is India's first indigenous universal multi-calibre long-range rocket launcher system, capable of conducting precision surface-to-surface strikes at 150 km and 300 km ranges.**
- It is designed to integrate multiple rocket and missile types on a single launch platform.

**7. A ramjet engine is best described as:**

- A) A rocket engine with onboard oxidiser
- B) An air-breathing jet engine with moving parts
- C) An air-breathing jet engine with no moving parts
- D) A subsonic propulsion system

**Answer: C**

- The Indian Army is set to become the first armed force in the world to operationally deploy ramjet-powered artillery shells for its 155 mm guns.
- A ramjet is a type of air-breathing jet engine with no moving parts, designed to operate efficiently at supersonic speeds. Unlike rockets, it does not carry its own oxidiser and instead uses atmospheric oxygen for combustion.

**8. The Indian Army has declared 2026 as the:**

**भारतीय सेना ने 2026 को घोषित किया है:**

- A) Year of Indigenous Weaponisation
- B) Year of Jointness and Integration
- C) Year of Networking & Data Centricity



D) Year of Artificial Intelligence

**Answer: C**

- The Indian Army declared 2026 as the 'Year of Networking & Data Centricity'
- The Army had declared 2024-25 as the 'Year of Technology Absorption'.

**9. SWaDeS, recently in the news, is related to:**

- A) Renewable energy generation
- B) Disaster early warning systems
- C) Portable drinking water purification
- D) Naval ship propulsion technology

**Answer: C**

- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) has developed a portable water desalination gadget to meet the drinking water requirements of a small group of soldiers in the field.
- Sea Water Desalination System (SWaDeS), can be operated manually or run by an engine.
- Developed by the Defence Laboratory, Jodhpur.

**10. The Long Range Anti-Ship Missile (LRAShM) has been developed by which organisation?**

**लॉन्ग रेंज एंटी-शिप मिसाइल (LRAShM) को किस संगठन ने विकसित किया है?**

- A. Indian Space Research Organisation
- B. Indian Navy
- C. Bharat Dynamics Limited
- D. Defence Research and Development Organisation

**Answer: D**

- India's indigenous LR-ASHM missile will be on display at the Republic Day parade on January 26, highlighting the country's growing maritime strike capability.

**About Long Range Anti-Ship Missile (LRAShM)**

- It is a hypersonic glide missile developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).
- Hypersonic glide vehicles (HGVs) like the LRAShM differ from traditional ballistic missiles, which follow a fixed trajectory.

**11. The national data management platform for improvised explosive devices (IEDs) has been developed by which of the following forces?**

- A. National Security Guard (NSG)
- B. Border Security Force (BSF)
- C. National Investigation Agency (NIA)
- D. Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)

**Answer: A**

- Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched a national IED data management platform created by counter-terrorist commando force NSG.
- **It is the facility that connected the platform, located at the National Security Guard (NSG) garrison in Manesar Gurugram.**
- The platform will collect and analyse improvised explosive device (IED) data gathered from across the country and disseminate it to security agencies.

**12. The headquarters of the Directorate General of Mines Safety (DGMS) is located at:**

- A. Ranchi
- B. Bokaro
- C. Jamshedpur
- D. Dhanbad

**Answer: D**

- The Directorate General of Mines Safety (DGMS) marked its 125th Foundation Day (2026), reaffirming its role in mine workers' safety and welfare.

- DGMS is the statutory regulatory authority under the Ministry of Labour & Employment, Government of India, responsible for occupational safety, health, and welfare of persons employed in coal, metalliferous, and oil mines.
- **Established in:** 1902, making it one of India's oldest labour safety institutions.
- **Headquarters:** Dhanbad, Jharkhand

**13. Operation Hawkeye Strike, recently seen in the news, is associated with:**

**ऑपरेशन हॉकआई स्ट्राइक, जो हाल ही में खबरों में था, किससे जुड़ा है:**

- A. Naval blockade operations in the Red Sea
- B. Large-scale airstrikes against Islamic State positions in Syria
- C. Peacekeeping operations in Afghanistan
- D. Cyber warfare operations against terror networks

**Answer: B**

- The United States and allied forces have conducted large-scale airstrikes across Syria under Operation Hawkeye Strike, targeting multiple Islamic State positions.
- Operation Hawkeye Strike was launched on December 19, 2025.
- Syria Capital : Damascus

**14. The Bhairav Battalions of the Indian Army are best described as:**

- A. Conventional infantry units for prolonged warfare
- B. Strategic deep-penetration Special Forces
- C. Compact, high-tech combat units for rapid response
- D. Territorial Army reserve formations

**Answer: C**

- The Indian Army's newly raised Bhairav Battalion will march for the first time on Kartavya Path during the Republic Day parade.
- These are compact, high-tech combat units, each with about 250 soldiers from multiple arms. Designed for swift, surprise, and high-impact operations.
- They act as a bridge between Special Forces and regular infantry.

**15. The aircraft popularly known as the "Doomsday Plane" of the US military is:**

**अमेरिकी सेना का वह विमान जिसे लोकप्रिय रूप से "डूम्सडे प्लेन" के नाम से जाना जाता है, वह है:**

- A. Boeing B-52 Stratofortress
- B. Lockheed C-5 Galaxy
- C. Boeing E-4B Nightwatch
- D. Northrop B-2 Spirit

**Answer: C**

**Boeing E-4B Nightwatch**

- Amid high geopolitical tensions, the Boeing E-4B Nightwatch made a rare appearance in Los Angeles, sparking panic.
- Known as the US military's "Doomsday Plane", it is among the most secretive aircraft in the US arsenal.
- It serves as the National Airborne Operations Center (NAOC) and functions as a flying command post.

**16. What is the operational range of the Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation?**

- A. 500 m – 2,500 m
- B. 1,000 m – 3,000 m
- C. 200 m – 4,000 m
- D. 1,500 m – 5,000 m

**Answer: C**

- DRDO successfully flight-tested the Third-Generation Fire & Forget Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) with top-attack capability against a moving target.
- MPATGM is a third-generation, fire-and-forget, shoulder-launched anti-tank guided missile system.
- Tandem HEAT warhead: A two-stage explosive first defeats reactive armour and then penetrates the main armour. It has 200–4,000 m range.
- Developed by: Developed by DRDO, led by Defence Research & Development Laboratory (Hyderabad).

**17. MAPSS, recently procured by the Indian Army, is best described as:**

- A. Battery-powered tethered surveillance drone
- B. Diesel-powered long-range UAV
- C. Fully electric, solar-powered unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV)
- D. Hydrogen fuel-based autonomous aircraft

**Answer: C**

- Indian Army has placed a Rs 168 crore order with Bengaluru-based startup NewSpace Research & Technologies (NRT) for its Medium Altitude Persistent Surveillance System (MAPSS), a fully electric, solar-powered unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV).
- The drone is designed to provide long-endurance intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance (ISR), electronic intelligence (ELINT), and communications relay support
- The MAPSS will feature a lightweight construction, solar recharging for long endurance flights, and modular payloads with advanced mission autonomy for operations in GNSS-denied zones—while prioritising persistence without frequent refuelling or landings.

**18. DIME is best described as:**

**DIME को सबसे अच्छे तरीके से इस तरह बताया जा सकता है:**

- A. A battlefield command-and-control system
- B. A pan-Army digital logistics platform
- C. A satellite-based surveillance system
- D. A personnel management portal

**Answer: B**

- **Indian Army has launched Depot Integration Management Edition (DIME), a pan-Army digital platform that delivers real-time visibility of logistic items from units to Army Headquarters, transforming Army logistics,**
- Developed jointly by the Indian Army and Bhaskaracharya National Institute for Space Applications and Geo-informatics (BISAG-N).
- DIME operationalises standardised digital workflows across all depots and units, while equipping commanders with integrated dashboards, exception alerts and predictive stock analytics for proactive logistics.

**19. The RBS-15 missile has been developed by which aerospace and defence company?**

- A. BAE Systems
- B. Lockheed Martin
- C. Raytheon Technologies
- D. Saab

**Answer: D**

- Saab (Sweden) showcased RBS-15 missile's capability to destroy components of Russia's S-400 system.
- **Type:** Fire-and-forget, anti-ship & land-attack (surface-to-surface, air-to-surface).
- **Developer:** Saab Bofors Dynamics.
- The Border Roads Organisation (BRO) carried out a high-altitude rescue and road restoration operation under Project Sampark at Chatergala Pass



- **Location:** It is situated at an altitude of 10,500 ft. in the Baderwah–Chatergala axis in Jammu region of Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir.

**20. Operation Megaburu, a major anti-Maoist offensive, was conducted in which state?**

- A. Chhattisgarh
- B. Jharkhand
- C. Telangana
- D. Odisha

**Answer: B**

- Operation Megaburu, a major anti-Maoist offensive in Jharkhand's West Singhbhum district, led to the killing of 16 Maoists, including top CPI (Maoist) leader Anal alias Patiram Manjhi.
- Operation Megaburu is a large-scale counter-insurgency operation against the CPI (Maoist), conducted in the Saranda forest region, one of the last major Maoist strongholds in Jharkhand.

**21. Which of the following countries participated in Exercise DOSTI-17?**

- A. India, Maldives and Seychelles
- B. India, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh
- C. India, Maldives and Sri Lanka
- D. India, Maldives and Myanmar

**Answer: C**

- India, Maldives and Sri Lanka have launched Exercise DOSTI in Male to enhance maritime cooperation and collective security in the Indian Ocean on January 19, 2026.
- Hosted by the Maldives.
- Exercise DOSTI-17 has commenced in Male with the participation of India, Maldives and Sri Lanka.
- **Frequency:** Biennial (every two years)

**22. The BRICS Plus naval exercise "Will for Peace 2026" was hosted by:**

- (a) South Africa
- (b) Russia
- (c) China
- (d) United Arab Emirates

**Answer: (a)**

- India's decision to skip the BRICS Plus naval exercise "Will for Peace 2026" has drawn attention as New Delhi clarified that such drills are not institutionalised BRICS activities and reflected a considered political choice amid evolving geopolitics.
- The BRICS Plus naval exercise is a host-led, non-institutionalised maritime drill involving selected BRICS members and invited partner countries, conducted outside the formal BRICS framework.
- Host nation: South Africa

**23. INS Sagardhwani was built by:**

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- (b) Cochin Shipyard Limited
- (c) Goa Shipyard Limited
- (d) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)

**Answer: (d)**

- INS Sagardhwani, India's oceanographic research vessel under the Naval Physical and Oceanographic Laboratory (NPOL) of DRDO, was flagged off for the fifth edition of the Sagar Maitri (SM-5) initiative from Southern Naval Command, Kochi on 17 Jan 2026.
- INS Sagardhwani is a specialised marine acoustic research vessel designed by NPOL and built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE).
- Commissioned in Jul 1994.

**24. The Type 096 Tang-Class ballistic missile submarine (SSBN), recently in news, belongs to which country?**

- (a) United States
- (b) Russia
- (c) China
- (d) France

**Answer: (c)**

- China has unveiled the most significant upgrade to its undersea nuclear capability with the unveiling of the Type 096 Tang-Class ballistic missile submarine recently.
- The Type 096 (NATO reporting name of Tang-class) submarine is China's next-generation nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN).

**25. Operation Trashi-I has been launched in which one of the following Union Territories / States?**

- A. Himachal Pradesh
- B. Uttarakhand
- C. Jammu and Kashmir
- D. Ladakh

**Answer: C**

- Operation Trashi-I - security forces intensified counter-terrorism operations in the dense forests of Kishtwar, Jammu & Kashmir.
- Operation Trashi-I is a multi-day counter-terrorism and area-domination operation aimed at tracking, neutralising, and dismantling terrorist groups operating in the forested belts of the Chatroo region in Kishtwar district.

**26. Captain Hansja Sharma has become the Indian Army's first woman officer qualified to fly which helicopter?**

- A. Apache
- B. Rudra
- C. Prachand
- D. Chinook

**Answer: B**

- Captain Hansja Sharma has scripted a historic first by becoming the Indian Army's first woman officer qualified to fly the Rudra Armed Helicopter.
- Captain Sharma recently led the 251 Army Aviation Squadron during the Army Day Parade 2026 in Rajasthan. The formation showcased the HELINA anti-tank guided missile,

**27. Which Indian company is partnering with Shield AI for manufacturing V-BAT drones in India?**

- A. Bharat Electronics Limited
- B. Larsen & Toubro
- C. Tata Advanced Systems
- D. JSW Defence

**Answer: D**

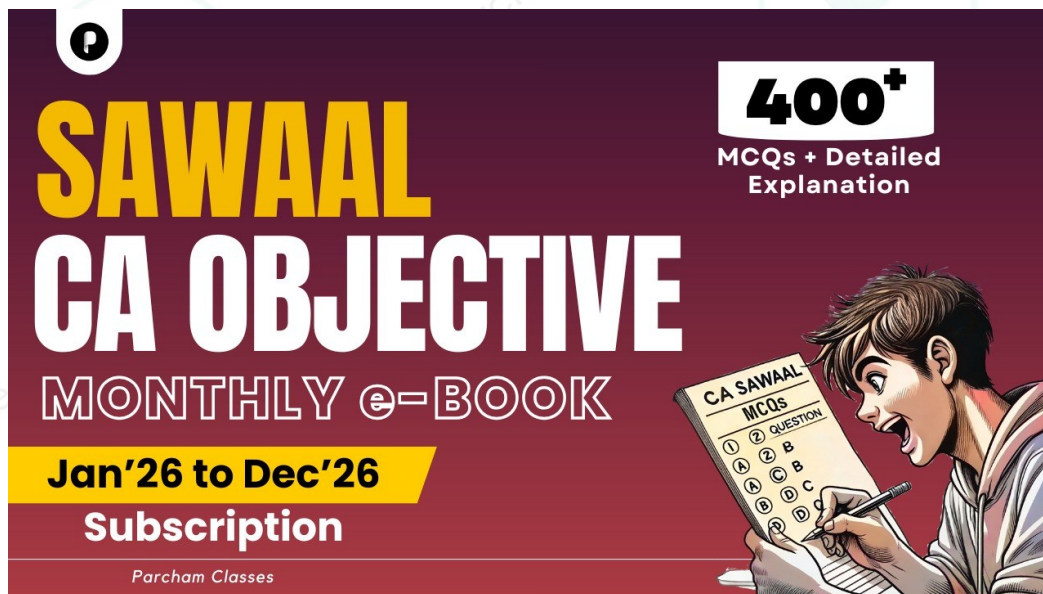
- The Indian Army officially selected the US-based firm Shield AI to supply its cutting-edge V-BAT autonomous drones.
- The V-BAT is a Group 3 Vertical Take-Off and Landing (VTOL) Unmanned Aircraft System (UAS).
- Developed By: Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM): Shield AI (US-based Deep-Tech firm).
- Indian Partner: JSW Defence, which is establishing a \$90 million manufacturing hub in Hyderabad to make India a global production base for the V-BAT.

**28. The Pechora air defence system is designed primarily to intercept:**

- A. High-altitude ballistic missiles only
- B. Space-based targets
- C. Low- to medium-altitude aerial targets
- D. Underwater targets

**Answer: C**

- The Pechora, officially known as the S-125 Neva/Pechora, is a Soviet-origin, medium-range surface-to-air missile (SAM) system designed to intercept low- to medium-altitude targets.
- The system consists of a radar-guided missile launcher and a fire control unit, typically employing the V-600 missile.



The banner features a dark red background. On the left, the word 'SAWAAL' is in large yellow letters, followed by 'CA OBJECTIVE' in large white letters, and 'MONTHLY e-BOOK' in smaller white letters. Below this, a yellow bar contains the text 'Jan'26 to Dec'26' in black, and 'Subscription' is written in white below it. At the bottom left, 'Parcham Classes' is written in small white text. On the right, there is a white box with '400+' in large black font, and 'MCQs + Detailed Explanation' in smaller black font below it. To the right of the text is an illustration of a young man with brown hair, wearing a white shirt, looking at a notepad and writing with a pen. The notepad has 'CA SAWAAL MCQs' and a list of questions with multiple-choice options (A, B, C, D) written on it.



**Science & tech****1. EOS-N1 (Anvesha) is best described as:**

EOS-N1 (अन्वेषा) का सबसे अच्छा वर्णन इस प्रकार किया गया है:

- A. A communication satellite
- B. A navigation satellite
- C. A weather forecasting satellite
- D. An earth observation hyperspectral imaging satellite

**Answer: d**

- ISRO's PSLV-C62 rocket is set to lift off from the first launchpad at Sriharikota, marking India's first space launch of 2026.
- It is a multi-payload mission of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) that will carry one primary satellite and 18 secondary payloads into space.
- It is **ISRO's first space launch of 2026**.
- It is scheduled to lift off from Sriharikota.
- **Primary payload:** EOS-N1 (Anvesha) — a hyperspectral Earth observation satellite developed mainly for DRDO for strategic purposes.

**2. With reference to Artemis II, consider the following statements:**

1. It will be the first mission to carry humans to the Moon's vicinity since 1972.
2. It is a mission undertaken by the European Union.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- NASA is on track to send humans around the moon as early as the first week of February as it makes final preparations for the imminent rollout of its Artemis 2 mega moon rocket.

**About Artemis II Mission**

- It will be the first mission to carry humans to the moon's vicinity since 1972.
- It is the **second scheduled flight of the Artemis program and the first crewed Artemis mission**.

**3. Which of the following statements about Voyager 1 is/are correct?**

1. It is the first spacecraft to travel beyond the solar system into interstellar space.
2. It was designed exclusively to study Earth's magnetosphere.

**Select the correct answer using the code given below:**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: (a)**

- Voyager 1 is expected to become the first human-made object to reach a distance of one light-day from Earth.

**About Voyager 1**

- It is a space probe launched by NASA in 1977.
- **Objective:** To explore the outer planets in our solar system.
- It is the first spacecraft to travel beyond the solar system and reach interstellar space.
- **It is currently the most distant human-made object from Earth.**
- Voyager 1's mission has included flybys of Jupiter and Saturn, with the goal of studying their moons, rings, and magnetic fields.

**13. The Dust Experiment (DEX), recently in the news, is associated with which organisation?**

- A. Defence Research and Development Organisation
- B. Indian Institute of Astrophysics
- C. Indian Space Research Organisation
- D. National Atmospheric Research Laboratory

**Answer: C**

- Recently, the Indian Space Research Organisation confirmed through its first-ever Dust Experiment (DEX) that an interplanetary dust particle enters Earth's atmosphere approximately every 1,000 seconds.
- It is the first Indian-made instrument to hunt for these high speed Interplanetary Dust Particles (IDPs).
- It is the **first-of-its-kind instrument designed to detect such high-transient particles.**
- It is **developed by the Physical Research Laboratory, Ahmedabad.**

**14. The astronomical object nicknamed "Cloud-9", which may shed light on dark matter, was discovered using data from which telescope?**

"क्लाउड-9" नाम की खगोलीय चीज़, जो डार्क मैटर पर रोशनी डाल सकती है, उसे किस टेलीस्कोप के डेटा का इस्तेमाल करके खोजा गया था?

- A. James Webb Space Telescope
- B. Chandra X-ray Observatory
- C. NASA's Hubble Space Telescope
- D. Spitzer Space Telescope

**Answer: C**

- Astronomers may have discovered a previously **unknown type of astronomical object, nicknamed "Cloud-9," that could shed light on dark matter, from NASA's Hubble Space Telescope.**
- Cloud-9 is scientifically classified as a Reionization-Limited H I Cloud (RELHIC).
- **"H I" refers to neutral hydrogen, meaning the gas is non-ionised**
- Located about 14 million light-years from Earth near the spiral galaxy Messier 94

**15. The discovery of the fastest-spinning asteroid 2025 MN45 was made using the first images from the:**

- A. Hubble Space Telescope
- B. James Webb Space Telescope
- C. **Vera C. Rubin Observatory**
- D. Atacama Large Millimeter/submillimeter Array

**Answer: C**

- Scientists analyzing the first images from the Vera C. Rubin Observatory recently discovered the fastest-spinning asteroid in its size class yet named 2025 MN45.

**About Vera C. Rubin Observatory**

- It is located 8,684 feet **above sea level atop the Cerro Pachón mountain in the Chilean Andes, where dry air and dark skies provide one of the world's best observing locations.**
- It is named after American astronomer Vera C. Rubin, who provided evidence about dark matter for the first time in the 1970s.

**16. The W Ursae Majoris (W UMa) star system is best described as:**

- A. A high-mass detached binary system
- B. A low-mass contact binary system
- C. A single variable star with stellar spots
- D. A neutron star binary system

**Answer: B**

- Astronomers from **Aryabhata Research Institute of Observational Sciences used data from Devasthal Fast Optical Telescope and NASA's TESS space telescope** to create detailed light curves of the W Ursae Majoris (W UMa) star.

**About W Ursae Majoris Star**

- It is also known as a low mass contact binary, is a type of eclipsing binary variable star.

- They share a single outer atmosphere and they orbit around each other.
- W UMa stars are easily recognized by their light curves with near equal minima and continuous light variation.

**17. 'Param Shakti', recently in the news as an indigenously developed supercomputing system, was launched at which institution?**

हाल ही में स्वदेशी रूप से विकसित सुपरकंप्यूटिंग सिस्टम के तौर पर खबरों में रहा 'परम शक्ति' किस संस्थान में लॉन्च किया गया था?

- A. Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru
- B. Indian Institute of Technology Bombay
- C. Indian Institute of Technology Madras
- D. Indian Institute of Technology Delhi

**Answer: C**

- Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) launched 'Param Shakti' at Indian Institute of Technology Madras.
- The project has been funded under the National Supercomputing Mission (NSM)

**18. Mission Mausam is being implemented under the aegis of which ministry?**

- A) Ministry of Science and Technology
- B) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- C) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- D) Ministry of Home Affairs

**Answer: C**

- The first batch of these **next-generation stations will be deployed in Delhi from February 2026**, marking a major step towards strengthening India's weather observation and forecasting network.
- The initiative is being led by the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology under the Ministry of Earth Sciences as part of Mission Mausam, a ₹2,000 crore national programme aimed at upgrading meteorological infrastructure.
- **Mission Mausam focuses on eliminating data gaps in weather observations, especially in urban and climate-sensitive regions, to improve forecast accuracy.**

**19. Which company has unveiled the Rubin next-generation GPU architecture and the Alpamayo AI reasoning models?**

किस कंपनी ने रुबिन नेक्स्ट-जेनरेशन GPU आर्किटेक्चर और अल्पामायो AI रीजनिंग मॉडल पेश किए हैं?

- A) Intel
- B) AMD
- C) NVIDIA
- D) Qualcomm

**Answer: C**

- Nvidia has unveiled Rubin, a next-generation GPU architecture and **tightly integrated AI computing platform that is set to replace the US chip giant's current flagship Blackwell architecture.**
- **Rubin is Nvidia's first extreme-codesigned platform and will comprise six AI chips**, alongside various networking technologies and system software, all working together as a single computing unit.

**20. The Mpemba effect refers to the phenomenon in which:**

मपेम्बा इफेक्ट उस घटना को कहते हैं जिसमें:

- A) Hot water freezes faster than cold water under certain conditions
- B) Hot water boils at a lower temperature
- C) Cold water evaporates faster than hot water
- D) Ice melts faster in colder environments

**Answer: A**



- Indian scientists have developed the first supercomputer-powered simulation **that successfully captures the Mpemba effect, resolving a long-standing scientific paradox of hot water freezing faster than cold.**
- The Mpemba effect refers to the counterintuitive phenomenon **where hot water freezes faster than cold water under specific experimental conditions.**
- **Named after Erasto Mpemba**, a Tanzanian student who reported it scientifically in 1969, though it was noted earlier by Aristotle, Bacon, and Descartes.

**21. India's first legged mobile manipulator, SCORP, has been developed by:**

- A. Tata Advanced Systems
- B. Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited
- C. xTerra Robotics
- D. Centre for Development of Advanced Computing

**Answer: C**

- India has marked a major milestone in advanced robotics with the unveiling of SCORP, the country's first legged mobile manipulator, developed by deep-tech startup xTerra Robotics.
- **Incubated at IIT Kanpur.**
- Legged mobile manipulators combine legged mobility with robotic arms.

**22. A white dwarf is best described as:**

- A. A newly formed star with active nuclear fusion
- B. A collapsing stellar core forming a black hole
- C. The stellar core left after a dying star expels its outer layers
- D. A massive star undergoing supernova explosion

**Answer: C**

- It is the stellar core left behind after a dying star has exhausted its nuclear fuel and expelled its outer layers to form a planetary nebula.
- It is what stars like the Sun become after they have exhausted their nuclear fuel.

**23. Karan Fries is a crossbreed developed from:**

- A. Gir × Jersey
- B. Sahiwal × Brown Swiss
- C. Tharparkar × Holstein-Friesian
- D. Red Sindhi × Jersey

**Answer: C**

- Recently, India has registered two high-yielding synthetic cattle breeds namely Karan Fries and Vrindavani.

**About Karan Fries**

- It is a cross between indigenous Tharparkar cows and Holstein-Friesian bulls.

**About Vrindavani**

- It is a blend of exotic breeds – Holstein-Friesian, Brown Swiss, and Jersey – with the indigenous Haryana cattle.

**24. Which public sector telecom company has launched Voice over Wi-Fi (VoWiFi) services nationwide across all telecom circles?**

- A) MTNL
- B) BSNL
- C) Airtel
- D) Reliance Jio

**Answer: B**

- BSNL has launched Voice over WiFi (VoWiFi) services nationwide across all telecom circles, enabling calls and messages over Wi-Fi.
- **Voice over WiFi (VoWiFi) is a technology that allows users to make and receive voice calls and SMS over a Wi-Fi network instead of a mobile tower.**

- It works using IMS (IP Multimedia Subsystem) and uses the same mobile number and phone dialer, without any third-party app.

**25. Nimesulide is commonly used for the treatment of:**

- A) Chronic autoimmune diseases
- B) Acute pain and inflammation
- C) Viral infections
- D) Neurological disorders

**Answer: b**

- **Govt bans manufacturing, sale and distribution of oral drug Nimesulide above 100 mg**
- **It said that the use of all oral formulations containing Nimesulide is likely to involve risk to human beings.**
- Nimesulide is a nonsteroidal antiinflammatory drug which is widely used in the treatment of acute pain.

**26. Mitapivat, an oral pill approved by the US FDA, is associated with the treatment of which disease?**

मिटापिवैट, जो US FDA द्वारा अप्रूव्ड एक ओरल पिल है, किस बीमारी के इलाज से जुड़ी है?

- A) Sickle cell disease
- B) Hemophilia
- C) Thalassemia
- D) Aplastic anaemia

**Answer: C**

- The US Food and Drug Administration's (FDA) approval of the **first-ever oral pill for anaemia in adults with thalassemia mitapivat** (to be marketed under the brand name Aqvesme) for the treatment of anemia in adults with alpha- or beta-thalassemia.
- **Mitapivat is the first medication indicated for both transfusion-dependent and non-transfusion-dependent forms of these rare, inherited blood disorders.**
- Mitapivat is a first-in-class medication designed to improve the energy balance within red blood cells.

**27. Which space telescope has produced one of the most detailed, high-resolution ("sharpest yet") maps of dark matter?**

- A. Hubble Space Telescope
- B. Chandra X-ray Observatory
- C. James Webb Space Telescope
- D. Spitzer Space Telescope

**Answer: C**

- NASA's James Webb Space Telescope have made one of the most detailed, high-resolution maps of dark matter ever produced. It shows how the invisible, ghostly material overlaps and intertwines with "regular" matter, the stuff that makes up stars, galaxies, and everything we can see.
- This is the largest dark matter map we've made with Webb, and it's twice as sharp as any dark matter map made by other observatories,"

**28. A sonic boom occurs when an object travels:**

- A. At subsonic speed
- B. At transonic speed
- C. Faster than the speed of sound
- D. At escape velocity

**Answer: C**

- A sonic boom is a thunderous noise caused by an object, like an aircraft, moving faster than the speed of sound.
- As the object zooms through the sky, the air molecules around it are pushed aside with tremendous force, generating shock waves along its flight path.

**29. Geomagnetic storms are primarily caused by:**

- A. Volcanic eruptions on Earth
- B. Variations in Earth's gravitational field
- C. Variations in the solar wind interacting with Earth's magnetosphere
- D. Asteroid impacts

**Answer: C**

- A powerful G4 (Severe) Geomagnetic Storm, caused by solar activity, has lit up the night skies with spectacular auroras visible across multiple continents.
- A geomagnetic storm is a major disturbance of Earth's magnetosphere that occurs when there is a very efficient exchange of energy from the solar wind into the space environment surrounding Earth.

**30. With reference to the Disobind tool, consider the following statements:**

1. It is open-source and freely available to researchers worldwide.
2. It analyses protein sequences using protein language models.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: (c)**

**Key Facts about Disobind Tool**

- It is developed by the researchers of National Centre for Biological Sciences (NCBS), Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Bengaluru.
- It is open-source and freely available for researchers worldwide.
- It analyses the protein sequences and uses protein language models (a form of AI trained on millions of known protein sequences).

**31. Vitamin A is classified as which of the following types of vitamins?**

- (a) Water-soluble vitamin stored in muscles
- (b) Fat-soluble vitamin primarily stored in the liver
- (c) Water-soluble vitamin excreted in urine
- (d) Fat-soluble vitamin stored in bones

**Answer: (b)**

- It is a fat-soluble vitamin primarily stored in the liver.
- There are two types of vitamin A that are found in the diet.
- Preformed vitamin A is found in animal products such as meat, fish, poultry, and dairy foods.
- Precursors to vitamin A, also known as provitamin A, are found in plant-based foods such as fruits and vegetables.

**32. The chemical formula of Borax is**

- A.  $\text{NaBO}_2$
- B.  $\text{Na}_2\text{B}_2\text{O}_5 \cdot 5\text{H}_2\text{O}$
- C.  $\text{Na}_2\text{B}_4\text{O}_7$
- D.  $\text{Na}_2\text{B}_4\text{O}_7 \cdot 10\text{H}_2\text{O}$

**Answer: D**

- Borax, also known as sodium tetraborate decahydrate, is a powdery white mineral.
- It's a combination of boron, sodium, and oxygen.
- Chemical Formula:  $\text{Na}_2\text{B}_4\text{O}_7 \cdot 10\text{H}_2\text{O}$



**32. The galaxy MoM-z14, recently in the news, was discovered by which telescope?**

- A. Hubble Space Telescope
- B. James Webb Space Telescope
- C. Chandra X-ray Observatory
- D. Spitzer Space Telescope

**Answer: B**

- The James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) has found the most distant galaxy ever observed, named MoM-z14.
- The newly discovered galaxy existed just 280 million years after the Big Bang.
- The solar cycle describes an approximately 11-year cycle of solar activity driven by the sun's magnetic field.
- It is indicated by the frequency and intensity of sunspots visible on the surface.
- Every 11 years or so, the Sun's magnetic field completely flips.
- This means that the Sun's north and south poles switch places.
- As the magnetic fields change, so does the amount of activity on the Sun's surface.
- It can be tracked by counting the number of sunspots.

**33. In January 2026, the Doomsday Clock was set to:**

- A. 2 minutes to midnight
- B. 100 seconds to midnight
- C. 85 seconds to midnight
- D. 30 seconds to midnight

**Answer: C**

- The Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists has moved the Doomsday Clock to 85 seconds to midnight, the closest ever to global catastrophe (January 2026).
- It is a symbolic clock showing how close humanity is to global annihilation ("doomsday"), with midnight representing catastrophe.

**34. Nipah virus (NiV) is best described as:**

- A. A bacterial infection transmitted by water
- B. A fungal disease affecting lungs
- C. A zoonotic virus transmitted from animals to humans
- D. A protozoan parasite transmitted by mosquitoes

**Answer: C**

**Nipah Virus**

- India recently confirmed two Nipah virus cases in West Bengal since December, with health authorities containing the situation amid misinformation and heightened airport screenings in parts of Asia.
- Nipah virus (NiV) is a zoonotic virus (it is transmitted from animals to humans) and can also be transmitted through contaminated food or directly between people.
- Fruit bats of the Pteropodidae family are the natural hosts of Nipah virus.
- In infected people, it causes a range of illnesses from asymptomatic (subclinical) infection to acute respiratory illness and fatal encephalitis.
- No specifically approved treatment or vaccine is currently available for Nipah virus infection in humans or animals.

## Environment

1. The conservation status of the Eastern Imperial Eagle under the IUCN Red List is:

- A) Least Concern
- B) Near Threatened
- C) Vulnerable
- D) Endangered

Answer: C

- **Wildlife enthusiasts recently confirmed the presence of an Eastern Imperial Eagle visiting the Mudumalai Tiger Reserve (MTR) during the winter migratory season.**
- It is a large bird of prey.
- It breeds in southeastern Europe and extensively through West and Central Asia.
- It is classified as 'Vulnerable' under the IUCN Red List

2. Which insect has received the world's first legal recognition of insect rights?

किस कीड़े को कीड़ों के अधिकारों की दुनिया की पहली कानूनी मान्यता मिली है?

- A) Monarch butterfly
- B) Honey bee (*Apis mellifera*)
- C) Amazonian stingless bees (Tribe Meliponini)
- D) Silk moth (*Bombyx mori*)

Answer: C

- **The Satipo Municipality (Peru) has adopted the Declaration of Rights for Native Stingless Bees (Tribe Meliponini) through a municipal ordinance, granting legal rights to Amazonian stingless bees, to preserve Peru's biocultural heritage.**
- This establishes **the first legal recognition of insect rights globally**, strengthening biocultural conservation and nature-rights governance models.

3. Which of the following States recorded the highest number of tiger deaths in India in 2025, according to data released by the National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)?

- A) Maharashtra
- B) Kerala
- C) Assam
- D) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: D

- India recorded a total of 166 tiger deaths in 2025 according to National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA) data — an increase of 40 deaths compared to 2024, when 126 tiger deaths were recorded.
- **Madhya Pradesh recorded the highest number of tiger deaths** at 55, accounting for about one-third of the national total

4. Winter Storm Ezra, recently in the news, intensified into which of the following weather phenomena over the United States?

- A) Tropical cyclone
- B) Polar vortex
- C) Bomb cyclone
- D) Atmospheric river

Answer: C

- A powerful winter storm, Winter Storm Ezra, rapidly intensified into a bomb cyclone over the US, disrupting peak holiday travel with mass flight cancellations, blizzards, power outages, and hurricane-force winds across multiple states.
- **A bomb cyclone is a powerful mid-latitude weather system that undergoes explosive cyclogenesis, marked by an exceptionally rapid fall in central air pressure within 24 hours, resulting in severe and wide-ranging weather impacts.**

**5. Mount Bur Ni Telong, recently in the news due to increased volcanic activity, is located in which country?**

- A) Philippines
- B) Indonesia
- C) Japan
- D) Papua New Guinea

**Answer: B**

- Indonesian authorities recently raised the alert for Mount Bur Ni Telong volcano due to increased activity, including numerous earthquakes

**About Mount Bur Ni Telong**

- It is an active stratovolcano.
- It is **located in Indonesia's westernmost province of Aceh.**
- It is formed by multiple layers of lava and eruptive materials, making it prone to explosive eruptions and highly hazardous.

**6. India's first Urban Night Safari is proposed to be established at:**

भारत की पहली अर्बन नाइट सफारी कहाँ स्थापित करने का प्रस्ताव है?

- A) Chandaka Forest Area, Odisha
- B) Kukrail Forest Area, Uttar Pradesh
- C) Dudhwa National Park, Uttar Pradesh
- D) Valmiki Tiger Reserve, Bihar

**Answer: b**

- Lucknow is set to introduce India's first urban night safari at the Kukrail Forest Area, marking a unique blend of wildlife conservation and city-based tourism.
- India's first urban night safari—a controlled nocturnal wildlife viewing experience within city limits, designed for education, conservation awareness, and low-impact tourism rather than entertainment-driven spectacle.

**7. Calamaria mizoramensis, recently in the news, belongs to which category of animals?**

- A) Venomous pit viper
- B) Non-venomous reed snake
- C) Tree-dwelling colubrid lizard
- D) Amphibious caecilian

**Answer: b**

- A new species of reed snake was recently found in Mizoram, which the researchers named after the state where it was found, calling it Calamaria Mizoramensis.
- It is a new species of non-venomous reed snake.

**8. India has established the world's second National Environmental Standard Laboratory (NESL) at which institution?**

भारत ने किस संस्थान में दुनिया की दूसरी नेशनल एनवायरनमेंटल स्टैंडर्ड लेबोरेटरी (NESL) स्थापित की है?

- A. CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology
- B. CSIR–National Physical Laboratory
- C. CSIR–Central Road Research Institute
- D. Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology

**Answer: B**

- India has inaugurated the world's second National Environmental Standard Laboratory (NESL) and the **world's fifth National Primary Standard Facility for Solar Cell Calibration at CSIR–NPL, New Delhi.**
- **An advanced metrology facility for high-precision solar cell (PV) calibration at global standards.**
- **Located at:** CSIR–National Physical Laboratory, New Delhi.

**9. Storm Gorette, which brought fierce winds, affected which continent?**

- A. Asia
- B. Africa



- C. Europe  
D. South America

**Answer: C**

**10. Fierce winds battered France and Britain as Storm Gorette barreled through northern Europe. Aralam Butterfly Sanctuary, India's first protected forest dedicated entirely to butterflies, is located in which Indian state?**

- A. Tamil Nadu  
B. Karnataka  
C. Maharashtra  
D. Kerala

**Answer: D.**

- The Kerala government has officially renamed the Aralam Wildlife Sanctuary the Aralam Butterfly Sanctuary, making it the first butterfly sanctuary in the State.
- India's first protected forest dedicated entirely to butterflies.

**11. Researchers recently discovered a new species named *Hemileccinum indicum*. It is a species of:**

- A. Bacterium  
B. Alga  
C. Mushroom  
D. Lichen

**Answer: C**

- Researchers exploring the temperate forests of the Indian Himalayas have discovered a previously unknown species of mushroom named *Hemileccinum indicum*.
- It is a new species of mushroom.

**12. Coconut Root Wilt Disease is best described as:**

- (a) A fatal disease causing sudden palm death  
(b) A non-fatal but causing chronic decline  
(c) A leaf-spot disease with minor yield loss  
(d) A soil-borne disease affecting seedlings only

**Answer: (b)**

- Coconut Root Wilt Disease is in the news due to its rapid spread across major coconut-growing regions of Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, affecting lakhs of palms.
- A debilitating, non-fatal disease of coconut caused by a phytoplasma (phloem-limited pathogen), leading to chronic decline and major yield loss.

**12. *Gegeneophis valmiki*, recently discovered by Indian scientists, belongs to which group of amphibians?**

- (a) Frogs  
(b) Salamanders  
(c) Newts  
(d) Caecilians

**Answer: (d)**

- Indian scientists recently discovered a rare subterranean amphibian species in the northern Western Ghats of Maharashtra and named it *Gegeneophis valmiki*.
- The name *Gegeneophis valmiki* honors the historic Maharshi Valmiki Mandir located near the discovery site.
- Caecilians, often called "hidden amphibians", are limbless, worm-like creatures that spend most of their lives underground.
- They look and move so much like earthworms.

**13. The Chatham Islands are primarily of which of the following origins?**

- (a) Coral origin
- (b) Sedimentary origin
- (c) Volcanic origin
- (d) Glacial origin

**Answer: (c)**

- **Chatham Islands**
- It is an island group in the South Pacific Ocean, about 800 km east of New Zealand.
- Composed of 10 islands, they are primarily of volcanic formation, but areas of limestone indicate that they may once have been part of New Zealand.

**14. Tropical Storm Nokaen, locally known as Ada, has impacted which country?**

- (a) Thailand
- (b) Indonesia
- (c) Japan
- (d) Philippines

**Answer: (d)**

- Tropical Storm Nokaen Raises Lahar Risk at Mayon Volcano  
The first tropical cyclone of the year, Tropical Storm Nokaen, locally named Ada, is posing fresh risks for communities around Mayon Volcano in the Philippines.
- Authorities have warned that the storm could trigger dangerous lahars and muddy streamflows
- Lahars are volcanic mudflows composed of water and volcanic debris.
- Mayon Volcano is one of the most active volcanoes in the Philippines.

**15. Iceberg A23a was once the world's largest iceberg by surface area, measuring approximately:**

- A. 1,500 sq km
- B. 2,800 sq km
- C. 3,200 sq km
- D. 4,170 sq km

**Answer: D**

- China's Fengyun-3D meteorological satellite has detected that iceberg A23a, once the largest iceberg in the world by surface area, has entered the final stage of disintegration.
- A23a was the world's largest iceberg by area, about 4,170 square kilometres when it broke away in 1986.
- It broke away from Antarctica's Filchner Ice Shelf.

**16. Indiaphonte bijoyi, recently identified in India, was found in which of the following locations?**

हाल ही में भारत में पहचाना गया इंडियोफॉन्टे बिजॉय, निम्नलिखित में से किस स्थान पर पाया गया था?

- (a) Chilika Lake
- (b) Vembanad Lagoon
- (c) Pulicat Lake
- (d) Kavaratti Lagoon

**Answer: (d)**

- Recently, a microscopic crustacean was discovered in Kavaratti which has been named Indiaphonte bijoyi, with the generic name Indiaphonte.
- It is a tiny crustacean discovered from the Kavaratti lagoon in the Lakshadweep islands.
- **Habitat:** It lives in sediments in aquatic environments.

**17. Brandt's hedgehog is classified under which conservation status according to the IUCN Red List?**

- A. Endangered
- B. Vulnerable

- C. Near Threatened  
D. Least Concern

**Answer: D**

- A new species of hedgehog, Brandt's hedgehog, not so far found in India, has been recently discovered in Jammu and Kashmir, DNA analysis and morphological studies reveal.
- Brandt's Hedgehog : It is a species of desert hedgehog.
- It inhabits arid and semi-arid regions, including rocky deserts, scrublands, and dry mountain slopes.
- It is classified as 'Least concern' under the IUCN Red List

**18. With reference to the Kumbhalgarh Wildlife Sanctuary, consider the following statements:**

- It is located in the Rajsamand district of Rajasthan.
- It was declared a wildlife sanctuary in the year 1971.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only  
B. 2 only  
C. Both 1 and 2  
D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- The Centre recently declared the biodiversity-rich area, ranging from zero to one kilometre around Kumbhalgarh Wildlife Sanctuary, located in one of the most fragile ecosystems of the Aravali Range in Rajasthan, as an eco-sensitive zone (ESZ).
- It is situated in the Rajsamand district of Rajasthan.
- Once the hunting grounds of royals, this area was declared a wildlife sanctuary in 1971.

**19. The term *myrmecophily*, associated with ant flies, refers to:**

- A. Feeding on plant nectar  
B. Living inside ant nests and feeding on ant brood  
C. Migratory behaviour  
D. Parasitising plants

**Answer: B**

- Researchers have discovered two new, extremely rare ant fly species from Delhi and the Western Ghats, underscoring the hidden biodiversity of urban forests and biodiversity hotspots.
- Ant flies belong to the subfamily Microdontinae (family Syrphidae) and are renowned for myrmecophily—their larvae live inside ant nests and feed on ant brood. This specialised ecology makes them exceptionally rare and hard to detect.

**20. The second range-wide Dolphin Survey under Project Dolphin was launched from:**

- (a) Patna, Bihar  
(b) Guwahati, Assam  
(c) Bijpur, Uttar Pradesh  
(d) Kolkata, West Bengal

**Answer: (c)**

- The second range-wide Dolphin Survey has been launched from Bijpur, Uttar Pradesh under Project Dolphin to update population estimates, assess habitats and threats.
- A pan-India scientific estimation exercise to assess population, distribution, habitat condition and threats to riverine and estuarine dolphins, conducted in two phases across major river systems and coastal/estuarine stretches.

**21. The "30 by 30" target under the Biodiversity Beyond National Jurisdiction (BBNJ) Treaty refers to:**

- (a) Reducing marine pollution by 30% by 2030  
(b) Restoring 30% of coral reefs by 2030



(c) Protecting 30% of the global ocean area by 2030

(d) Ensuring 30 maritime treaties by 2030

**Answer: (c)**

- The UN Biodiversity Beyond National Jurisdiction (BBNJ) Treaty, also known as the High Seas Treaty, has entered into force after crossing the required 60 ratifications, creating the first legally binding global framework to protect biodiversity in international waters.
- The BBNJ Agreement is a legally binding international treaty under the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) to conserve and sustainably use marine biodiversity in areas beyond national jurisdiction (the High Seas).
- Achieve the “30 by 30” goal: protect 30% of the global ocean area by 2030.
- Enable large-scale conservation across two-thirds of the ocean, which lies beyond national control.

**22. What is the IUCN Red List status of the Indian Skimmer?**

(a) Endangered

(b) Near Threatened

(c) Vulnerable

(d) Critically Endangered

**Answer: (a)**

**Indian Skimmer**

- The Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS) and the National Mission for Clean Ganga (NMCG) have launched a new conservation project to protect the endangered Indian Skimmer and its breeding habitats across the Ganga Basin.
- The Indian Skimmer (*Rynchops albicollis*) is a riverine bird species known for its unique feeding behaviour of skimming the water surface with an elongated lower mandible to catch fish.
- IUCN status: Endangered (EN) on the IUCN Red List

**23. The Striped Tiger Butterfly has been designated as the State Butterfly of which Union Territory?**

(a) Chandigarh

(b) Puducherry

(c) Delhi

(d) Jammu and Kashmir

**Answer: (a)**

- The State Board of Wildlife (SBWL) declared the Striped Tiger Butterfly as the State Butterfly of Chandigarh

**24. The Arabian Sea is best described as**

A. A marginal sea of the Pacific Ocean

B. A northeastern extension of the Atlantic Ocean

C. A northwestern arm of the Indian Ocean

D. An enclosed inland sea between Africa and Asia

**Answer: C**

- The Arabian Sea is a northwestern arm of the Indian Ocean, forming a crucial maritime space linking Europe, West Asia, Africa, and South Asia, and serving as one of the world's busiest sea routes.
- Bordering nations:
- India, Pakistan, Iran, Oman, Yemen, and Somalia.
- Connected to the Persian Gulf via the Strait of Hormuz and to the Red Sea via the Bab-el-Mandeb Strait.

**25. The cold winter storm 'Fern' over the United States is driven by a surge of which type of air mass?**

A. Tropical maritime air

B. Continental tropical air

C. Arctic air

D. Equatorial maritime air

**Answer: C**

- The storm is being driven by a powerful surge of Arctic air arriving during what is typically the coldest time of the year.
- Several states have already declared emergencies ahead of the storm.

**26. Pangolakha Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which Indian state?**

- A. Arunachal Pradesh
- B. West Bengal
- C. Assam
- D. Sikkim

**Answer: D**

- Recently, a forest fire continued to rage inside Sikkim's Pangolakha Wildlife Sanctuary along the Indo-China border at an altitude of 13,000 feet.
- Location: It is located in the state of Sikkim.

**27. According to the IUCN Red List, the conservation status of Gharial is:**

- A. Vulnerable
- B. Endangered
- C. Critically Endangered
- D. Near Threatened

**Answer: C**

- Key Facts about Gharial
- It is a freshwater crocodile.
- The name 'gharial' comes from the Hindi word ghara, meaning pot or vessel, referring to the bulbous snout tip of adult males, which resembles an inverted pot.
- Historically, the gharial's range spanned rivers of Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal and Pakistan.
- IUCN Red List: Critically Endangered.

**28. Hoya nagaensis was discovered in which type of ecosystem?**

- A. Coastal mangrove forests
- B. Desert scrubland
- C. High-altitude forests
- D. Tropical coral islands

**Answer: C**

- Recently, a new plant species has been discovered in Nagaland and it's named as Hoya Nagaensis.
- It is a new plant species found in the high-altitude forests of Nagaland.
- It is a member of the 'wax plant family' discovered in the Kavunhou Community Reserved Forest in Phek district.

**29. Lonar Lake, India's only basaltic meteor impact crater, is located in which district of Maharashtra?**

- A. Nagpur
- B. Chandrapur
- C. Buldhana
- D. Jalgaon

**Answer: C**

- India's only basaltic meteor impact crater, Lonar lake in Maharashtra's Buldhana district, is facing an environmental crisis
- It was created due to a meteorite.

**30. With reference to Kyasanur Forest Disease (KFD), consider the following statements:**

1. KFD is transmitted to humans through tick bites and is viral in nature.
2. KFD can be spread directly from one infected person to another.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only  
B. 2 only  
C. Both 1 and 2  
D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- Kyasanur Forest Disease - It is a tick-borne viral haemorrhagic disease mostly found in southern India.
- The causal agent, KFD Virus (family Flaviviridae, genus Flavivirus), is a member of the tick-borne encephalitis (TBE) complex.
- KFD does not spread between people.

**31. The IUCN conservation status of Indo-Pacific leopard sharks is:**

- A. Least Concern  
B. Near Threatened  
C. Vulnerable  
D. Endangered

**Answer: D**



## National

1. The mascot “सांख्यिकी” has been recently introduced by which of the following Ministries of the Government of India?

भारत सरकार के निम्नलिखित में से किस मंत्रालय ने हाल ही में "सांख्यिकी" नामक मैस्कॉट पेश किया है?

- A) Ministry of Finance
- B) Ministry of Education
- C) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- D) Ministry of Information and Broadcasting

**Answer: C**

- **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation launches new logo and mascot**
- New logo:
- Ashoka Chakra symbolising truth, transparency, and good governance.
- Mascot – “सांख्यिकी”:
- Citizen-centric character designed to simplify complex statistical concepts.
- To be used across surveys, awareness campaigns, educational initiatives, digital platforms, and public events.

2. Which of the following animals will be part of the Indian Army’s animal contingent at the Republic Day Parade 2026?

- 1. Bactrian camels
- 2. Zanskar ponies
- 3. Army dogs
- 4. Elephants

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- A) 1, 2 and 3 only
- B) 1 and 4 only
- C) 2 and 3 only
- D) 1, 2, 3 and 4

- **Answer: A**
- **For the first time, the Indian Army’s animal contingent will march on Kartavya Path in the national capital during the Republic Day Parade 2026.**
- **The contingent will feature two Bactrian camels, four Zanskar ponies, four raptors, 10 Indian-breed Army dogs, along with six conventional military dogs currently in service.**
- **A major highlight of the parade will be the Army dogs, often referred to as the “Silent Warriors” of the Indian Army.**

3. The Union Government has launched an integrated e-Bill System primarily to digitally process subsidies related to which sector?

केंद्र सरकार ने मुख्य रूप से किस सेक्टर से संबंधित सब्सिडी को डिजिटली प्रोसेस करने के लिए एक इंटीग्रेटेड ई-बिल सिस्टम लॉन्च किया है?

- A) Fertilisers
- B) Petroleum
- C) Food grains
- D) Power

**Answer: A**

- The Union Government has launched an integrated e-Bill System to digitally process fertiliser subsidies worth about ₹2 lakh crore.
- The e-Bill System is an end-to-end digital platform for submission, processing, tracking, and payment of fertiliser subsidy bills, replacing the earlier manual, paper-based workflow.

4. With reference to the Battery Pack Aadhaar Number (BPAN), consider the following statements:

- 1. It is a 21-character unique identification number.

**2. It is linked with a QR code.**

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A) 1 only
- B) 2 only
- C) Both 1 and 2
- D) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- Recently, the central government has released draft guidelines for a Battery Pack Aadhaar system.
- It is an indigenous digital identification and data storage system developed to ensure end-to-end traceability of batteries throughout their entire lifecycle.
- The battery producer or importer shall have the **obligation of assigning a unique Battery Pack Aadhaar Number (BPAN) to each battery** that they introduce in the market and the battery they put to self-use.
- Every Electric Vehicle battery pack and industrial battery above 2 kWh will be assigned a 21 character Battery Pack Aadhaar Number, or BPAN, along with a QR code.

**5. PRAGATI, recently in the news, is best described as which of the following?**

- A) A statutory authority for land acquisition
- B) A centralised ICT-enabled platform for real-time project monitoring
- C) A State-level grievance redressal mechanism
- D) A parliamentary committee on infrastructure

**Answer: B**

- **Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation (PRAGATI)**
- **Land acquisition has emerged as the single largest bottleneck in infrastructure development**, accounting for 35% of project delays, the Cabinet Secretary said after the 50th PRAGATI meeting.
- PRAGATI is a centralised, ICT-enabled governance platform for grievance redressal, programme implementation, and project monitoring, enabling real-time review of projects of national importance.

**6. The primary objective of the Rah-Veer Scheme is to:**

- A) Compensate road accident victims
- B) Improve trauma care infrastructure
- C) Encourage bystanders to help accident victims without fear of harassment
- D) Reduce insurance fraud

**Answer: C**

- The **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways reiterated protections and incentives under the Rah-Veer (Good Samaritan) Scheme** to encourage bystanders to help road accident victims without fear of legal or procedural harassment.
- Rah-Veer is a **Good Samaritan initiative notified under Section 134A of the Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019**, protecting citizens who help road accident victims during the Golden Hour from legal, police, or hospital-related harassment.

**7. Which ministry is responsible for the execution of the Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY)?**

- A) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- B) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- C) Ministry of Rural Development
- D) Ministry of Women and Child Development

**Answer: D**

- The Government of India is implementing the Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY) with effect from 1st January 2017.
- It is **executed by the Ministry of Women and Child Development**
- It is a **centrally sponsored scheme under Mission Shakti's sub-scheme 'Samarthya'**, providing direct financial assistance through the Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) mode.
- It is designed to support pregnant women and lactating mothers.

8. The headquarters of the Bureau of Indian Standards is located at:

- A) Mumbai
- B) Kolkata
- C) Chennai
- D) New Delhi

Answer: D

- **The 79th Foundation Day of the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) was celebrated**, where Union Minister highlighted BIS's shift from a regulatory to a facilitative approach, aligned with ease of doing business and quality culture.
- BIS is India's National Standards Body, responsible for standardisation, certification, hallmarking, and quality assurance of goods and services to protect consumers and enhance global competitiveness.
- **Established in:** 1987 (came into force on 1 April 1987)
- **Headquarters:** New Delhi

9. Indian Railways has become the world's largest electrified rail network by electrifying approximately what percentage of its broad-gauge network (as of November 2025)?

- A) 90%
- B) 95%
- C) 97.5%
- D) 99.2%

Answer: D

- **Indian Railways has become the largest electrified rail network in the world, with about 99.2% of its broad-gauge network electrified by November 2025.**
- Indian Railways is India's national transporter, operating one of the world's largest rail networks.
- **Initiative under:** Mission 100% Railway Electrification
- **Launched in:** The electrification drive began historically in 1925, but Mission-mode acceleration was undertaken post-2014.
- 99.2% rail electrification (~70,000 km); 25 States/UTs covered

10. India's first hydrogen-powered train has been developed by:

भारत की पहली हाइड्रोजन से चलने वाली ट्रेन किसके द्वारा विकसित की गई है?

- A. Chittaranjan Locomotive Works
- B. Rail Coach Factory
- C. Integral Coach Factory
- D. Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited

Answer: C

- The trial run of India's first hydrogen-powered train has commenced, with testing being carried out by the Research Designs & Standards Organisation (RDSO).
- **Developed by Chennai-based Integral Coach Factory (ICF).**
- The trial run of the hydrogen-powered train is being conducted on the Jind–Sonipat section of the Northern Railway.

11. PANKHUDI is an initiative launched by which ministry?

पंखुड़ी किस मंत्रालय द्वारा शुरू की गई एक पहल है?

- A. Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- B. Ministry of Corporate Affairs
- C. Ministry of Women and Child Development
- D. Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Answer: C



- The Ministry of Women and Child Development launched PANKHUDI, an integrated digital portal designed to streamline Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) and partnership initiatives focused on women and child development.
- The **portal aims to consolidate contributions and collaborations from NGOs, companies, CSR contributors, NRIs, government agencies and individuals working in areas such as nutrition, health, early childhood care and education, child welfare, rehabilitation, women's safety and empowerment.**

**12. Which country has recently become the first in the world to commercially produce bio-bitumen for road construction?**

हाल ही में कौन सा देश सड़क निर्माण के लिए बायो-बिटुमेन का कमर्शियल प्रोडक्शन करने वाला दुनिया का पहला देश बन गया है?

- A. Germany
- B. Japan
- C. United States of America
- D. India

Answer: D

- India has **become the first country** to commercially produce bio-bitumen for road construction, marking a global milestone in green infrastructure.
- **Bio-bitumen is a bio-based alternative to conventional petroleum bitumen, used as a binder in road construction.**
- It is produced from agricultural residues (especially rice straw) and can partially replace fossil-fuel-derived bitumen without compromising road performance.

**13. The India International Conference on Democracy and Election Management (IICDEM)–2026 will be held from:**

- A. January 18–20, 2026
- B. January 20–22, 2026
- C. January 21–23, 2026
- D. January 24–26, 2026

Answer: C

- The Election Commission of India (ECI) **will host the inaugural India International Conference on Democracy and Election Management (IICDEM)-2026 from 21st to 23rd January, 2026** at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.
- The **three-day international conference is being organised by India International Institute of Democracy and Election Management (IIIDEM) under the aegis of ECI.**

**14. What is the name of the official mascot launched by the Unique Identification Authority of India?**

यूनिक आइडेंटिफिकेशन अथॉरिटी ऑफ इंडिया द्वारा लॉन्च किए गए ऑफिशियल मैस्कॉट का नाम क्या है?

- A. Udaan
- B. Aaditya
- C. Aadit
- D. Udai

Answer: D

- The **Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) has launched Aadhaar mascot 'Udai (उदय)'** to make Aadhaar-related information more relatable and people-friendly.
- A resident-facing communication companion (official mascot) designed to simplify public understanding of Aadhaar services such as updates, authentication, offline verification, selective data sharing, and responsible usage.

**15. Where will the Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative–2026 be held?**

- A. Mumbai
- B. Bengaluru

C. Hyderabad

D. New Delhi

Answer: D

#### India Launches Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative 2026

- **The Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India (OPSA) and the Observer Research Foundation (ORF)** have announced a partnership for the inaugural edition of the Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative (2026).
- **The Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative is scheduled to be held alongside the Raisina Dialogue from 5–7 March 2026 in New Delhi.**
- The SDI initiative aims to create a dedicated platform within the Raisina Dialogue to deliberate on the intersection of science, technology, and diplomacy.
- **The initiative marks a new institutional effort to embed science diplomacy within India's flagship geopolitical dialogue framework**, reflecting the growing strategic importance of science and technology in international relations.

#### 16. Who will be the Chief Guests at India's 77th Republic Day celebrations in 2026?

2026 में भारत के 77वें गणतंत्र दिवस समारोह में मुख्य अतिथि कौन होंगे?

A. Emmanuel Macron and Olaf Scholz

B. Roberta Metsola and Josep Borrell

C. António Luís Santos da Costa and Ursula von der Leyen

D. Charles Michel and Donald Tusk

Answer: C

#### EU Council President Costa, Commission President von der Leyen to be Chief Guests at 77th Republic Day

- **The President of the European Council, António Luís Santos da Costa, and the President of the European Commission, Ursula von der Leyen**, will be Chief Guests at India's 77th Republic Day celebrations, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) announced.
- During their visit, President Costa and President von der Leyen will co-chair the 16th India-EU Summit on January 27, 2026.
- **India and the European Union have been strategic partners since 2004.** The 15th India-EU Summit was held virtually on July 15, 2020.

#### 17. What is the official theme of the Bharat Electricity Summit 2026?

A. Powering India's Green Transition

B. Electrifying Growth. Empowering Sustainability. Connecting Globally.

C. Sustainable Power for a Digital Future

D. Energy Security through Innovation

Answer: B

#### Bharat Electricity Summit 2026 Announced in New Delhi

- Bharat Electricity Summit 2026, a global conference-cum-exhibition for the power and electricity sector, will be **held from 19-22 March 2026 at Yashobhoomi, New Delhi**, as announced by Union Power Minister Manohar Lal.
- **The theme of the summit is "Electrifying Growth. Empowering Sustainability. Connecting Globally."**
- The four-day event will feature more than 50 high-level conference sessions, expert-led panel discussions, thematic pavilions and technology showcases.

#### 18. With reference to the PM CARES Fund, consider the following statements:

1. It was established in the aftermath of the COVID-19 pandemic.
2. It was created through a Parliamentary statute.
3. It is registered as a Public Charitable Trust.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 1 and 3 only

C. 2 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: B**

- The Delhi High Court orally remarked that the PM Cares Fund, **despite being a juristic or government entity, cannot be denied the right to privacy under the Right to Information Act.**
- The court's reasoning relied on **Section 8(1)(j) of the RTI Act**, which exempts disclosure of personal or third party information unless a larger public interest is established.
- The Prime Ministers Citizen Assistance and Relief in Emergency Situations Fund (PM CARES Fund) was created on 28 March 2020, **following the COVID-19 pandemic in India.**
- It was created for combating, and containment and relief efforts against the coronavirus outbreak and similar pandemic like situations in the future.
- **It has been registered as a Public Charitable Trust.**

**19. With reference to the proposed merger of schemes under the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (PM-RKVY), which of the following schemes are to be merged with it?**

1. Krishonnati Yojana
2. National Mission on Natural Farming
3. National Bee and Honey Mission
4. Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana
5. Soil Health Card Scheme

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1, 3 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 5 only

D. 1, 2, 4 and 5

**Answer: A.**

- **The Union Ministry of Agriculture has proposed merging three schemes with Pradhan Mantri-Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana:**  
Krishonnati Yojana (KY), National Mission on Natural Farming (NMNF), and National Bee and Honey Mission (NBHM).
- PM-RKVY was launched to accelerate agricultural growth and increase farmers' income.

**20. With reference to the status of the Shaksgam Valley (Trans Karakoram Tract), consider the following statements:**

1. It was ceded to China by Pakistan in 1963.
2. It is a disputed territory claimed by India.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- **The Shaksgam Valley, or Trans Karakoram Tract, is part of the Hunza-Gilgit region of Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir (POK) and is a disputed territory claimed by India but controlled by Pakistan.**
- **It was ceded to China by Pakistan in 1963**, when both countries signed a boundary agreement to settle their border differences.

**21. India has previously hosted the Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of Parliaments of Commonwealth Countries (CSPOC) in which of the following years?**

भारत ने पहले निम्नलिखित में से किस वर्ष में कॉमनवेल्थ देशों की संसदों के स्पीकर्स और प्रेसाइडिंग ऑफिसर्स का सम्मेलन (CSPOC) आयोजित किया था?



- A. 1969, 1980 and 2005
- B. 1970–71, 1986 and 2010
- C. 1975, 1990 and 2015
- D. 1982, 1998 and 2020

Answer: B

- India will host the 28th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of Parliaments of Commonwealth Countries (CSPOC) in 2026.
- **As Chairperson of the 28th CSPOC, Om Birla will preside over this meeting.**
- India's history of hosting the conference in 1970-71, 1986, and 2010, and invited presiding officers from Commonwealth nations to join the 2026 event in New Delhi.

## 22. Which two countries will co-chair the 16th ADMM-Plus EWG on Counter Terrorism?

आतंकवाद विरोधी 16वें ADMM-प्लस EWG की सह-अध्यक्षता कौन से दो देश करेंगे?

- A. India and Indonesia
- B. India and Malaysia
- C. India and Singapore
- D. India and Thailand

Answer: B

- **The meeting of 16th ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting (ADMM)-Plus Experts Working Group (EWG) on Counter Terrorism (CT) and Final Planning Conference for Table Top Exercise is scheduled to be held in New Delhi from January 14 to 16, 2026.**
- India and Malaysia will co-chair the 16th EWG on CT meeting.

## 23. BHASHINI Samudaye is being organised by which ministry?

- A. Ministry of Education
- B. Ministry of Culture
- C. Ministry of Science and Technology
- D. Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Answer: D

- BHASHINI Samudaye is being organised by MeitY in New Delhi to strengthen India's language AI ecosystem.
- **BHASHINI Samudaye is a collaborative ecosystem platform under BHASHINI that enables co-creation, governance and scaling of Indian-language AI tools, datasets and services through partnerships with academia, civil society and technology developers.**
- **Developed by:** It is led by the Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD) under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) as part of the National Language Translation Mission (NLTM).

## Republic Day

24. \_\_\_\_\_, an Assistant Commandant of the Central Reserve Police Force, will become the first woman officer to command over 140 male personnel during the Republic Day Parade 2026.

- A. Anju Kumari
- B. Simran Bala
- C. Ritu Chauhan
- D. Poonam Dalal

Answer: B

- **Simran Bala, a 26-year-old CRPF Assistant Commandant hailing from Jammu and Kashmir, will lead an all-male contingent of her force during the Republic Day parade at Kartavya Path in Delhi on January 26.**

25. Which ministry will present the tableau titled *"Prakash Ganga: Powering an Aatmanirbhar and Viksit Bharat"* at the Republic Day Parade 2026?

- A. Ministry of New and Renewable Energy

- B. Ministry of Heavy Industries
- C. Ministry of Coal
- D. Ministry of Power

**Answer: D**

- The Ministry of Power will present its grand tableau titled “Prakash Ganga: Powering an Aatmanirbhar and Viksit Bharat” at the Republic Day Parade on January 26, 2026.
- The theme Prakash Ganga - meaning “River of Light” - symbolises the seamless and continuous flow of power across the interconnected national grid.

**26. Who created history by unfurling the national flag alongside the President of India at the 77th Republic Day parade?**

- A. Squadron Leader Anjali Sharma
- B. Flight Lieutenant Akshita Dhankar
- C. Wing Commander Neha Singh
- D. Flying Officer Pooja Meena

**Answer: B**

- **Flight Lieutenant in the Indian Air Force, Akshita Dhankar, created history after she unfurled the national flag alongside President Droupadi Murmu at the 77th Republic Day parade .**
- **Born in Kasni village in Haryana.**

**27. The headquarters of the Indian Army's Remount and Veterinary Corps is located at:**

- A. New Delhi
- B. Dehradun
- C. Pune
- D. Meerut

**Answer: d**

- Recently, during the Republic Day Parade more animals were represented the Indian Army's Remount and Veterinary Corps.  
Headquarters: Meerut
- Motto: 'Pashu Seva Asmakam Dharma (Service to animals is our duty)'.

**28. With reference to *Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao (BBBP)*, consider the following statements:  
It was launched on January 22, 2015.**

**The Ministry of Women and Child Development is the nodal implementing ministry.**

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- The Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao (BBBP) scheme was launched on January 22, 2015, initially in 100 districts, to combat the alarming decline in the sex ratio at birth and promote female education across India
- The Union Ministry of Women and Child Development is the nodal ministry that implements the Beti Bachao Beti Padhao Scheme in collaboration with other ministries of the government of India.

**29. The SAMPANN pension management system has recently been integrated with which platform?**

- A. DigiLocker
- B. UMANG
- C. BharatNet
- D. e-Sign

**Answer: B**

- The SAMPANN pension management system developed by the office of Controller General of Communication Accounts has been integrated with the UMANG (Unified Mobile Application for New-age Governance) platform.
- This initiative facilitates pensioners in retrieving their Pension Payment Order (PPO) number and Life Certificate (LC) validity status via the UMANG web portal or mobile application.

**30. Granth Kutir is located at:**

- A. National Museum
- B. Rashtrapati Bhavan
- C. Parliament House
- D. National Archives of India

**Answer: B**

- The President of India inaugurated Granth Kutir at Rashtrapati Bhavan.
- **Aim:** The aim of developing the Granth Kutir is to enhance awareness among the citizens regarding the rich cultural and literary heritage of India.

**31. Where will the 65th Central Geological Programming Board (CGPB) meeting be held?**

- A. Kolkata
- B. Mumbai
- C. Hyderabad
- D. New Delhi

**Answer: D**

- The Geological Survey of India (GSI) under the Ministry of Mines will host the 65th Central Geological Programming Board (CGPB) meeting in Delhi on January 21.
- The CGPB functions as a key platform where GSI presents its Annual Field Season Programme (FSP) for discussion, ensuring coordinated survey and exploration activities across the country and preventing duplication of efforts.

**32. IGICBS (Internet Governance Internship & Capacity Building Scheme) was launched in which year?**

- A. 2023
- B. 2024
- C. 2025
- D. 2026

**Answer: C**

- National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI) has completed one year of its Internet Governance Internship & Capacity Building Scheme (IGICBS) and marked the milestone with a national-level event in New Delhi.
- Launched in: 2025 (completed one year in January 2026)

**33. The Union Cabinet approved the continuation of the Atal Pension Yojana (APY) till which financial year?**

- A. 2027–28
- B. 2028–29
- C. 2029–30
- D. 2030–31

**Answer: D**

- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved the continuation of the Atal Pension Yojana (APY) till the financial year 2030-31, along with the extension of government funding support for promotional and developmental activities as well as gap funding.
- Launched on May 9, 2015, the APY provides a guaranteed minimum pension ranging from Rs 1,000 to Rs 5,000 per month from the age of 60, depending on the subscriber's contribution.

**34. With reference to the Womaniya Initiative, consider the following statements:**

**It was launched on 14 January 2019.**



It aims to strengthen the participation of women-led Micro and Small Enterprises in public procurement.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: (c)**

- Recently, the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) marked seven years of the Womaniya initiative.
- It was launched on 14 January 2019.
- It is a flagship programme aimed at strengthening the participation of women-led Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) in public procurement.
- Womaniya was conceived to address the limited access of women entrepreneurs and Self-Help Groups (SHGs) to government markets.

**35. The primary objective of Trucks-on-Trains (ToT) is to:**

- A. Promote air cargo transport
- B. Shift long-haul freight from roads to rail
- C. Replace passenger rail services
- D. Reduce port congestion only

**Answer: B**

- Indian Railways, through its Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC) network, is scaling up the Trucks-on-Trains (ToT) service to shift long-haul freight from roads to electrified rail.
- Trucks-on-Trains (ToT) is a multimodal freight service under the DFC that allows loaded trucks to be carried on specially designed flat wagons for the long-haul rail leg, while trucks handle only the first- and last-mile by road.

**36. With reference to the Model Youth Gram Sabha, consider the following statements:**

1. It is inspired by the Model United Nations (Model UN) format used in schools.
2. It is jointly organized by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj, Ministry of Education and Ministry of Rural Development.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- The Ministry of Panchayati Raj in collaboration with the Ministry of Education and the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, is jointly organizing a National Award Ceremony to felicitate the winners of the Model Youth Gram Sabha.
- It is a simulated forum for School Children to participate in mock Gram Sabha sessions.
- It is an **initiative based on the Model UN – an educational simulation of the United Nations** – in schools across the country.
- **The results of the Best Marching Contingents and Best Tableaux of the Republic Day Parade 2026 have been announced.**
- Among the three Services, the **Indian Navy has been adjudged the Best Marching Contingent.**
- **In the States and Union Territories category - Maharashtra secured first place for its tableau Ganeshotsav: A Symbol of Aatmanirbharta.**
- **The Popular Choice Awards** - The Assam Regiment was voted the Best Marching Contingent among the Services,

**37. Which company has earned the 'Great Place to Work' certification for February 2026 to February 2027 by the Great Place To Work Institute, India?**

- A. Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)
- B. JSW Steel
- C. Tata Steel
- D. Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited

**Answer: A**

- Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL), a Maharatna and India's largest public sector steelmaker has earned the coveted 'Great Place to Work' certification for February 2026 to February 2027, straight third time in a row
- The Great Place to Work Institute, a global authority on workplace culture, honors organizations that deliver exceptional employee experiences through a rigorous evaluation process.

**34. Who is the Principal Conductor for the Beating Retreat ceremony, 2026?**

- A. Squadron Leader Lamapokpam Roopchand Singh
- B. Major Rakesh Singh
- C. Commander Manoj Sebastian
- D. Group Captain Arvind Kumar

**Answer: A**

- Beating Retreat is a ceremony that marks the end of Republic Day festivities in India. It is held on the evening of January 29, three days after Republic Day, at the Vijay Chowk, New Delhi.
- The principal conductor in 2026- Squadron Leader Lamapokpam Roopchand Singh

**35. Under Article 87, the President addresses both Houses of Parliament:**

1. At the beginning of the first session after each general election
2. At the beginning of the first session of every year

**Select the correct answer using the code below:**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- Article 87 of the Indian Constitution outlines when the President addresses both Houses of Parliament.
- The President addresses the Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha at the beginning of the first session after each general election.
- The President also addresses both Houses at the beginning of the first session of each year.
- The Union Minister of State for Panchayati Raj launched the PANCHAM – Panchayat Assistance and Messaging Chatbot
- It is a digital tool developed in collaboration with UNICEF.

**36. With reference to the UGC (Promotion of Equity in Higher Education Institutions) Regulations, 2026, consider the following statements:**

1. They apply only to central universities and institutions of national importance.
2. They mandate the establishment of Equal Opportunity Centres (EOCs) in all higher education institutions.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: B**

- A petition has been filed in the Supreme Court assailing the constitutional validity of Regulation 3(c) of the University Grants Commission (Promotion of Equity in Higher Education Institutions) Regulations, 2026
- Applies to all Indian higher education institutions (HEIs) — public, private, deemed universities, colleges, etc
- Key components include: Establishing Equal Opportunity Centres (EOCs) - primary grievance redressal and support mechanism

**37. The primary aim of *Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0* is to ensure:**

- A. Universal industrial growth
- B. Full coverage of essential government services
- C. Expansion of digital infrastructure
- D. Promotion of private investment

**Answer: B**

- NITI Aayog CEO Shri B.V.R Subrahmanyam launched ‘Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0’—a 3-month intensive campaign to achieve 100% saturation of critical development indicators in India’s most underserved regions.
- Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0 is a mission-mode, time-bound campaign designed to accelerate progress in 112 Aspirational Districts and 513 Aspirational Blocks.

**38. Consider the following statements regarding Meghalaya’s Living Root Bridges:**

1. They are formed using the roots of the rubber fig tree.
2. They are on the tentative list of UNESCO’s World Heritage Sites.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- Meghalaya has moved a step closer to global recognition of its unique living heritage, with India formally submitting the nomination dossier of the State’s living root bridges, titled “Jingkieng Jri / Lyu Chrai Cultural Landscape”, to UNESCO for consideration under the 2026-27 World Heritage evaluation cycle.
- A living root bridge is like a suspension bridge formed by guiding the pliable roots of the rubber fig tree (*Ficus elastica*) across a stream or river and allowing the roots to grow and strengthen over time.
- They are on the tentative list of UNESCO’s World Heritage sites.

**39. The PAIMANA portal, recently operationalised, is an initiative of:**

- A. Ministry of Road Transport and Highways
- B. Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)
- C. Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- D. Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)

**Answer: D**

- The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) has operationalised a new web-based portal, PAIMANA portal for the mandated monitoring of Central Sector Infrastructure Projects worth ₹150 crore and above.
- The Project Assessment, Infrastructure Monitoring & Analytics for Nation-building (PAIMANA) is a flagship initiative of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).

**40. JALAJ Livelihood Centres, recently in the news, is a joint initiative of:**

हाल ही में खबरों में रहे JALAJ आजीविका केंद्र, किसकी एक संयुक्त पहल है:

- A. Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change and WWF-India
- B. Namami Gange Mission and Wildlife Institute of India (WII)



- C. Namami Gange Mission and National Biodiversity Authority  
D. Ministry of Rural Development and UNDP

**Answer: B**

- Recently, the union Minister of Jal Shakti inaugurated 25 JALAJ Livelihood Centres. It is a joint initiative of the Namami Gange Mission and the Wildlife Institute of India (WII).
- Aim: It is aimed at integrating river conservation with sustainable livelihoods in the Ganga river basin.

**41. The Smithsonian's National Museum of Asian Art recently announced the return of three sculptures to India.**

**These sculptures represent:**

- A. Buddha, Bodhisattva, and Tara  
B. Nataraja, Somaskanda, and Saint Sundarar with Paravai  
C. Vishnu, Lakshmi, and Somaskanda  
D. Shiva, Parvati, and Nataraja

**Answer: B**

- The Smithsonian's National Museum of Asian Art, United States, announced that it would return three sculptures:
- The Chola-period sculptures of the Nataraja from the 10th Century
- the Somaskanda from the 12th Century
- and Saint Sundarar with Paravai from the Vijayanagara period (16th Century)

### Eminent Personalities in News

**1. Consider the following statements about Lala Lajpat Rai:**

**He coined the slogan "Quit India."**

**He was associated with founding and editing newspapers such as *Vande Mataram* and *Arya Gazette*.**

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only  
B. 2 only  
C. Both 1 and 2  
D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: B**

- Lala Lajpat Rai was born on 28 January 1865 in Dhudike village, Punjab.
- Lala Lajpat Rai led the protests against the Simon Commission, famously raising the slogan "*Simon Go Back*." - martyrdom on November 17, 1928
- He co-founded the Punjab National Bank in 1894. He founded and edited several newspapers, including *Vande Mataram*, and *Arya Gazette*. founding force behind the influential newspaper Punjab Kesari.

**2. Consider the following statements regarding Parbati Giri:**

- She participated in the Individual Satyagraha of 1940.
- She was popularly known as "Banhi Kanya" for her fearless nationalism.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only  
(b) 2 only  
(c) Both 1 and 2  
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: (c)**

- Prime Minister of India paid tribute to Parbati Giri on her birth centenary.
- Parbati Giri (1926–1995) was an Indian freedom fighter and social reformer from Odisha, widely known as the "Mother Teresa of Western Odisha".

- Actively participated in Individual Satyagraha (1940) and mobilised villagers for the Khadi and Charkha movement.
- Joined the Quit India Movement (1942) at the age of 16, leading rallies and openly defying British authority.
- Earned the epithet “Banhi Kanya” for her fearless nationalism and mass mobilization

**3. With reference to Field Marshal K. M. Cariappa, consider the following statements:**

- 1. He was the first Indian to command a battalion in the Indian Army.**
- 2. Army Day, celebrated every January 15, marks the day he took over as Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Army.**

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

- **28<sup>th</sup> January K. M. Cariappa Jayanti**
- Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa (1899-1993)
- He was independent India’s first Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Army—a role previously reserved for the British.
- He is the first Indian to command a battalion in the Indian Army.
- Army Day, celebrated every January 15, marks the day he took over as Commander-in-Chief, replacing General Sir Francis Roy Bucher.

## Banking

**1. Which organisation has recently become the first payments company in India, the Middle East, APAC and South Africa to be certified as an ISO/IEC 42001 Certification Lead?**

- A. National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)
- B. Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)
- C. Paytm Payments Bank
- D. Financial Software and Systems

**Answer: D**

- Financial Software and Systems (FSS) a global leader in payments technology and transaction processing, has become the first payments company in India, the Middle East, APAC and South Africa to be certified as an ISO IEC 42001 Certification Lead.
- ISO/IEC 42001 represents a significant evolution in how organizations govern AI, moving beyond ad-hoc adoption to a structured, organization-wide AI governance framework.

**2. Which was the first urban cooperative credit society established in India?**

**भारत में स्थापित पहली शहरी सहकारी ऋण समिति कौन सी थी?**

- A. Bombay Mercantile Cooperative Bank
- B. Anyonya Sahakari Mandali
- C. Saraswat Cooperative Bank
- D. Baroda Central Cooperative Bank

**Answer: B**

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) proposed resuming the issuance of licenses for Urban Cooperative Banks (UCBs) after nearly two decades.
- About Urban Cooperative Banks
- Urban Cooperative Banks are not formally defined but refers to primary cooperative banks located in urban and semi-urban areas
- History: The first formal co-operative legislation in India came with the Co-operative Credit Societies Act of 1904 (During Lord Curzon's tenure) and also enacted the more comprehensive Co-operative Societies Act of 1912.
- The first urban cooperative credit society, (Anyonya Sahakari Mandali) was established in 1889 in Baroda.

**3. Receivables Exchange of India Ltd (RXIL) is India's first:**

- A. Credit Rating Agency
- B. Digital Payments Bank
- C. Trade Receivables Discounting System platform
- D. Asset Reconstruction Company

**Answer: C**

Receivables Exchange of India Ltd (RXIL), India's first Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) platform, has announced an interim dividend of 21.6 per cent on its shares.

**This marks a historic milestone, as RXIL becomes the first TReDS platform in the country to distribute returns to its shareholders.**

**4. Consider the following statements regarding Economic Survey 2025–26:**

1. FY27 real GDP growth is projected at 6.8–7.2%.
2. Apr–Dec 2025 average headline inflation was 2.7%.
3. India was the world's largest remittance recipient in FY25 (USD 135.4 bn; ~3.5% of GDP).

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: c**



**Economic Survey 2025-26**

- The Economic Survey is an annual document presented by the government ahead of the Union Budget to review the state of the economy.
- It is prepared by the Economic Division of the Department of Economic Affairs in the Ministry of Finance under the supervision of the Chief Economic Adviser (currently V. Anantha Nageswaran).
- Overall State of the Economy
- real GDP growth for FY26 is projected at 7.4%,
- while GVA growth is estimated at 7.3%,
- Inflation Trends: India recorded the lowest inflation rate since the beginning of the CPI series, with April-Dec '25 average headline inflation coming in at 1.7%.
- India remained the largest recipient of remittances globally, with inflows of USD 135.4 billion in FY25, approximately 3.5% of GDP.

## International

### 1. Operation Absolute Resolve refers to:

ऑपरेशन एब्सोल्यूट रिजॉल्व का मतलब है:

- A) A diplomatic initiative led by the United States
- B) A joint UN–US peacekeeping mission
- C) A sanctions enforcement programme against Venezuela
- D) A major United States military mission to capture Venezuela's President

Answer: d

- The United States reportedly captured Nicolás Maduro, President of Venezuela, following a large-scale strike.
- Operation Absolute Resolve (executed in the early hours of 3 January 2026) was described as a major US military mission aimed at capturing Nicolás Maduro and his wife Cilia Flores and bringing them into US custody.
- **The US cited migration, drug trafficking, and "narco-terrorism"** as the primary reasons for action against Venezuela and Nicolás Maduro.

### 2. The RQ-170 "Sentinel" stealth surveillance drone, recently in the news, is operated by which country?

- A) United Kingdom
- B) Israel
- C) United States of America
- D) France

Answer: C

- A rare **U.S. Air Force RQ-170 "Sentinel" stealth surveillance drone was recently spotted returning to Roosevelt Roads Naval Station** in eastern Puerto Rico, following U.S. military strikes conducted overnight against targets in Venezuela.
- It is an American high-altitude long-endurance unmanned aerial vehicle.
- It is **designed to execute intelligence, surveillance, target acquisition, and reconnaissance (ISTAR) and electronic warfare missions over a target area.**

### 3. Who has assumed the role of Acting President following the detention of Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro?

- A) Cilia Flores
- B) Jorge Rodríguez
- C) Delcy Rodríguez
- D) Diosdado Cabello

Answer: C

- Venezuela's Supreme Court ordered that Vice President Delcy Rodríguez assume the role of acting president in the absence of President Nicolás Maduro, who was detained earlier in the day during an operation carried out by US forces.
- **Rodríguez served as Venezuela's minister of communication and information** from 2013 to 2014, before becoming foreign minister from 2014 to 2017.

### 4. The Monroe Doctrine, recently in the news, is associated with which country's foreign policy?

हाल ही में खबरों में रही मोनरो डॉक्ट्रिन किस देश की विदेश नीति से जुड़ी है?

- A) United States
- B) United Kingdom
- C) France
- D) Spain

Answer: A

- **The U.S. action against Venezuela and the capture of its president has been justified by Donald Trump by invoking the Monroe Doctrine, a 19th-century U.S. policy.**

- The Monroe Doctrine is a U.S. foreign policy principle asserting that the Western Hemisphere is the exclusive sphere of influence of the United States, and that any external (especially European) interference would be treated as a hostile act against the U.S.
- **Established in:** Proclaimed on December 2, 1823 by James Monroe, the 5th President of the United States.

5. The **Eurozone (euro area)** refers to:

- A) All countries of Europe using a common market
- B) EU countries that use the euro as their official legal tender
- C) NATO member countries using a common currency
- D) OECD countries following a shared fiscal policy

**Answer: B**

- Bulgaria officially adopted the euro on January 1, 2026, becoming the 21st member of the eurozone and retiring its national currency, the lev.
- **Bulgaria is a Balkan nation in southeastern Europe and a member of the European Union** (since 2007) and NATO (since 2004). It replaced the Bulgarian lev (in use since 1881) with the euro after fulfilling EU convergence criteria.

**Eurozone (Euro Area):**

- Group of EU states using the euro (€) with a common monetary policy.
- **Founded:** 1992 Maastricht Treaty → created EMU with convergence criteria.
- **1999:** Euro launched as book money.
- **2002:** Euro notes & coins introduced.

6. The maximum tenure of stay permitted under India's newly introduced e-B-4 Visa for Chinese businessmen is:

- A) Three months
- B) Four months
- C) Six months
- D) One year

**Answer: C**

- India has introduced an e-Production Investment Business Visa called e-B-4 Visa that Chinese businessmen can apply for to travel to India for specific business activities, including installation and commissioning of equipment.
- **The e-B-4 Visa, was introduced on January 1, can be applied online without visiting the embassy or agents.**
- The new visa will be issued in about 45 to 50 days, with permission to stay in India for up to six months.

7. The **Weimar Triangle** is a regional political grouping of which three countries?

वीमर ट्रायंगल किन तीन देशों का एक क्षेत्रीय राजनीतिक समूह है?

- A. Italy, Spain, and Portugal
- B. Austria, Hungary, and Czech Republic
- C. France, Germany, and Poland
- D. Belgium, Netherlands, and Luxembourg

**Answer: c**

**Weimar Triangle**

- India's External Affairs Minister recently participated in India's first-ever engagement in the Weimar Triangle, with French and Polish counterparts along with German representatives.

**About Weimar Triangle**

- It is a **regional political grouping of France, Germany, and Poland.**
- It was formed on 29 August 1991 by a joint declaration issued in Weimar, Germany, by the Foreign Ministers of the three countries.

**It had three objectives:**

- To involve France in German-Polish reconciliation by building on the Franco-German experience;
- To strengthen dialogue and political cooperation between the three countries.
- To support Poland in its process of integration into NATO and the European Union (EU).



- Although the Weimar Triangle still has no institutional structure, it remains a framework of reference at the political level.

**8. The BRICS India 2026 logo primarily symbolises:**

- A. Economic dominance and strategic power
- B. Inclusivity, dialogue, and shared growth
- C. Cultural heritage and civilisational ties
- D. Technological leadership of member states

Answer: B

- India has formally launched the official logo and website for its BRICS 2026 Presidency.
- The **BRICS India 2026 Logo symbolises inclusivity, dialogue and shared growth.**
- **The BRICS 2026 Theme** is "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation, and Sustainability".
- It draws inspiration from Prime Minister's "Humanity First and People-centric" vision for BRICS.

**9. Zycubo is primarily used in the treatment of:**

- A. Wilson's disease
- B. Menkes disease
- C. Hemochromatosis
- D. Sickle cell anemia

Answer: B

- **The U.S. Food and Drug Administration recently approved the Zycubo (copper histidinate) as the first treatment for Menkes disease in pediatric patients.**

**Menkes Disease**

- It is a **genetic disorder that affects your body's ability to process copper.**
- It is **caused by a mutation of the ATP7A gene located on the X chromosome. This ATP7A gene affects how the body transports copper and maintains copper levels.**

**10. Which country became the first in the world to impose a nationwide block on the AI chatbot Grok due to concerns over AI-generated explicit and non-consensual deepfake imagery?**

AI-जनरेटेड आपत्तिजनक और बिना सहमति वाली डीपफेक तस्वीरों को लेकर चिंताओं के कारण किस देश ने AI चैटबॉट गोक पर देशव्यापी बैन लगाने वाला दुनिया का पहला देश बन गया है?

- A. United States
- B. United Kingdom
- C. Australia
- D. Indonesia

Answer: D

- Indonesian government temporarily blocked access to Grok, the artificial intelligence chatbot developed by Elon Musk's xAI, citing serious concerns about its ability to produce **AI-generated explicit and non-consensual deepfake imagery.**
- Indonesia is the first country globally to implement a nationwide block specifically over this issue.

**11. Pax Silica is best described as:**

पैक्स सिलिका का सबसे अच्छा वर्णन इस प्रकार किया जा सकता है:

- A. A US-led military alliance in the Indo-Pacific
- B. A trade agreement focused on agriculture
- C. A US-led economic security and technology partnership
- D. A UN-backed digital governance framework

Answer: C

- The United States has announced that India will be invited to join the US-led Pax Silica initiative next month as part of efforts to stabilise and deepen India-US strategic and trade ties.

- Pax Silica is a US-led economic security and technology partnership to build a secure, resilient and innovation-driven global supply chain for silicon, semiconductors, artificial intelligence, critical minerals and advanced manufacturing.
- First Pax Silica Summit held in December 2025.

**12. With reference to the Finke River, consider the following statements:**

1. It is a major but intermittent river of central Australia.
2. It is often called “the oldest river in the world.”

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- **The Finke River, known to the Arrernte people as Larapinta, is believed to be the world’s oldest river system.**
- It is a major but intermittent river of central Australia.
- **It starts in the MacDonnell Ranges in the Northern Territory.**
- It flows for about 600 kilometers (370 miles) towards the Simpson Desert in South Australia.

**13. The Muslim Brotherhood organisations recently designated as “terrorist” groups by the United States operate in which of the following countries?**

1. Egypt
2. Lebanon
3. Jordan

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. **1, 2 and 3**
- D. 1 only

Answer: C

- The United States has designated Muslim Brotherhood organisations in Egypt, Lebanon and Jordan as “terrorist” groups, as Washington intensifies its crackdown on Israel’s rivals across the world.

**14. According to the European Union, the India–EU Free Trade Agreement 2026 will remove or reduce duties on over:**

- A. 50% of EU goods exported to India
- B. 70% of EU goods exported to India
- C. 80% of EU goods exported to India
- D. **90% of EU goods exported to India**

Answer: D

- The free trade agreement (FTA) between India and the European Union (EU) has been termed “mother of all deals”
- The signing of the India-EU trade deal was announced amid European Council President Antonio Costa and EU Commission President Von der Leyen's two-day India visit.
- The trade agreement is expected benefit the most labour-intensive sectors such as textiles, leather, chemicals, electronics and jewellery as they do not compete with European manufacturers.
- According to the European Union, the agreement will remove or reduce duties on over 90% of EU goods exported to India.

**15. The United Arab Emirates signed an MoU with which organisation to host the Global Future Councils (GFCs) meetings?**

- A. World Economic Forum
- B. United Nations Development Programme
- C. World Bank
- D. UNESCO

**Answer: A**

- The United Arab Emirates and the World Economic Forum (WEF) have signed an MoU for Dubai to host the annual Global Future Councils (GFCs) meetings for the next five years.
- Established in: 2013 (as part of WEF's future-oriented knowledge architecture)
- Organisations involved: World Economic Forum
- Strategic partner host (2026–2030): United Arab Emirates

**16. The recently announced "Board of Peace" is associated with efforts to address which of the following conflicts?**

- (a) Russia–Ukraine conflict
- (b) Afghanistan peace process
- (c) Gaza Strip conflict
- (d) Iran nuclear negotiations

**Answer: (c)**

- Trump Announces new 'Board of Peace' to Lead Second Phase of Gaza Peace Plan
- US President Donald Trump has announced the members of a new Board of Peace to lead the second phase of his 20-Point Peace Plan aimed at ending the Gaza conflict.

**17. Which country currently controls the Pratas (Dongsha) Islands?**

- (a) China
- (b) Philippines
- (c) Vietnam
- (d) Taiwan

**Answer: (d)**

- A Chinese reconnaissance drone briefly flew over the Taiwan-controlled Pratas Islands at the top end of the South China Sea recently, in what Taiwan's defence ministry called a "provocative and irresponsible" move.
- The Pratas Islands, also known as the Dongsha Islands, are a small group of three islands located in the northern part of the South China Sea.

**18. The theme of the World Economic Forum Annual Meeting 2026 is:**

- (a) Globalisation and Inclusive Growth
- (b) Restoring Trust in Global Institutions
- (c) A Spirit of Dialogue
- (d) Resilient Futures

**Answer: (c)**

- The "World Economic Forum" Annual Meeting 2026 begins in Davos, Switzerland.
- Jan 19-23, 2026
- Held under the theme "A Spirit of Dialogue",

**19. The Kashiwazaki-Kariwa Nuclear Power Plant, the world's largest nuclear power plant by installed capacity, is located in which country?**

- A. China
- B. South Korea



C. France

D. Japan

**Answer: D.**

- Japan has restarted a reactor at the world's largest nuclear plant nearly 15 years after a disaster at the Fukushima power plant forced the country to shut all its nuclear reactors.
- Reactor no.6 at the Kashiwazaki-Kariwa plant
- Kashiwazaki-Kariwa Nuclear Plant: It is the world's largest nuclear power plant by installed capacity, located near Tokyo.

**20. The Media and Information Literacy (MIL) Alliance is coordinated by which organisation?**

A. World Bank

B. United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)

C. United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)

D. Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

**Answer: C.**

- The UNESCO Media and Information Literacy Alliance has announced the election of its first-ever Global Board, marking a major milestone in its institutional governance.
- The MIL Alliance is a global collaborative network coordinated by UNESCO, bringing together organisations and experts to advance media and information literacy (MIL) and counter disinformation, misinformation, and hate speech.

**21. Muna Island is located in which one of the following countries?**

A. Philippines

B. Malaysia

C. Indonesia

D. Papua New Guinea

**Answer: C**

- The painted outline of a human hand inside a cave on the Indonesian island of Muna represents what researchers are calling the oldest example of rock art in the world, created at least 67,800 years ago.
- It is situated in the Southeast Sulawesi province of Indonesia.

**22. Which one of the following countries has recently acceded to the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI)?**

A. France

B. Japan

C. Australia

D. Spain

**Answer: D**

- Spain has formally joined the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI), with its Foreign Minister handing over the Declaration of Accession to S. Jaishankar.
- The Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI) is a non-treaty, voluntary, cooperative framework for practical maritime collaboration among like-minded countries in the Indo-Pacific region.
- Launched in: 2019 (announced at the East Asia Summit, Bangkok).

**Sports****1. Who won the women's 75 kg category at the National Boxing Championships 2026?**

- A. Saweety Boora
- B. Lovlina Borgohain
- C. Pooja Rani
- D. Mary Kom

**Answer:** Lovlina Borgohain

- **Lovlina Borgohain won the women's 75kg category.**
- Nikhat Zareen claimed the 52kg title at the National Boxing Championships 2026 in Noida
- This was the first time that the men's and women's National Championships were held simultaneously at the same venue.

**2. With reference to the Khelo India Beach Games (KIBG) 2026, consider the following statements:**

1. Karnataka finished first with three gold, two silver and six bronze medals.
2. The slogan of the Games was "Khel Ke Sitare, Diu Ke Kinare".

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: c**

**Tamil Nadu wins gold in women's beach volleyball and men's regu pencak silat at Khelo India Beach Games**

- The Khelo India Beach Games 2026, held in the Union Territory of Diu, concluded with Karnataka emerging as the winners after clinching 11 medals - three gold, two silver and six bronze.
- **With the top three states - Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Manipur** - claiming three gold and two silver medals each, the overall standings of KIBG 2026 .
- Karnataka topped the standings with three gold, all from Open Water swimming, two silver and six bronze to win the overall crown in the second edition of KIBG.

| KIBG 2026 medal table |                |      |        |        |       |
|-----------------------|----------------|------|--------|--------|-------|
| Rank                  | State/UT       | Gold | Silver | Bronze | Total |
| 1                     | Karnataka      | 3    | 2      | 6      | 11    |
| 2                     | Tamil Nadu     | 3    | 2      | 3      | 8     |
| 3                     | Manipur        | 3    | 2      | 2      | 7     |
| 4                     | Madhya Pradesh | 3    | 1      | 1      | 5     |
| 5                     | Haryana        | 2    | 4      | 2      | 8     |

- Diu hosted all the sporting events in the Khelo India Beach Games 2026.
- The Khelo India Beach Games 2026 **logo** embodies the event's spirit, blending sports and Diu's coastal charm with vibrant colors, local elements, and bilingual typography, under the catchy slogan "Khel Ke Sitare, Diu Ke Kinare".
- **Mallakhamb and tug of war were demonstration sports at KIBG 2026 and featured 336 athletes.**
- The **Mascot** - "Pearls – the Dolphin", embodies Diu's coastal spirit and marine heritage, symbolizing intelligence, energy, and sportsmanship.

**3. The 47th National Junior Boys Handball Championship, inaugurated recently, is being hosted in which State/Union Territory?**

- (a) Haryana
- (b) Uttar Pradesh
- (c) Delhi
- (d) Chandigarh

**Answer: (c)**

- **Delhi** Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated the **47th** National Junior Boys Handball Championship at a government school in Pitampura, New Delhi.
- **The championship is being jointly organised by the Handball Federation of India and the Delhi Handball Association.**
- A cash prize of ₹1 lakh for the winning team.

**4. Who has been appointed as the chief coach of the Indian women's hockey team?**

- A) Harendra Singh
- B) Graham Reid
- C) Sjoerd Marijne
- D) Janneke Schopman

**Answer: C**

**Chief coach Sjoerd Marijne appointed for Indian women's hockey team**

**5. The Indian women's hockey team won which medal at the Women's Asia Cup?**

- A) Gold
- B) Silver
- C) Bronze
- D) No medal

**Answer: B**

- The Indian women's hockey team concluded 2025 with a silver medal at the Women's Asia Cup.
- **Women's Asia Cup is a key continental hockey tournament.**
- China topped the 2025 Women's Hockey Asia Cup.

**6. Who has been appointed as the captain of the Hyderabad Ranji Trophy team?**

- A. Tilak Varma
- B. G Rahul Singh
- C. Mohammed Siraj
- D. Mayank Agarwal

**Answer: C**

- **Indian fast bowler Mohammed Siraj has been named the captain of the Hyderabad Ranji Trophy team for the remainder of the season, while top-order bat G Rahul Singh has been named as his deputy.**

**7. The recently retired women cricketer Alyssa Healy belonged to which cricket team?**

- A. England Women's Cricket Team
- B. New Zealand Women's Cricket Team
- C. India Women's Cricket Team
- D. Australia women's cricket team

**Answer: D**

- **Australia captain Alyssa Healy announces retirement from international cricket**

**8. Virat Kohli became only the third batter to score 28,000 international runs, joining which of the following players?**

- A. Brian Lara and Ricky Ponting
- B. Jacques Kallis and Rahul Dravid
- C. Sachin Tendulkar and Kumar Sangakkara
- D. AB de Villiers and Kane Williamson

**Answer: C.**

- **Virat Kohli reached 28,000 international runs in the first ODI vs New Zealand at Vadodara. He became the fastest to 28,000 runs, achieving it in 624 innings, ahead of Tendulkar (644) and Sangakkara (666).**
- **He is only the third batter to reach this milestone after Tendulkar and Sangakkara.**



**9. The ICC Women's Player of the Month for December 2025 is:**

- A. Smriti Mandhana
- B. Ellyse Perry
- C. Sophie Ecclestone
- D. Laura Wolvaardt

**Answer: D**

- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has named Australia's Mitchell Starc as the ICC Men's Player of the Month for December 2025.
- On the other hand, South Africa's Laura Wolvaardt has been named the ICC Women's Player of the Month.

**10. Who has been announced as the new coach of Real Madrid?**

- A. Zinedine Zidane
- B. Carlo Ancelotti
- C. Álvaro Arbeloa
- D. Raúl González

**Answer: C**

**Real Madrid Football Club Announced that Xabi Alonso left his role as team coach and Álvaro Arbeloa as the new first-team coach.**

**11. Which football club secured its 16th Spanish Super Cup title 2026?**

- A. Atlético Madrid
- B. Sevilla FC
- C. FC Barcelona
- D. Valencia CF

- FC Barcelona secured their 16th Spanish Super Cup title after defeating Real Madrid 3–2 in the final held at the King Abdullah Sports City Stadium in Jeddah, Saudi Arabia.

**12. Which team won the women's title at the 75th Senior National Basketball Championship?**

- A. Kerala
- B. Tamil Nadu
- C. Karnataka
- D. Indian Railways

**Answer: D**

- It was double victory for the Indian Railways at the 75th senior National basketball championship at the Nehru Indoor Stadium .
- **In the women's section, Railways defeated Kerala 75-66 to clinch its eighth consecutive crown and 41st overall.**
- In the men's category, Railways dethroned defending champion Tamil Nadu.

**13. Which Indian motorsport athlete won the H3 Class in the Prologue Stage of the Dakar Rally 2026?**

- A) Gaurav Gill
- B) Sanjay Takale
- C) Arjun Maini
- D) Narain Karthikeyan

**Answer: B**

- In a historic achievement for Indian motorsport, **top driver Sanjay Takale delivered a standout performance in the Prologue Stage of the Dakar Rally 2026, finishing first** in the high average speed Group H3 and 35th overall in the Cars category.

**14. Who became the first Indian and the first female to secure a top-five finish on debut in the junior S125 category at the IAME UAE Karting Championship, held at the Yas Marina Circuit?**

यास मरीना सर्किट में हुई IAME UAE कार्टिंग चैंपियनशिप में जूनियर S125 कैटेगरी में डेब्यू पर टॉप-5 में जगह बनाने वाली पहली भारतीय और पहली महिला कौन बनीं?

- A) Ananya Sharma
- B) Atiqa Mir
- C) Rhea Banerjee
- D) Sneha Kapoor

Answer: B

- **Racer Atiqa Mir becomes first Indian to secure top five finish at IAME UAE Karting Championship**
- Atiqa Mir (11) became the first Indian and first female to finish top-five on debut.
- She moved from Mini to Junior S125 category.

**15. Which medal did Anahat Singh win in the women's Under-19 category at the British Junior Open Squash Championships 2026?**

- A) Gold
- B) Silver
- C) Bronze
- D) No medal

Answer: B

- In squash, the top-seeded Indian player, Anahat Singh, clinched the silver medal in the women's under-19 final **at the British Junior Open squash championships 2026.**

**16. Jinson Johnson, who recently announced his retirement, is associated with which sport?**

- A. Badminton
- B. Wrestling
- C. Shooting
- D. Athletics

Answer: D

- National record-holder and Asian Games gold-winning Indian middle distance runner Jinson Johnson announced his retirement.
- He **went on to bag the bronze medal in 1500m at the 2023 Asian Games in Hangzhou.**
- Johnson also won the silver and bronze medals at the Asian Athletics Championships in 2015 and 2017, respectively.

**17. Paradip Port Authority is located in which Indian state?**

- A) West Bengal
- B) Odisha
- C) Andhra Pradesh
- D) Tamil Nadu

Answer: B

- Paradip Port Authority, Odisha observed its **65th Port Foundation Day with the successful conduct of the 21st Paradip Marathon 2026.**
- Paradip Port Authority, foundation stone was laid on 3 January 1962.

**18. Which snake boat was crowned champion of the 5th edition of the Champions Boat League (CBL) Season 5?**

- A. Niranam Chundan
- B. Payippad Chundan
- C. **Veeyapuram Chundan**
- D. Kumarakom Chundan

Answer: C

- Veeyapuram Chundan, rowed by the Village Boat Club (VBC) from Kainakary, was crowned **fifth edition of the Champions Boat League (CBL) Season 5** champions.

- In the **President's Trophy**, held as the finale of the CBL season at Ashtamudi Lake in Kollam, Niranam Chundan (rowed by Niranam Boat Club) won the President's Trophy race.

**19. Which team clinched the title at the 5th LG Cup Ice Hockey Championship?**

- (a) Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)
- (b) Indian Army
- (c) Ladakh Scouts Regiment
- (d) Ladakh Police

**Answer: (a)**

- In Ladakh, the 5th LG Cup Ice Hockey Championship concluded at the Biamathang Ice Hockey Ground, Kargil.
- ITBP clinching the title after defeating the Ladakh Scouts team of the Indian Army .

**20. Who won the Vijay Hazare Trophy 2025–26?**

- A. Saurashtra
- B. Tamil Nadu
- C. Vidarbha
- D. Karnataka

**Answer: C**

- Vidarbha clinched their maiden Vijay Hazare Trophy title in the 2025–26 season.
- Vidarbha defeated Saurashtra by 38 runs to secure the trophy.

**21. Which team won the 2025 Africa Cup of Nations (AFCON) title?**

- (a) Egypt
- (b) Senegal
- (c) Nigeria
- (d) Morocco

**Answer: (b)**

- Senegal have won the 2025 Africa Cup of Nations title, beating hosts Morocco 1-0
- This victory secured Senegal's second AFCON (Africa Cup of Nations) title (their first was in 2021).

**22. The All India Football Federation (AIFF) appointed which of the following as the head coach of the Indian senior women's football team?**

- A. Pia Sundhage
- B. Tom Sermanni
- C. Amelia Valverde
- D. Sarina Wiegman

**Answer: C**

- The All India Football Federation (AIFF) announced the appointment of Costa Rica's Amelia Valverde as the head coach of the Indian senior women's team.

**23. In which of the following Indian states was the National Paralympic Powerlifting Championship 2026 held?**

- A. Himachal Pradesh
- B. Uttarakhand
- C. Uttar Pradesh
- D. Haryana

**Answer: B**

- Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami inaugurated the National Paralympic Powerlifting Championship in Uttarakhand in January 2026.
- Event: The Championship was inaugurated virtually from COER University, Roorkee.



**24. Who won the gold medal at the 7th Roll Ball World Cup 2025?**

- A. Arjun Patel
- B. Rohit Sharma
- C. Yash Anil Rashiya
- D. Kunal Mehta

**Answer: C**

- Yash Anil Rashiya, a 20-year-old athlete from Surat, India, won the gold medal at the 7th Roll Ball World Cup 2025 held in Dubai.

**25. Recently in news, Jude Owens created history by setting Guinness World Records at the age of two. Which of the following correctly describes his achievement?**

- A. Youngest person to score a century break in snooker
- B. Youngest person to successfully execute two different trick shots in snooker
- C. Youngest person to win an international snooker tournament
- D. Youngest person to compile a maximum 147 break

**Answer: B**

- A two-year-old boy from Manchester Jude Owens became the youngest person ever to successfully execute two different trick shots in snooker.
- He set the record for the youngest player to make a bank shot in pool.
- He had already created history by becoming the youngest to double pot a snooker shot.

## Index

**1. As per the Economic Survey (Statistical Appendix) 2023–24, which state was the largest rice producer in India?**

इकोनॉमिक सर्वे (स्टैटिस्टिकल अपेंडिक्स) 2023-24 के अनुसार, भारत में सबसे बड़ा चावल उत्पादक राज्य कौन सा था?

- A) Uttar Pradesh
- B) West Bengal
- C) Andhra Pradesh
- D) Telangana

**Answer: D**

- Union Agriculture Minister said India has become the world's largest rice producer, with output at 150.18 million tonnes, overtaking China at 145.28 million tonnes.
- **India has overtaken China to become the No. 1 rice-producing country globally**, as per the minister's statement (2024–25 output: 150.18 MT).

**As per Economic Survey (Statistical Appendix) for 2023–24, the three largest rice-producing states were:**

- **Telangana** – 16.63 MT ( $\approx 12.17\%$  share)
- **Uttar Pradesh** – 15.72 MT ( $\approx 11.50\%$  share)

**2. India has recently achieved which global position in contributions to the WHO pharmacovigilance database?**

भारत ने हाल ही में WHO फार्माकोविजिलेंस डेटाबेस में योगदान के मामले में कौन सी वैश्विक रैंक हासिल की है?

- A) 5th
- B) 8th
- C) 10th
- D) 15th

**Answer: B**

### WHO Pharmacovigilance

- Union Health Minister announced that India has risen to 8th position globally in contributions to the WHO pharmacovigilance database, from 123rd a decade ago.
- **WHO pharmacovigilance refers to the global system** for monitoring, detecting, assessing, and preventing adverse effects of medicines and vaccines, coordinated through international data-sharing mechanisms.
- **Aim:** Ensure patient safety by early identification of medicine- and vaccine-related risks.

**3. According to the World Economic Situation and Prospects 2026 report, the global economy is projected to grow by what percentage in 2026?**

वर्ल्ड इकोनॉमिक सिचुएशन एंड प्रॉस्पेक्ट्स 2026 रिपोर्ट के अनुसार, 2026 में ग्लोबल इकोनॉमी में कितने प्रतिशत की बढ़ोतरी होने का अनुमान है?

- A. 2.5%
- B. 2.6%
- C. 2.7%
- D. 2.9%

**Answer: C**

### The UN's World Economic Situation and Prospects Report 2026

- The global economy is forecast to grow by 2.7 per cent in 2026, slightly below the 2.8 per cent estimated for 2025, **40 bps faster than previously anticipated, according to the World Economic Situation and Prospects 2026, released by the United Nations**
- The report is prepared by the UN's Department of Economic and Social Affairs (DESA) in partnership with the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) and the five United Nations regional commissions.

**4. Which city topped the Top Cities for Women in India 2025 report released by Avtar Group?**

अवतार ग्रुप द्वारा जारी भारत 2025 में महिलाओं के लिए टॉप शहरों की रिपोर्ट में कौन सा शहर टॉप पर रहा?

- A. Chennai
- B. Mumbai

C. Bengaluru

D. Pune

Answer: C

- Bengaluru has emerged as the best city for women in India, topping the Top Cities for Women in India 2025 report .
- Released by Avatar Group, which assessed 125 cities across the country on parameters linked to women's inclusion, safety, employment and quality of life.

**5. Which state secured the first position in the ICJS (Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System) 2.0 national ranking?**

A. Haryana

B. Assam

C. Uttar Pradesh

D. Uttarakhand

Answer: D

**ICJS (Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System) 2.0 national ranking**

- In the latest ICJS 2.0 ranking, Uttarakhand ranked first with 93.46, followed by Haryana at 93.41 and Assam at 93.16.

**6. With reference to the 2026 Henley Passport Index, consider the following statements:**

1. India is ranked 80th in the Henley Passport Index.
2. India improved its rank by **three** places compared to the previous year.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The Henley Passport Index 2026 is the world's most trusted ranking of global mobility.
- At the **very top is Singapore**, holding the No. 1 spot. Singaporeans can travel to 192 countries and territories without needing a visa.
- In 2026, it ranks 80th, moving up five spots from last year. Indian citizens can now travel to 55 countries without a visa.

**7. Consider the following statements regarding the Export Preparedness Index (EPI) 2024:**

1. It was released by NITI Aayog.
2. Maharashtra is identified as a leading performer among large states in EPI 2024.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- **NITI Aayog released the Export Preparedness Index (EPI) 2024**, a comprehensive assessment of export readiness across India's States and Union Territories (UTs).
- **The 2024 edition indicates that Maharashtra, along with Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh, are leading performers among large states.**
- Uttarakhand, Jammu and Kashmir, Nagaland, Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu, and Goa are listed as leading performers in the category of small states, northeastern states and union territories

**8. The Global Risks Report 2026 is published by the:**

ग्लोबल रिस्क रिपोर्ट 2026 किसके द्वारा पब्लिश की जाती है:

A. United Nations Development Programme

B. International Monetary Fund



- C. World Bank  
D. World Economic Forum

**Answer: D**

- The **World Economic Forum's Global Risks Report 2026** has ranked **geoeconomic confrontation** as the **world's top short-term risk**, overtaking armed conflict, reflecting rising trade wars, sanctions, and weaponization of economic tools.
- The Global Risks Report 2026 is the **21st annual assessment published by the World Economic Forum**, drawing on the Global Risks Perception Survey (GRPS) of leaders from government, business, academia, civil society and international organisations.
- It evaluates 33 global risks across 2-year (short-term) and 10-year (long-term) time horizons.
- In January 2026, according to Numbeo Safety Index 2026 rankings by Numbeo, a crowd-sourced global database, Mangaluru (Karnataka) emerged as the safest city in India.
- **Released by:** Numbeo
- **Total Cities Covered:** 304
- **Top 3 Safest City (Globally):** Qingdao, Shandong (China) (Score: 89.2); Abu Dhabi(UAE)(88.9); Doha(Qatar)(84.5)
- **Top 3 Safest Countries:** UAE – 86.0; Qatar – 84.8; Andorra – 84.8
- India ranked 70th globally among countries, with an overall safety.

**9. Consider the following statements regarding the National Legislative Index (NLI):**

1. It is a proposed framework to evaluate the performance of Parliament and State Legislatures.
2. It relies entirely on subjective political assessments.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only  
B. 2 only  
C. Both 1 and 2  
D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- The 86th All India Presiding Officers Conference, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla announced the initiation of a National Legislative Index (NLI) to objectively assess and compare the performance of legislatures.
- The **National Legislative Index is a proposed performance-evaluation framework to objectively measure and compare the functioning of Parliament and State Legislatures using predefined indicators.**

**10. Which university secured Rank 1 globally in the THE World University Rankings by Subject 2026?**

- A. University of Oxford  
B. Stanford University  
C. Massachusetts Institute of Technology  
D. Harvard University

**Answer: D**

- Indian institutions make a limited mark in the Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings by Subject 2026.
- **IISc Bangalore is the only Indian institute to rank under 100 in the Computer Science subject category**, followed by Amity University at the 251-300 slot, Jamia Millia Islamia at the 301-400 belt.

**11. Which country has been ranked first globally in the Responsible Nations Index (RNI) 2026?**

- (a) Switzerland  
(b) Denmark  
(c) Singapore  
(d) Sweden

**Answer: (c)**

- India has launched the Responsible Nations Index (RNI) 2026 to introduce a new global benchmark for evaluating countries on ethical governance and responsibility, with India ranked 16th globally.
- Launched by: Under the aegis of the World Intellectual Foundation (WIF).
- **Rankings (RNI 2026):**
- Singapore – Rank 1

- India: Rank 16 (Overall Score: 0.5515) and Central African Republic – Overall Score: 0.35715, Rank: 154 (Last).

**12. With reference to the Asia Manufacturing Index (AMI) 2026, consider the following statements:**

- China topped the Asia Manufacturing Index for the third consecutive year.
- India ranked 11th in the Asia Manufacturing Index 2026.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- India has ranked sixth among 11 Asian economies in the Asia Manufacturing Index (AMI) 2026.
- Asia Manufacturing Index is released by Dezan Shira & Associates
- Headquartered in Hong Kong
- China** : Retained the top spot for the third consecutive year due to its unmatched industrial scale and supply chains.

**13. Which organisation released the flagship report titled “Global Water Bankruptcy: Living Beyond Our Hydrological Means in the Post-Crisis Era”?**

- A. UNESCO – International Hydrological Programme (IHP)
- B. World Bank – Water Global Practice
- C. United Nations University Institute for Water, Environment and Health (UNU-INWEH)
- D. United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

**Answer: C**

- Global Water Bankruptcy Report** - The United Nations University Institute for Water, Environment and Health (UNU-INWEH) released a flagship report titled “Global Water Bankruptcy: Living Beyond Our Hydrological Means in the Post-Crisis Era”.
- It describes a persistent post-crisis failure state where long-term water use exceeds renewable inflows and safe depletion limits**, causing irreversible damage to natural capital.

**14. What is India’s rank in the Global Soft Power Index 2026?**

- A. 28th
- B. 30th
- C. 32nd
- D. 35th

**Answer: C**

- The Brand Finance Global Soft Power Index 2026 — ranking 193 UN member states across 55 metrics — published
- The United States retained the top position .
- India ranks 32nd with a score of 48.0, slipping two positions and declining 1.8 points from last year.

**15. Which university has secured the first position in the QS World University Rankings Europe 2026?**

- A. University of Cambridge
- B. ETH Zurich
- C. University of Oxford
- D. Imperial College London

**Answer: C**

- The QS World University Rankings Europe 2026 have been released.
- Compiled by Quacquarelli Symonds (QS).
- The University of Oxford has secured the first position
- ETH Zurich followed closely at second place,

**16. India achieved elimination of leprosy as a public health problem at the national level in:**

- A. 1998
- B. 2002
- C. 2005
- D. 2010

**Answer: C**

- India observes National Leprosy Day annually on January 30,
- Leprosy, also known as Hansen's disease, is a chronic infectious disease caused by the bacterium *Mycobacterium leprae*.
- India achieved the elimination of leprosy as a public health problem at the national level in December 2005,

**17. Consider the following statements:**

1. The designation of Patna Bird Sanctuary and Chhari-Dhand has increased India's Ramsar sites to 98.
2. Both sites are important for waterbird conservation.
3. Both sites are man-made reservoirs.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: A**

- Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav announces addition of two new wetlands to India's Ramsar network
- The wetlands in Kutch in Gujarat and Etah in Uttar Pradesh have been recognised as Ramsar sites
- the designation of Patna Bird Sanctuary in Etah and Chhari-Dhand in Kutch as Ramsar sites.
- Chhari-Dhand is a seasonal saline wetland located between the famous Banni grasslands and salt flats of Kutch.
- It is an important wintering site for waterfowl, supporting species such as critically endangered sociable lapwing, the vulnerable common pochard, and, notably, approximately 30,000 common cranes (*Grus grus*) annually, Patna Bird Sanctuary is particularly important in supporting waterbird populations and has been designated an Important Bird and Biodiversity Area (IBA) by BirdLife International
- The designation of these two sites under the Ramsar Convention takes the total number of such wetlands in India to 98.

**18. Which of the following states are the theme states of the Surajkund International Crafts Mela 2026?**

- A. Rajasthan and Gujarat
- B. Uttar Pradesh and Meghalaya
- C. Bihar and Assam
- D. Punjab and Haryana

**Answer: B**

- Vice President C P Radhakrishnan on 31st January inaugurated the 39th Surajkund International Crafts Mela 2026 at Surajkund in Faridabad, Haryana. Mr Radhakrishnan also launched the Mela Sathi App during the event.
- This year, the central theme of the fair is Local to Global,
- Uttar Pradesh and Meghalaya are the theme state of this year's fair to cherish the visitors.

**19. Recently passed away, Catherine O'Hara was associated with which of the following professions?**

- A. Sports journalism
- B. Film and television acting
- C. Fashion designing
- D. Political activism

**Answer: B**

- Catherine O'Hara, the Emmy-winning Canadian-American actor, popular for her comic roles, passed away in Los Angeles



- She was 71 year old. O'Hara was best known for her starring roles in the Home Alone and Beetlejuice films.

**20. Team India secured which position at the 35th Breckenridge International Snow Sculpture Championships 2026?**

- A. First (Gold)
- B. Second (Silver)
- C. Third (Bronze)
- D. Fourth

**Answer: C**

- Team India secured the third prize (Bronze Medal) at the **35th Breckenridge International Snow Sculpture Championships** in Breckenridge, Colorado, USA.
- In the 2026 results:  
Gold Medal: Team Republic of Korea  
Silver Medal: Team Mongolia  
Bronze Medal: Team India

**21. The primary objective of the Mukhyamantri Gramotthan Yojana is to:**

- A. Promote industrial corridors in rural areas
- B. Provide urban-equivalent facilities to villages
- C. Develop coastal tourism villages
- D. Encourage organic farming clusters

**Answer: B**

- In Gujarat, Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel launched the state-wide 'Mukhyamantri Gramotthan Yojana'.
- Under the scheme, the villages will be provided with modern urban equivalent facilities, including road infrastructure, water, sanitation, solar street lights, e-grams, and community halls, etc, helping reduce the burden on cities,

**22. The 5th edition of the Rüsoma Orange Festival began in which Indian state?**

- A. Assam
- B. Manipur
- C. Nagaland
- D. Mizoram

**Answer: C**

- In Nagaland, the 5th edition of the Rüsoma Orange Festival began today at Rüsoma village.
- the theme "Abundance of Rüsoma,

**23. Uttar Pradesh and Bihar were joint winners in which of the following categories at the Wings India 2026 Awards?**

- A. Best State with Dedicated Outlook
- B. State Champions in Aviation
- C. Most Proactive State under RCS–UDAN Non-Priority Areas
- D. Best State for Promotion of Aviation Ecosystem

**Answer: C**

- The Wings India 2026 Awards were announced
- The country's premier aviation event, hosted by the Ministry of Civil Aviation in collaboration with FICCI and the Airports Authority of India (AAI).
- Delhi International Airport Limited - Best Airport of the Year,
- States recognised for aviation leadership
- while Uttar Pradesh and Bihar were joint winners in the Most Proactive State under RCS–UDAN Non-Priority Areas category.

**24. According to the Supreme Court judgment, inaccessibility of menstrual hygiene measures violates which of the following fundamental rights?**

1. Right to Equality (Article 14)
2. Right to Life (Article 21)
3. Right to Education under Article 21A

**Select the correct answer using the code below:**

- A. 1 only  
B. 1 and 2 only  
C. 2 and 3 only  
D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: D**

- The Supreme Court of India, in a landmark verdict Dr. Jaya Thakur vs Government Of India, declared the right to menstrual health a fundamental right under Article 21, ordering all schools to provide free sanitary pads and gender-segregated toilets.
- Key Highlights of the judgment
- Menstrual Health as a fundamental right: Right to life under Article 21 of the Constitution includes the right to menstrual health.
- Link to Article 14 (Right to Equality): Inaccessibility of MH measures strips away the right to participate on equal terms in schools.
- Inaccessibility of sanitary products affects fundamental right to education under Article 21A and Right to Education (RTE) Act.

**25. According to Numbeo's Cost of Living Index by City 2026, which city is ranked as the most expensive city in the world?**

- A. Geneva  
B. Basel  
C. Bern  
D. Zurich

**Answer: D**

- Numbeo's Cost of Living Index by City 2026
- The Cost of Living Index reflects the estimated average expenses for a family of four in each city.
- Zurich, with a cost-of-living index score of 118.5, retains its position as the most expensive city in the world in 2026.
- Geneva (2nd ), Basel(3rd ) and Bern (4th )

**26. Who is the author of the book The Unprecedented Success Story of the First Indigenous Supersonic Multitarget Surface to Air Missile System – Akash?**

- A. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam  
B. G Chandramouli  
C. V.K. Saraswat  
D. Satheesh Reddy

**Answer: B**

- Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh released the book 'The Unprecedented success story of the first indigenous supersonic multitarget surface to air missile system - Akash'
- authored by former, project director 'Akash' & programme director, Defence Research and Development Laboratory (DRDL) G Chandramouli

**27. Who won the Men's Doubles title at the Australian Open 2026?**

- A. Rajeev Ram and Joe Salisbury  
B. Neal Skupski and Christian Harrison  
C. Nikola Mektic and Mate Pavic  
D. Wesley Koolhof and Jean-Julien Rojer

**Answer: B**

- Australian Open 2026
- Australian Open men's doubles title : Neal Skupski and Christian Harrison - their first Grand Slam event as a team.
- Australian Open women's doubles : Elise Mertens and Zhang Shuai

**28. Who is set to become the first woman Deputy Chief Minister of Maharashtra?**

- A. Supriya Sule
- B. Sunetra Pawar
- C. Pankaja Munde
- D. Raksha Khadse

**Answer: B**

- Sunetra Pawar, wife of the deceased Nationalist Congress Party leader Ajit Pawar, is set to become the first woman Deputy Chief Minister of Maharashtra.
- MP Sunetra Pawar was elected by NCP legislators as the leader of the party's

**29. Consider the following statements:**

1. Digital Food Currency is a programmed form of e-Rupee (CBDC).
2. Beneficiaries can use digital food coupons at any retail store.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

- The Government of India is set to launch a pilot program for Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC), also termed Digital Food Currency, in February 2026.
- Regulatory Body: Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
- Digital food coupons are a programmed form of e-Rupee (CBDC). Instead of physical grains or cash transfers, beneficiaries receive digital tokens specifically locked for use at authorized ration shops.

**30. Paathara (also known as Khoni in Odia) refers to:**

- A. An above-ground bamboo granary
- B. A floating grain warehouse
- C. A metal silo storage system
- D. A traditional underground grain storage pit

**Answer: D**

- The ancient Paathara (or Khoni) grain storage tradition in Andhra Pradesh's Srikakulam district is facing imminent extinction in January 2026.
- Paathara (referred to as Khoni in Odia) is a traditional underground grain storage pit.
- It is a highly scientific, indigenous method used by farmers to preserve freshly harvested paddy for long-term household consumption and rituals.

**31. Hanle Dark Sky Reserve is part of:**

- A. Hemis National Park
- B. Changthang Wildlife Sanctuary
- C. Karakoram Wildlife Sanctuary
- D. Pin Valley National Park

**Answer: B**

- Recently, a rare blood-red auroral activity was captured by the all-sky camera at the Indian Astronomical Observatory in Ladakh's Hanle Dark Sky Reserve.
- Location: It is located at 4,500 metres altitude, in the remote Changthang region of Ladakh.
- part of the Changthang Wildlife Sanctuary
- It was notified in December 2022 by the Government of Ladakh.